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Three-dimensional data encoding method, three-dimensional data decoding method, three-dimensional data encoding device, and three-dimensional data decoding device

Abstract

A three-dimensional data encoding method of encoding three-dimensional points includes: calculating a predicted value of attribute information of a first three-dimensional point in a prediction mode, using one or more items of attribute information of one or more second three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the first three-dimensional point; calculating a prediction residual that is a difference between the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point and the predicted value; and generating a bitstream including the prediction residual and prediction mode information indicating the prediction mode. The prediction mode is: one prediction mode among two or more prediction modes when a type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is first attribute information including elements more than a predetermined threshold value; and one fixed prediction mode when the type is second attribute information including elements equal to or less than the predetermined threshold value.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a U.S. continuation application of PCT International Patent Application Number PCT/JP2021/036760 filed on Oct. 5, 2021, claiming the benefit of priority of U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/088,001 filed on Oct. 6, 2020, the entire contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference.

BACKGROUND

1. Technical Field

(1) The present disclosure relates to a three-dimensional data encoding method, a three-dimensional data decoding method, a three-dimensional data encoding device, and a three-dimensional data decoding device.

2. Description of the Related Art

(2) Devices or services utilizing three-dimensional data are expected to find their widespread use in a wide range of fields, such as computer vision that enables autonomous operations of cars or robots, map information, monitoring, infrastructure inspection, and video distribution. Three-dimensional data is obtained through various means including a distance sensor such as a rangefinder, as well as a stereo camera and a combination of a plurality of monocular cameras.

(3) Methods of representing three-dimensional data include a method known as a point cloud scheme that represents the shape of a three-dimensional structure by a point cloud in a three-dimensional space. In the point cloud scheme, the positions and colors of a point cloud are stored. While point cloud is expected to be a mainstream method of representing three-dimensional data, a massive amount of data of a point cloud necessitates compression of the amount of three-dimensional data by encoding for accumulation and transmission, as in the case of a two-dimensional moving picture (examples include Moving Picture Experts Group-4 Advanced Video Coding (MPEG-4 AVC) and High Efficiency Video Coding (HEVC) standardized by MPEG).

(4) Meanwhile, point cloud compression is partially supported by, for example, an open-source library (Point Cloud Library) for point cloud-related processing.

(5) Furthermore, a technique for searching for and displaying a facility located in the surroundings of the vehicle by using three-dimensional map data is known (for example, see International Publication WO 2014/020663).

SUMMARY

(6) There has been a demand for increasing the encoding efficiency in three-dimensional data encoding.

(7) An object of the present disclosure is to provide a three-dimensional data encoding method, a three-dimensional data decoding method, a three-dimensional data encoding device, or a three-dimensional data decoding device that is capable of increasing the encoding efficiency.

(8) In accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure, a three-dimensional data encoding method of encoding three-dimensional points includes: calculating a predicted value of attribute information of a first three-dimensional point in a prediction mode for calculating the predicted value, using one or more items of attribute information of one or more second three-dimensional points in a vicinity of the first three-dimensional point, the first three-dimensional point and the one or more second three-dimensional points being included in the three-dimensional points; calculating a prediction residual that is a difference between the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point and the predicted value calculated; and generating a bitstream including the prediction residual and prediction mode information indicating the prediction mode, wherein the prediction mode is: one prediction mode among two or more prediction modes when a type of

the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is first attribute information including elements a total number of which is greater than a predetermined threshold value; and one fixed prediction mode when the type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is second attribute information including elements a total number of which is smaller than or equal to the predetermined threshold value.

(9) In accordance with another aspect of the present disclosure, a three-dimensional data decoding method of decoding three-dimensional points includes: obtaining a prediction residual and prediction mode information indicating a prediction mode for a first three-dimensional point among the three-dimensional points, by obtaining a bitstream; calculating a predicted value in the prediction mode indicated by the prediction mode information; and calculating attribute information of the first three-dimensional point by adding the predicted value to the prediction residual, wherein the prediction mode is: one prediction mode among two or more prediction modes when a type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is first attribute information including elements a total number of which is greater than a predetermined threshold value; and one fixed prediction mode when the type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is second attribute information including elements a total number of which is smaller than or equal to the predetermined threshold value.

(10) The present disclosure provides a three-dimensional data encoding method, a three-dimensional data decoding method, a three-dimensional data encoding device, or a three-dimensional data decoding device that is capable of increasing the encoding efficiency.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) These and other objects, advantages and features of the disclosure will become apparent from the following description thereof taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings that illustrate a specific embodiment of the present disclosure.

(2) FIG. 1 is a diagram illustrating a configuration of a three-dimensional data encoding and decoding system according to Embodiment 1;

(3) FIG. 2 is a diagram illustrating a structure example of point cloud data according to Embodiment 1;

(4) FIG. 3 is a diagram illustrating a structure example of a data file indicating the point cloud data according to Embodiment 1;

(5) FIG. 4 is a diagram illustrating types of the point cloud data according to Embodiment 1;

(6) FIG. 5 is a diagram illustrating a structure of a first encoder according to Embodiment 1;

(7) FIG. 6 is a block diagram illustrating the first encoder according to Embodiment 1;

(8) FIG. 7 is a diagram illustrating a structure of a first decoder according to Embodiment 1;

(9) FIG. 8 is a block diagram illustrating the first decoder according to Embodiment 1;

(10) FIG. 9 is a block diagram of a three-dimensional data encoding device according to Embodiment 1;

(11) FIG. 10 is a diagram showing an example of geometry information according to Embodiment 1;

(12) FIG. 11 is a diagram showing an example of an octree representation of geometry information according to Embodiment 1;

(13) FIG. 12 is a block diagram of a three-dimensional data decoding device according to Embodiment 1;

(14) FIG. 13 is a block diagram of an attribute information encoder according to Embodiment 1;

(15) FIG. 14 is a block diagram of an attribute information decoder according to Embodiment 1;

(16) FIG. 15 is a block diagram showing a configuration of the attribute information encoder

according to the variation of Embodiment 1;

(17) FIG. 16 is a block diagram of the attribute information encoder according to Embodiment 1;

(18) FIG. 17 is a block diagram showing a configuration of the attribute information decoder according to the variation of Embodiment 1;

(19) FIG. 18 is a block diagram of the attribute information decoder according to Embodiment 1;

(20) FIG. 19 is a diagram illustrating a structure of a second encoder according to Embodiment 1;

(21) FIG. 20 is a block diagram illustrating the second encoder according to Embodiment 1;

(22) FIG. 21 is a diagram illustrating a structure of a second decoder according to Embodiment 1;

(23) FIG. 22 is a block diagram illustrating the second decoder according to Embodiment 1;

(24) FIG. 23 is a diagram illustrating a protocol stack related to PCC encoded data according to Embodiment 1;

(25) FIG. 24 is a diagram illustrating structures of an encoder and a multiplexer according to Embodiment 2;

(26) FIG. 25 is a diagram illustrating a structure example of encoded data according to Embodiment 2;

(27) FIG. 26 is a diagram illustrating a structure example of encoded data and a NAL unit according to Embodiment 2;

(28) FIG. 27 is a diagram illustrating a semantics example of pcc_nal_unit_type according to Embodiment 2;

(29) FIG. 28 is a diagram illustrating an example of a transmitting order of NAL units according to Embodiment 2;

(30) FIG. 29 is a flowchart of processing performed by a three-dimensional data encoding device according to Embodiment 2;

(31) FIG. 30 is a flowchart of processing performed by a three-dimensional data decoding device according to Embodiment 2;

(32) FIG. 31 is a flowchart of multiplexing processing according to Embodiment 2;

(33) FIG. 32 is a flowchart of demultiplexing processing according to Embodiment 2;

(34) FIG. 33 is a diagram illustrating an example of three-dimensional points according to Embodiment 3;

(35) FIG. 34 is a diagram illustrating an example of setting LoDs according to Embodiment 3;

(36) FIG. 35 is a diagram illustrating an example of setting LoDs according to Embodiment 3;

(37) FIG. 36 is a diagram illustrating an example of attribute information to be used for predicted values according to Embodiment 3;

(38) FIG. 37 is a diagram illustrating examples of exponential-Golomb codes according to Embodiment 3;

(39) FIG. 38 is a diagram indicating a process on exponential-Golomb codes according to Embodiment 3;

(40) FIG. 39 is a diagram indicating an example of a syntax in attribute header according to Embodiment 3;

(41) FIG. 40 is a diagram indicating an example of a syntax in attribute data according to Embodiment 3;

(42) FIG. 41 is a flowchart of a three-dimensional data encoding process according to Embodiment 3;

(43) FIG. 42 is a flowchart of an attribute information encoding process according to Embodiment 3;

(44) FIG. 43 is a diagram indicating processing on exponential-Golomb codes according to Embodiment 3;

(45) FIG. 44 is a diagram indicating an example of a reverse lookup table indicating relationships between remaining codes and the values thereof according to Embodiment 3;

(46) FIG. 45 is a flowchart of a three-dimensional data decoding process according to Embodiment

3;

(47) FIG. **46** is a flowchart of an attribute information decoding process according to Embodiment 3;

(48) FIG. **47** is a block diagram of a three-dimensional data encoding device according to Embodiment 3;

(49) FIG. **48** is a block diagram of a three-dimensional data decoding device according to Embodiment 3;

(50) FIG. **49** is a diagram showing a first example of a table representing predicted values calculated in prediction modes according to Embodiment 4;

(51) FIG. **50** is a diagram showing examples of attribute information items (pieces of attribute information) used as the predicted values according to Embodiment 4;

(52) FIG. **51** is a diagram showing a second example of a table representing predicted values calculated in the prediction modes according to Embodiment 4;

(53) FIG. **52** is a diagram showing a third example of a table representing predicted values calculated in the prediction modes according to Embodiment 4;

(54) FIG. **53** is a diagram showing a fourth example of a table representing predicted values calculated in the prediction modes according to Embodiment 4;

(55) FIG. **54** is a diagram showing a fifth example of a table representing predicted values calculated in the prediction modes according to Embodiment 4;

(56) FIG. **55** is a diagram showing a sixth example of a table representing predicted values calculated in the prediction modes according to Embodiment 4;

(57) FIG. **56** is a diagram showing a seventh example of a table representing predicted values calculated in the prediction modes according to Embodiment 4;

(58) FIG. **57** is a diagram showing an eighth example of a table representing predicted values calculated in the prediction modes according to Embodiment 4;

(59) FIG. **58** is a diagram showing a first example of a binarization table in binarizing and encoding prediction mode values according to Embodiment 4;

(60) FIG. **59** is a diagram showing a second example of a binarization table in binarizing and encoding the prediction mode values according to Embodiment 4;

(61) FIG. **60** is a diagram showing a third example of a binarization table in binarizing and encoding the prediction mode values according to Embodiment 4;

(62) FIG. **61** is a diagram for describing an example of encoding binary data in the binarization table in binarizing and encoding the prediction modes according to Embodiment 4;

(63) FIG. **62** is a flowchart of an example of encoding a prediction mode value according to Embodiment 4;

(64) FIG. **63** is a flowchart of an example of decoding a prediction mode value according to Embodiment 4;

(65) FIG. **64** is a diagram showing another example of a table representing predicted values calculated in the prediction modes according to Embodiment 4;

(66) FIG. **65** is a diagram for describing an example of encoding binary data in the binarization table in binarizing and encoding the prediction modes according to Embodiment 4;

(67) FIG. **66** is flowchart of another example of encoding a prediction mode value according to Embodiment 4;

(68) FIG. **67** is a flowchart of another example of decoding a prediction mode value according to Embodiment 4;

(69) FIG. **68** is a flowchart of an example of a process of determining whether or not a prediction mode value is fixed under condition A in encoding according to Embodiment 4;

(70) FIG. **69** is a flowchart of an example of a process of determining whether the prediction mode value is fixed or decoded under condition A in decoding according to Embodiment 4;

(71) FIG. **70** is a diagram for describing maximum absolute differential value maxdiff according to

Embodiment 4;

(72) FIG. **71** is a diagram showing an example of a syntax according to Embodiment 4;

(73) FIG. **72** is a diagram showing an example of a syntax according to Embodiment 4;

(74) FIG. **73** is a flowchart of a three-dimensional data encoding process by a three-dimensional data encoding device according to Embodiment 4;

(75) FIG. **74** is a flowchart of an attribute information encoding process according to Embodiment 4;

(76) FIG. **75** is a flowchart of a predicted value calculation process by the three-dimensional data encoding device according to Embodiment 4;

(77) FIG. **76** is a flowchart of a prediction mode selection process according to Embodiment 4;

(78) FIG. **77** is a flowchart of a prediction mode selection process that minimizes cost according to Embodiment 4;

(79) FIG. **78** is a flowchart of a three-dimensional data decoding process by a three-dimensional data decoding device according to Embodiment 4;

(80) FIG. **79** is a flowchart of an attribute information decoding process according to Embodiment 4;

(81) FIG. **80** is a flowchart of a predicted value calculation process by the three-dimensional data decoding device according to Embodiment 4;

(82) FIG. **81** is a flowchart of a prediction mode decoding process according to Embodiment 4;

(83) FIG. **82** is a block diagram showing a configuration of an attribute information encoder included in the three-dimensional data encoding device according to Embodiment 4;

(84) FIG. **83** is a block diagram showing a configuration of an attribute information decoder included in the three-dimensional data decoding device according to Embodiment 4;

(85) FIG. **84** is a flowchart of a prediction mode determination process performed by a three-dimensional data encoding device according to Embodiment 5;

(86) FIG. **85** is a diagram showing an example of a syntax of the prediction mode determination process performed by the three-dimensional data encoding device according to Embodiment 5;

(87) FIG. **86** is a flowchart of a prediction mode determination process performed by a three-dimensional data decoding device according to Embodiment 5;

(88) FIG. **87** is a diagram showing an example of a syntax of attribute data when a prediction mode fixing flag is provided for each three-dimensional point according to Embodiment 5;

(89) FIG. **88** is a diagram showing an example of a syntax of attribute data when a prediction mode fixing flag is provided for each LoD according to Embodiment 5;

(90) FIG. **89** is a flowchart of an example of a prediction mode encoding process by the three-dimensional data encoding device according to Embodiment 5;

(91) FIG. **90** is a flowchart of an example of a prediction mode decoding process by the three-dimensional data decoding device according to Embodiment 5;

(92) FIG. **91** is a flowchart of a three-dimensional data encoding process by the three-dimensional data encoding device according to Embodiment 5;

(93) FIG. **92** is a flowchart of an attribute information encoding process shown in FIG. **91**;

(94) FIG. **93** is a flowchart of a predicted-value calculation process shown in FIG. **92**;

(95) FIG. **94** is a flowchart of a prediction mode selection process shown in FIG. **93**;

(96) FIG. **95** is a flowchart of a specific example of the prediction mode selection process shown in FIG. **94**;

(97) FIG. **96** is a flowchart of a three-dimensional data decoding process by the three-dimensional data decoding device according to Embodiment 5;

(98) FIG. **97** is a flowchart of a predicted-value calculation process shown in FIG. **96**;

(99) FIG. **98** is a flowchart of details of the predicted-value calculation process shown in FIG. **97**;

(100) FIG. **99** is a flowchart of a calculation process of a prediction mode and a quantized value shown in FIG. **98**;

(101) FIG. **100** is a flowchart of a process when the three-dimensional data encoding device does not fix a prediction mode according to Embodiment 5;

(102) FIG. **101** is a flowchart of a process when the three-dimensional data decoding device does not fix a prediction mode according to Embodiment 5;

(103) FIG. **102** is a diagram showing another example of a syntax of attribute data according to Embodiment 5;

(104) FIG. **103** is a flowchart of an example of a prediction mode encoding process by the three-dimensional data encoding device according to Embodiment 5;

(105) FIG. **104** is a flowchart of a prediction mode decoding process by the three-dimensional data decoding device according to Embodiment 5;

(106) FIG. **105** is a flowchart of another example of the predicted-value calculation process shown in FIG. **92**;

(107) FIG. **106** is a flowchart of a prediction mode selection process shown in FIG. **105**;

(108) FIG. **107** is a flowchart of a specific example of the prediction mode selection process shown in FIG. **106**;

(109) FIG. **108** is a flowchart of another example of the calculation process of a prediction mode and a quantized value shown in FIG. **97**;

(110) FIG. **109** is a diagram illustrating an example of a first three-dimensional point and one or more second three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the first three-dimensional point according to Embodiment 6.

(111) FIG. **110** is a diagram illustrating an example of the first three-dimensional point and the one or more second three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the first three-dimensional point according to Embodiment 6.

(112) FIG. **111** is a diagram illustrating an example of the first three-dimensional point and the one or more second three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the first three-dimensional point according to Embodiment 6.

(113) FIG. **112** is a graph illustrating a relation between a cost and a bit count according to Embodiment 6.

(114) FIG. **113** is a graph illustrating results of changing an offset according to Embodiment 6.

(115) FIG. **114** is a graph illustrating results of changing λ according to Embodiment 6.

(116) FIG. **115** is a diagram illustrating a first example of a binarization table in the case where a prediction mode value is binarized and encoded according to Embodiment 6.

(117) FIG. **116** is a diagram illustrating a second example of the binarization table in the case where the prediction mode value is binarized and encoded according to Embodiment 6.

(118) FIG. **117** is a diagram illustrating a third example of the binarization table in the case where the prediction mode value is binarized and encoded according to Embodiment 6.

(119) FIG. **118** is a flowchart illustrating a method of determining whether or not to fix a prediction mode by a three-dimensional data encoding device according to Embodiment 6.

(120) FIG. **119** is a flowchart illustrating a decoding method by a three-dimensional data decoding device according to Embodiment 6.

(121) FIG. **120** is a flowchart of a three-dimensional data encoding process according to Embodiment 6.

(122) FIG. **121** is a flowchart of a three-dimensional data decoding process according to Embodiment 6.

(123) FIG. **122** is a block diagram of a three-dimensional data creation device according to Embodiment 7;

(124) FIG. **123** is a flowchart of a three-dimensional data creation method according to Embodiment 7;

(125) FIG. **124** is a diagram showing a structure of a system according to Embodiment 7;

(126) FIG. **125** is a block diagram of a client device according to Embodiment 7;

- (127) FIG. **126** is a block diagram of a server according to Embodiment 7;
- (128) FIG. **127** is a flowchart of a three-dimensional data creation process performed by the client device according to Embodiment 7;
- (129) FIG. **128** is a flowchart of a sensor information transmission process performed by the client device according to Embodiment 7;
- (130) FIG. **129** is a flowchart of a three-dimensional data creation process performed by the server according to Embodiment 7;
- (131) FIG. **130** is a flowchart of a three-dimensional map transmission process performed by the server according to Embodiment 7;
- (132) FIG. **131** is a diagram showing a structure of a variation of the system according to Embodiment 7;
- (133) FIG. **132** is a diagram showing a structure of the server and client devices according to Embodiment 7;
- (134) FIG. **133** is a diagram illustrating a configuration of a server and a client device according to Embodiment 7;
- (135) FIG. **134** is a flowchart of a process performed by the client device according to Embodiment 7;
- (136) FIG. **135** is a diagram illustrating a configuration of a sensor information collection system according to Embodiment 7;
- (137) FIG. **136** is a diagram illustrating an example of a system according to Embodiment 7;
- (138) FIG. **137** is a diagram illustrating a variation of the system according to Embodiment 7;
- (139) FIG. **138** is a flowchart illustrating an example of an application process according to Embodiment 7;
- (140) FIG. **139** is a diagram illustrating the sensor range of various sensors according to Embodiment 7;
- (141) FIG. **140** is a diagram illustrating a configuration example of an automated driving system according to Embodiment 7;
- (142) FIG. **141** is a diagram illustrating a configuration example of a bitstream according to Embodiment 7;
- (143) FIG. **142** is a flowchart of a point cloud selection process according to Embodiment 7;
- (144) FIG. **143** is a diagram illustrating a screen example for point cloud selection process according to Embodiment 7;
- (145) FIG. **144** is a diagram illustrating a screen example of the point cloud selection process according to Embodiment 7; and
- (146) FIG. **145** is a diagram illustrating a screen example of the point cloud selection process according to Embodiment 7.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

(147) In accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure, a three-dimensional data encoding method of encoding three-dimensional points includes: calculating a predicted value of attribute information of a first three-dimensional point in a prediction mode for calculating the predicted value, using one or more items of attribute information of one or more second three-dimensional points in a vicinity of the first three-dimensional point, the first three-dimensional point and the one or more second three-dimensional points being included in the three-dimensional points; calculating a prediction residual that is a difference between the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point and the predicted value calculated; and generating a bitstream including the prediction residual and prediction mode information indicating the prediction mode, wherein the prediction mode is: one prediction mode among two or more prediction modes when a type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is first attribute information including elements a total number of which is greater than a predetermined threshold value; and one fixed prediction mode when the type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is

second attribute information including elements a total number of which is smaller than or equal to the predetermined threshold value.

(148) By the above-described three-dimensional data encoding method, attribute information including many elements can be encoded by one prediction mode selected from two or more prediction modes, thereby reducing overhead and increasing the encoding efficiency of the attribute information.

(149) For example, it is possible that the bitstream indicates whether or not the prediction mode is the one fixed prediction mode.

(150) For example, it is possible that the predetermined threshold value is 1.

(151) For example, it is possible that the bitstream does not include the prediction mode information when the one prediction mode is the one fixed prediction mode.

(152) For example, it is possible that the predicted value is an average value of the one or more items of attribute information of the one or more second three-dimensional points, when a value indicated by the prediction mode information is 0.

(153) For example, it is possible that the first attribute information is color information indicating color of a three-dimensional point, and that the second attribute information is information indicating a reflectance of a three-dimensional point.

(154) In accordance with another aspect of the present disclosure, a three-dimensional data decoding method of decoding three-dimensional points includes: obtaining a prediction residual and prediction mode information indicating a prediction mode for a first three-dimensional point among the three-dimensional points, by obtaining a bitstream; calculating a predicted value in the prediction mode indicated by the prediction mode information; and calculating attribute information of the first three-dimensional point by adding the predicted value to the prediction residual, wherein the prediction mode is: one prediction mode among two or more prediction modes when a type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is first attribute information including elements a total number of which is greater than a predetermined threshold value; and one fixed prediction mode when the type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is second attribute information including elements a total number of which is smaller than or equal to the predetermined threshold value.

(155) By the above-described three-dimensional data decoding method, it is possible to appropriately decode attribute information that has been encoded using the predicted value in the prediction mode indicated by the bitstream.

(156) For example, it is possible that the bitstream indicates whether or not the one prediction mode is the one fixed prediction mode, and that the calculating of the predicted value is performed: in the prediction mode indicated in the prediction mode information when the bitstream indicates that the one prediction mode is different from the one fixed prediction mode; and in the one fixed prediction mode when the bitstream indicates that the one prediction mode is the one fixed prediction mode.

(157) For example, it is possible that the predetermined threshold value is 1.

(158) For example, it is possible that the calculating of the predicted value is performed in the one fixed prediction mode when the bitstream does not include the prediction mode information.

(159) For example, it is possible that the predicted value is an average value of one or more items of attribute information of one or more second three-dimensional points in a vicinity of the first three-dimensional point, when a value indicated by the prediction mode information is 0.

(160) For example, it is possible that the first attribute information is color information indicating color of a three-dimensional point, and that the second attribute information is information indicating a reflectance of a three-dimensional point.

(161) In accordance with still another aspect of the present disclosure, a three-dimensional data encoding device that encodes three-dimensional points includes: a processor; and memory, wherein using the memory, the processor: calculates a predicted value of attribute information of a first

three-dimensional point in a prediction mode for calculating the predicted value, using one or more items of attribute information of one or more second three-dimensional points in a vicinity of the first three-dimensional point, the first three-dimensional point and the one or more second three-dimensional points being included in the three-dimensional points; calculates a prediction residual that is a difference between the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point and the predicted value calculated; and generates a bitstream including the prediction residual and prediction mode information indicating the prediction mode, wherein the prediction mode is: one prediction mode among two or more prediction modes when a type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is first attribute information including elements a total number of which is greater than a predetermined threshold value; and one fixed prediction mode when the type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is second attribute information including elements a total number of which is smaller than or equal to the predetermined threshold value.

(162) The above-described three-dimensional data encoding device can encode attribute information including many elements by one prediction mode selected from two or more prediction modes, thereby reducing overhead and increasing the encoding efficiency of the attribute information.

(163) In accordance with still another aspect of the present disclosure, a three-dimensional data decoding device that decodes three-dimensional points includes: a processor; and memory, wherein using the memory, the processor: obtains a prediction residual and prediction mode information indicating a prediction mode for a first three-dimensional point among the three-dimensional points, by obtaining a bitstream; calculates a predicted value in the prediction mode indicated by the prediction mode information; and calculates attribute information of the first three-dimensional point by adding the predicted value to the prediction residual, wherein the prediction mode is: one prediction mode among two or more prediction modes when a type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is first attribute information including elements a total number of which is greater than a predetermined threshold value; and one fixed prediction mode when the type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is second attribute information including elements a total number of which is smaller than or equal to the predetermined threshold value.

(164) The above-described three-dimensional data decoding device can appropriately decode attribute information that has been encoded using the predicted value in the prediction mode indicated by the bitstream.

(165) It is to be noted that these general or specific aspects may be implemented as a system, a method, an integrated circuit, a computer program, or a computer-readable recording medium such as a CD-ROM, or may be implemented as any combination of a system, a method, an integrated circuit, a computer program, and a recording medium.

(166) Hereinafter, embodiments will be specifically described with reference to the drawings. It is to be noted that each of the following embodiments indicate a specific example of the present disclosure. The numerical values, shapes, materials, constituent elements, the arrangement and connection of the constituent elements, steps, the processing order of the steps, etc., indicated in the following embodiments are mere examples, and thus are not intended to limit the present disclosure. Among the constituent elements described in the following embodiments, constituent elements not recited in any one of the independent claims will be described as optional constituent elements.

Embodiment 1

(167) When using encoded data of a point cloud in a device or for a service in practice, required information for the application is desirably transmitted and received in order to reduce the network bandwidth. However, conventional encoding structures for three-dimensional data have no such a function, and there is also no encoding method for such a function.

(168) Embodiment 1 described below relates to a three-dimensional data encoding method and a three-dimensional data encoding device for encoded data of a three-dimensional point cloud that provides a function of transmitting and receiving required information for an application, a three-dimensional data decoding method and a three-dimensional data decoding device for decoding the encoded data, a three-dimensional data multiplexing method for multiplexing the encoded data, and a three-dimensional data transmission method for transmitting the encoded data.

(169) In particular, at present, a first encoding method and a second encoding method are under investigation as encoding methods (encoding schemes) for point cloud data. However, there is no method defined for storing the configuration of encoded data and the encoded data in a system format. Thus, there is a problem that an encoder cannot perform an MUX process (multiplexing), transmission, or accumulation of data.

(170) In addition, there is no method for supporting a format that involves two codecs, the first encoding method and the second encoding method, such as point cloud compression (PCC).

(171) With regard to this embodiment, a configuration of PCC-encoded data that involves two codecs, a first encoding method and a second encoding method, and a method of storing the encoded data in a system format will be described.

(172) A configuration of a three-dimensional data (point cloud data) encoding and decoding system according to this embodiment will be first described. FIG. 1 is a diagram showing an example of a configuration of the three-dimensional data encoding and decoding system according to this embodiment. As shown in FIG. 1, the three-dimensional data encoding and decoding system includes three-dimensional data encoding system **4601**, three-dimensional data decoding system **4602**, sensor terminal **4603**, and external connector **4604**.

(173) Three-dimensional data encoding system **4601** generates encoded data or multiplexed data by encoding point cloud data, which is three-dimensional data. Three-dimensional data encoding system **4601** may be a three-dimensional data encoding device implemented by a single device or a system implemented by a plurality of devices. The three-dimensional data encoding device may include a part of a plurality of processors included in three-dimensional data encoding system **4601**.

(174) Three-dimensional data encoding system **4601** includes point cloud data generation system **4611**, presenter **4612**, encoder **4613**, multiplexer **4614**, input/output unit **4615**, and controller **4616**. Point cloud data generation system **4611** includes sensor information obtainer **4617**, and point cloud data generator **4618**.

(175) Sensor information obtainer **4617** obtains sensor information from sensor terminal **4603**, and outputs the sensor information to point cloud data generator **4618**. Point cloud data generator **4618** generates point cloud data from the sensor information, and outputs the point cloud data to encoder **4613**.

(176) Presenter **4612** presents the sensor information or point cloud data to a user. For example, presenter **4612** displays information or an image based on the sensor information or point cloud data.

(177) Encoder **4613** encodes (compresses) the point cloud data, and outputs the resulting encoded data, control information (signaling information) obtained in the course of the encoding, and other additional information to multiplexer **4614**. The additional information includes the sensor information, for example.

(178) Multiplexer **4614** generates multiplexed data by multiplexing the encoded data, the control information, and the additional information input thereto from encoder **4613**. A format of the multiplexed data is a file format for accumulation or a packet format for transmission, for example.

(179) Input/output unit **4615** (a communication unit or interface, for example) outputs the multiplexed data to the outside. Alternatively, the multiplexed data may be accumulated in an accumulator, such as an internal memory. Controller **4616** (or an application executor) controls each processor. That is, controller **4616** controls the encoding, the multiplexing, or other

processing.

(180) Note that the sensor information may be input to encoder **4613** or multiplexer **4614**.

Alternatively, input/output unit **4615** may output the point cloud data or encoded data to the outside as it is.

(181) A transmission signal (multiplexed data) output from three-dimensional data encoding system **4601** is input to three-dimensional data decoding system **4602** via external connector **4604**.

(182) Three-dimensional data decoding system **4602** generates point cloud data, which is three-dimensional data, by decoding the encoded data or multiplexed data. Note that three-dimensional data decoding system **4602** may be a three-dimensional data decoding device implemented by a single device or a system implemented by a plurality of devices. The three-dimensional data decoding device may include a part of a plurality of processors included in three-dimensional data decoding system **4602**.

(183) Three-dimensional data decoding system **4602** includes sensor information obtainer **4621**, input/output unit **4622**, demultiplexer **4623**, decoder **4624**, presenter **4625**, user interface **4626**, and controller **4627**.

(184) Sensor information obtainer **4621** obtains sensor information from sensor terminal **4603**.

(185) Input/output unit **4622** obtains the transmission signal, decodes the transmission signal into the multiplexed data (file format or packet), and outputs the multiplexed data to demultiplexer **4623**.

(186) Demultiplexer **4623** obtains the encoded data, the control information, and the additional information from the multiplexed data, and outputs the encoded data, the control information, and the additional information to decoder **4624**.

(187) Decoder **4624** reconstructs the point cloud data by decoding the encoded data.

(188) Presenter **4625** presents the point cloud data to a user. For example, presenter **4625** displays information or an image based on the point cloud data. User interface **4626** obtains an indication based on a manipulation by the user. Controller **4627** (or an application executor) controls each processor. That is, controller **4627** controls the demultiplexing, the decoding, the presentation, or other processing.

(189) Note that input/output unit **4622** may obtain the point cloud data or encoded data as it is from the outside. Presenter **4625** may obtain additional information, such as sensor information, and present information based on the additional information. Presenter **4625** may perform a presentation based on an indication from a user obtained on user interface **4626**.

(190) Sensor terminal **4603** generates sensor information, which is information obtained by a sensor. Sensor terminal **4603** is a terminal provided with a sensor or a camera. For example, sensor terminal **4603** is a mobile body, such as an automobile, a flying object, such as an aircraft, a mobile terminal, or a camera.

(191) Sensor information that can be generated by sensor terminal **4603** includes (1) the distance between sensor terminal **4603** and an object or the reflectance of the object obtained by LiDAR, a millimeter wave radar, or an infrared sensor or (2) the distance between a camera and an object or the reflectance of the object obtained by a plurality of monocular camera images or a stereo-camera image, for example. The sensor information may include the posture, orientation, gyro (angular velocity), position (GPS information or altitude), velocity, or acceleration of the sensor, for example. The sensor information may include air temperature, air pressure, air humidity, or magnetism, for example.

(192) External connector **4604** is implemented by an integrated circuit (LSI or IC), an external accumulator, communication with a cloud server via the Internet, or broadcasting, for example.

(193) Next, point cloud data will be described. FIG. 2 is a diagram showing a configuration of point cloud data. FIG. 3 is a diagram showing a configuration example of a data file describing information of the point cloud data.

(194) Point cloud data includes data on a plurality of points. Data on each point includes geometry

information (three-dimensional coordinates) and attribute information associated with the geometry information. A set of a plurality of such points is referred to as a point cloud. For example, a point cloud indicates a three-dimensional shape of an object.

(195) Geometry information (position), such as three-dimensional coordinates, may be referred to as geometry. Data on each point may include attribute information (attribute) on a plurality of types of attributes. A type of attribute is color or reflectance, for example.

(196) One item of attribute information (in other words, a piece of attribute information or an attribute information item) may be associated with one item of geometry information (in other words, a piece of geometry information or a geometry information item), or attribute information on a plurality of different types of attributes may be associated with one item of geometry information. Alternatively, items of attribute information on the same type of attribute may be associated with one item of geometry information.

(197) The configuration example of a data file shown in FIG. 3 is an example in which geometry information and attribute information are associated with each other in a one-to-one relationship, and geometry information and attribute information on N points forming point cloud data are shown.

(198) The geometry information is information on three axes, specifically, an x-axis, a y-axis, and a z-axis, for example. The attribute information is RGB color information, for example. A representative data file is ply file, for example.

(199) Next, types of point cloud data will be described. FIG. 4 is a diagram showing types of point cloud data. As shown in FIG. 4, point cloud data includes a static object and a dynamic object.

(200) The static object is three-dimensional point cloud data at an arbitrary time (a time point). The dynamic object is three-dimensional point cloud data that varies with time. In the following, three-dimensional point cloud data associated with a time point will be referred to as a PCC frame or a frame.

(201) The object may be a point cloud whose range is limited to some extent, such as ordinary video data, or may be a large point cloud whose range is not limited, such as map information.

(202) There are point cloud data having varying densities. There may be sparse point cloud data and dense point cloud data.

(203) In the following, each processor will be described in detail. Sensor information is obtained by various means, including a distance sensor such as LiDAR or a range finder, a stereo camera, or a combination of a plurality of monocular cameras. Point cloud data generator **4618** generates point cloud data based on the sensor information obtained by sensor information obtainer **4617**. Point cloud data generator **4618** generates geometry information as point cloud data, and adds attribute information associated with the geometry information to the geometry information.

(204) When generating geometry information or adding attribute information, point cloud data generator **4618** may process the point cloud data. For example, point cloud data generator **4618** may reduce the data amount by omitting a point cloud whose position coincides with the position of another point cloud. Point cloud data generator **4618** may also convert the geometry information (such as shifting, rotating or normalizing the position) or render the attribute information.

(205) Note that, although FIG. 1 shows point cloud data generation system **4611** as being included in three-dimensional data encoding system **4601**, point cloud data generation system **4611** may be independently provided outside three-dimensional data encoding system **4601**.

(206) Encoder **4613** generates encoded data by encoding point cloud data according to an encoding method previously defined. In general, there are the two types of encoding methods described below. One is an encoding method using geometry information, which will be referred to as a first encoding method, hereinafter. The other is an encoding method using a video codec, which will be referred to as a second encoding method, hereinafter.

(207) Decoder **4624** decodes the encoded data into the point cloud data using the encoding method previously defined.

(208) Multiplexer **4614** generates multiplexed data by multiplexing the encoded data in an existing multiplexing method. The generated multiplexed data is transmitted or accumulated. Multiplexer **4614** multiplexes not only the PCC-encoded data but also another medium, such as a video, an audio, subtitles, an application, or a file, or reference time information. Multiplexer **4614** may further multiplex attribute information associated with sensor information or point cloud data.

(209) Multiplexing schemes or file formats include ISOBMFF, MPEG-DASH, which is a transmission scheme based on ISOBMFF, MMT, MPEG-2 TS Systems, or RMP, for example.

(210) Demultiplexer **4623** extracts PCC-encoded data, other media, time information and the like from the multiplexed data.

(211) Input/output unit **4615** transmits the multiplexed data in a method suitable for the transmission medium or accumulation medium, such as broadcasting or communication. Input/output unit **4615** may communicate with another device over the Internet or communicate with an accumulator, such as a cloud server.

(212) As a communication protocol, http, ftp, TCP, UDP or the like is used. The pull communication scheme or the push communication scheme can be used.

(213) A wired transmission or a wireless transmission can be used. For the wired transmission, Ethernet (registered trademark), USB, RS-232C, HDMI (registered trademark), or a coaxial cable is used, for example. For the wireless transmission, wireless LAN, Wi-Fi (registered trademark), Bluetooth (registered trademark), or a millimeter wave is used, for example.

(214) As a broadcasting scheme, DVB-T2, DVB-S2, DVB-C2, ATSC3.0, or ISDB-S3 is used, for example.

(215) FIG. 5 is a diagram showing a configuration of first encoder **4630**, which is an example of encoder **4613** that performs encoding in the first encoding method. FIG. 6 is a block diagram showing first encoder **4630**. First encoder **4630** generates encoded data (encoded stream) by encoding point cloud data in the first encoding method. First encoder **4630** includes geometry information encoder **4631**, attribute information encoder **4632**, additional information encoder **4633**, and multiplexer **4634**.

(216) First encoder **4630** is characterized by performing encoding by keeping a three-dimensional structure in mind. First encoder **4630** is further characterized in that attribute information encoder **4632** performs encoding using information obtained from geometry information encoder **4631**. The first encoding method is referred to also as geometry-based PCC (GPCC).

(217) Point cloud data is PCC point cloud data like a PLY file or PCC point cloud data generated from sensor information, and includes geometry information (position), attribute information (attribute), and other additional information (metadata). The geometry information is input to geometry information encoder **4631**, the attribute information is input to attribute information encoder **4632**, and the additional information is input to additional information encoder **4633**.

(218) Geometry information encoder **4631** generates encoded geometry information (compressed geometry), which is encoded data, by encoding geometry information. For example, geometry information encoder **4631** encodes geometry information using an N-ary tree structure, such as an octree. Specifically, in the case of an octree, a current space (target space) is divided into eight nodes (subspaces), 8-bit information (occupancy code) that indicates whether each node includes a point cloud or not is generated. A node including a point cloud is further divided into eight nodes, and 8-bit information that indicates whether each of the eight nodes includes a point cloud or not is generated. This process is repeated until a predetermined level is reached or the number of the point clouds included in each node becomes equal to or less than a threshold.

(219) Attribute information encoder **4632** generates encoded attribute information (compressed attribute), which is encoded data, by encoding attribute information using configuration information generated by geometry information encoder **4631**. For example, attribute information encoder **4632** determines a reference point (reference node) that is to be referred to in encoding a current point (in other words, a current node or a target node) to be processed based on the octree

structure generated by geometry information encoder **4631**. For example, attribute information encoder **4632** refers to a node whose parent node in the octree is the same as the parent node of the current node, of peripheral nodes or neighboring nodes. Note that the method of determining a reference relationship is not limited to this method.

(220) The process of encoding attribute information may include at least one of a quantization process, a prediction process, and an arithmetic encoding process. In this case, “refer to” means using a reference node for calculating a predicted value of attribute information or using a state of a reference node (occupancy information that indicates whether a reference node includes a point cloud or not, for example) for determining a parameter of encoding. For example, the parameter of encoding is a quantization parameter in the quantization process or a context or the like in the arithmetic encoding.

(221) Additional information encoder **4633** generates encoded additional information (compressed metadata), which is encoded data, by encoding compressible data of additional information.

(222) Multiplexer **4634** generates encoded stream (compressed stream), which is encoded data, by multiplexing encoded geometry information, encoded attribute information, encoded additional information, and other additional information. The generated encoded stream is output to a processor in a system layer (not shown).

(223) Next, first decoder **4640**, which is an example of decoder **4624** that performs decoding in the first encoding method, will be described. FIG. 7 is a diagram showing a configuration of first decoder **4640**. FIG. 8 is a block diagram showing first decoder **4640**. First decoder **4640** generates point cloud data by decoding encoded data (encoded stream) encoded in the first encoding method in the first encoding method. First decoder **4640** includes demultiplexer **4641**, geometry information decoder **4642**, attribute information decoder **4643**, and additional information decoder **4644**.

(224) An encoded stream (compressed stream), which is encoded data, is input to first decoder **4640** from a processor in a system layer (not shown).

(225) Demultiplexer **4641** separates encoded geometry information (compressed geometry), encoded attribute information (compressed attribute), encoded additional information (compressed metadata), and other additional information from the encoded data.

(226) Geometry information decoder **4642** generates geometry information by decoding the encoded geometry information. For example, geometry information decoder **4642** restores the geometry information on a point cloud represented by three-dimensional coordinates from encoded geometry information represented by an N-ary structure, such as an octree.

(227) Attribute information decoder **4643** decodes the encoded attribute information based on configuration information generated by geometry information decoder **4642**. For example, attribute information decoder **4643** determines a reference point (reference node) that is to be referred to in decoding a current point (current node) to be processed based on the octree structure generated by geometry information decoder **4642**. For example, attribute information decoder **4643** refers to a node whose parent node in the octree is the same as the parent node of the current node, of peripheral nodes or neighboring nodes. Note that the method of determining a reference relationship is not limited to this method.

(228) The process of decoding attribute information may include at least one of an inverse quantization process, a prediction process, and an arithmetic decoding process. In this case, “refer to” means using a reference node for calculating a predicted value of attribute information or using a state of a reference node (occupancy information that indicates whether a reference node includes a point cloud or not, for example) for determining a parameter of decoding. For example, the parameter of decoding is a quantization parameter in the inverse quantization process or a context or the like in the arithmetic decoding.

(229) Additional information decoder **4644** generates additional information by decoding the encoded additional information. First decoder **4640** uses additional information required for the

decoding process for the geometry information and the attribute information in the decoding, and outputs additional information required for an application to the outside.

(230) Next, an example configuration of a geometry information encoder will be described. FIG. 9 is a block diagram of geometry information encoder **2700** according to this embodiment. Geometry information encoder **2700** includes octree generator **2701**, geometry information calculator **2702**, encoding table selector **2703**, and entropy encoder **2704**.

(231) Octree generator **2701** generates an octree, for example, from input position information, and generates an occupancy code of each node of the octree. Geometry information calculator **2702** obtains information that indicates whether a neighboring node of a current node (target node) is an occupied node or not. For example, geometry information calculator **2702** calculates occupancy information on a neighboring node from an occupancy code of a parent node to which a current node belongs (information that indicates whether a neighboring node is an occupied node or not). Geometry information calculator **2702** may save an encoded node in a list and search the list for a neighboring node. Note that geometry information calculator **2702** may change neighboring nodes in accordance with the position of the current node in the parent node.

(232) Encoding table selector **2703** selects an encoding table used for entropy encoding of the current node based on the occupancy information on the neighboring node calculated by geometry information calculator **2702**. For example, encoding table selector **2703** may generate a bit sequence based on the occupancy information on the neighboring node and select an encoding table of an index number generated from the bit sequence.

(233) Entropy encoder **2704** generates encoded geometry information and metadata by entropy-encoding the occupancy code of the current node using the encoding table of the selected index number. Entropy encoder may add, to the encoded geometry information, information that indicates the selected encoding table.

(234) In the following, an octree representation and a scan order for geometry information will be described. Geometry information (geometry data) is transformed into an octree structure (octree transform) and then encoded. The octree structure includes nodes and leaves. Each node has eight nodes or leaves, and each leaf has voxel (VXL) information. FIG. 10 is a diagram showing an example structure of geometry information including a plurality of voxels. FIG. 11 is a diagram showing an example in which the geometry information shown in FIG. 10 is transformed into an octree structure. Here, of leaves shown in FIG. 11, leaves 1, 2, and 3 represent voxels VXL1, VXL2, and VXL3 shown in FIG. 10, respectively, and each represent VXL containing a point cloud (referred to as a valid VXL, hereinafter).

(235) Specifically, node **1** corresponds to the entire space comprising the geometry information in FIG. 10. The entire space corresponding to node **1** is divided into eight nodes, and among the eight nodes, a node containing valid VXL is further divided into eight nodes or leaves. This process is repeated for every layer of the tree structure. Here, each node corresponds to a subspace, and has information (occupancy code) that indicates where the next node or leaf is located after division as node information. A block in the bottom layer is designated as a leaf and retains the number of the points contained in the leaf as leaf information.

(236) Next, an example configuration of a geometry information decoder will be described. FIG. 12 is a block diagram of geometry information decoder **2710** according to this embodiment. Geometry information decoder **2710** includes octree generator **2711**, geometry information calculator **2712**, encoding table selector **2713**, and entropy decoder **2714**.

(237) Octree generator **2711** generates an octree of a space (node) based on header information, metadata or the like of a bitstream. For example, octree generator **2711** generates an octree by generating a large space (root node) based on the sizes of a space in an x-axis direction, a y-axis direction, and a z-axis direction added to the header information and dividing the space into two parts in the x-axis direction, the y-axis direction, and the z-axis direction to generate eight small spaces A (nodes A0 to A7). Nodes A0 to A7 are sequentially designated as a current node.

(238) Geometry information calculator **2712** obtains occupancy information that indicates whether a neighboring node of a current node is an occupied node or not. For example, geometry information calculator **2712** calculates occupancy information on a neighboring node from an occupancy code of a parent node to which a current node belongs. Geometry information calculator **2712** may save a decoded node in a list and search the list for a neighboring node. Note that geometry information calculator **2712** may change neighboring nodes in accordance with the position of the current node in the parent node.

(239) Encoding table selector **2713** selects an encoding table (decoding table) used for entropy decoding of the current node based on the occupancy information on the neighboring node calculated by geometry information calculator **2712**. For example, encoding table selector **2713** may generate a bit sequence based on the occupancy information on the neighboring node and select an encoding table of an index number generated from the bit sequence.

(240) Entropy decoder **2714** generates position information by entropy-decoding the occupancy code of the current node using the selected encoding table. Note that entropy decoder **2714** may obtain information on the selected encoding table by decoding the bitstream, and entropy-decode the occupancy code of the current node using the encoding table indicated by the information.

(241) In the following, configurations of an attribute information encoder and an attribute information decoder will be described. FIG. **13** is a block diagram showing an example configuration of attribute information encoder **A100**. The attribute information encoder may include a plurality of encoders that perform different encoding methods. For example, the attribute information encoder may selectively use any of the two methods described below in accordance with the use case.

(242) Attribute information encoder **A100** includes LoD attribute information encoder **A101** and transformed-attribute-information encoder **A102**. LoD attribute information encoder **A101** classifies three-dimensional points into a plurality of layers based on geometry information on the three-dimensional points, predicts attribute information on three-dimensional points belonging to each layer, and encodes a prediction residual therefor. Here, each layer into which a three-dimensional point is classified is referred to as a level of detail (LoD).

(243) Transformed-attribute-information encoder **A102** encodes attribute information using region adaptive hierarchical transform (RAHT). Specifically, transformed-attribute-information encoder **A102** generates a high frequency component and a low frequency component for each layer by applying RAHT or Haar transform to each item of attribute information based on the geometry information on three-dimensional points, and encodes the values by quantization, entropy encoding or the like.

(244) FIG. **14** is a block diagram showing an example configuration of attribute information decoder **A110**. The attribute information decoder may include a plurality of decoders that perform different decoding methods. For example, the attribute information decoder may selectively use any of the two methods described below for decoding based on the information included in the header or metadata.

(245) Attribute information decoder **A110** includes LoD attribute information decoder **A111** and transformed-attribute-information decoder **A112**. LoD attribute information decoder **A111** classifies three-dimensional points into a plurality of layers based on the geometry information on the three-dimensional points, predicts attribute information on three-dimensional points belonging to each layer, and decodes attribute values thereof.

(246) Transformed-attribute-information decoder **A112** decodes attribute information using region adaptive hierarchical transform (RAHT). Specifically, transformed-attribute-information decoder **A112** decodes each attribute value by applying inverse RAHT or inverse Haar transform to the high frequency component and the low frequency component of the attribute value based on the geometry information on the three-dimensional point.

(247) FIG. **15** is a block diagram showing a configuration of attribute information encoder **3140**

that is an example of LoD attribute information encoder A101.

(248) Attribute information encoder **3140** includes LoD generator **3141**, periphery searcher **3142**, predictor **3143**, prediction residual calculator **3144**, quantizer **3145**, arithmetic encoder **3146**, inverse quantizer **3147**, decoded value generator **3148**, and memory **3149**.

(249) LoD generator **3141** generates an LoD using geometry information on a three-dimensional point.

(250) Periphery searcher **3142** searches for a neighboring three-dimensional point neighboring each three-dimensional point using a result of LoD generation by LoD generator **3141** and distance information indicating distances between three-dimensional points.

(251) Predictor **3143** generates a predicted value of an item of attribute information on a current (target) three-dimensional point to be encoded.

(252) Prediction residual calculator **3144** calculates (generates) a prediction residual of the predicted value of the item of the attribute information generated by predictor **3143**.

(253) Quantizer **3145** quantizes the prediction residual of the item of attribute information calculated by prediction residual calculator **3144**.

(254) Arithmetic encoder **3146** arithmetically encodes the prediction residual quantized by quantizer **3145**. Arithmetic encoder **3146** outputs a bitstream including the arithmetically encoded prediction residual to the three-dimensional data decoding device, for example.

(255) The prediction residual may be binarized by quantizer **3145** before being arithmetically encoded by arithmetic encoder **3146**.

(256) Arithmetic encoder **3146** may initialize the encoding table used for the arithmetic encoding before performing the arithmetic encoding. Arithmetic encoder **3146** may initialize the encoding table used for the arithmetic encoding for each layer. Arithmetic encoder **3146** may output a bitstream including information that indicates the position of the layer at which the encoding table is initialized.

(257) Inverse quantizer **3147** inverse-quantizes the prediction residual quantized by quantizer **3145**.

(258) Decoded value generator **3148** generates a decoded value by adding the predicted value of the item of attribute information generated by predictor **3143** and the prediction residual inverse-quantized by inverse quantizer **3147** together.

(259) Memory **3149** is a memory that stores a decoded value of an item of attribute information on each three-dimensional point decoded by decoded value generator **3148**. For example, when generating a predicted value of a three-dimensional point yet to be encoded, predictor **3143** may generate the predicted value using a decoded value of an item of attribute information on each three-dimensional point stored in memory **3149**.

(260) FIG. **16** is a block diagram of attribute information encoder **6600** that is an example of transformation attribute information encoder A102. Attribute information encoder **6600** includes sorter **6601**, Haar transformer **6602**, quantizer **6603**, inverse quantizer **6604**, inverse Haar transformer **6605**, memory **6606**, and arithmetic encoder **6607**.

(261) Sorter **6601** generates the Morton codes by using the geometry information of three-dimensional points, and sorts the plurality of three-dimensional points in the order of the Morton codes. Haar transformer **6602** generates the coding coefficient by applying the Haar transform to the attribute information. Quantizer **6603** quantizes the coding coefficient of the attribute information.

(262) Inverse quantizer **6604** inverse quantizes the coding coefficient after the quantization. Inverse Haar transformer **6605** applies the inverse Haar transform to the coding coefficient. Memory **6606** stores the values of items of attribute information of a plurality of decoded three-dimensional points. For example, the attribute information of the decoded three-dimensional points stored in memory **6606** may be utilized for prediction and the like of an unencoded three-dimensional point.

(263) Arithmetic encoder **6607** calculates ZeroCnt from the coding coefficient after the quantization, and arithmetically encodes ZeroCnt. Additionally, arithmetic encoder **6607**

arithmetically encodes the non-zero coding coefficient after the quantization. Arithmetic encoder **6607** may binarize the coding coefficient before the arithmetic encoding. In addition, arithmetic encoder **6607** may generate and encode various kinds of header information.

(264) FIG. **17** is a block diagram showing a configuration of attribute information decoder **3150** that is an example of LoD attribute information decoder **A111**.

(265) Attribute information decoder **3150** includes LoD generator **3151**, periphery searcher **3152**, predictor **3153**, arithmetic decoder **3154**, inverse quantizer **3155**, decoded value generator **3156**, and memory **3157**.

(266) LoD generator **3151** generates an LoD using geometry information on a three-dimensional point decoded by the geometry information decoder (not shown in FIG. **17**).

(267) Periphery searcher **3152** searches for a neighboring three-dimensional point neighboring each three-dimensional point using a result of LoD generation by LoD generator **3151** and distance information indicating distances between three-dimensional points.

(268) Predictor **3153** generates a predicted value of attribute information item on a current three-dimensional point to be decoded.

(269) Arithmetic decoder **3154** arithmetically decodes the prediction residual in the bitstream obtained from attribute information encoder **3140** shown in FIG. **15**. Note that arithmetic decoder **3154** may initialize the decoding table used for the arithmetic decoding. Arithmetic decoder **3154** initializes the decoding table used for the arithmetic decoding for the layer for which the encoding process has been performed by arithmetic encoder **3146** shown in FIG. **15**. Arithmetic decoder **3154** may initialize the decoding table used for the arithmetic decoding for each layer. Arithmetic decoder **3154** may initialize the decoding table based on the information included in the bitstream that indicates the position of the layer for which the encoding table has been initialized.

(270) Inverse quantizer **3155** inverse-quantizes the prediction residual arithmetically decoded by arithmetic decoder **3154**.

(271) Decoded value generator **3156** generates a decoded value by adding the predicted value generated by predictor **3153** and the prediction residual inverse-quantized by inverse quantizer **3155** together. Decoded value generator **3156** outputs the decoded attribute information data to another device.

(272) Memory **3157** is a memory that stores a decoded value of an item of attribute information on each three-dimensional point decoded by decoded value generator **3156**. For example, when generating a predicted value of a three-dimensional point yet to be decoded, predictor **3153** generates the predicted value using a decoded value of an item of attribute information on each three-dimensional point stored in memory **3157**.

(273) FIG. **18** is a block diagram of attribute information decoder **6610** that is an example of transformation attribute information decoder **A112**. Attribute information decoder **6610** includes arithmetic decoder **6611**, inverse quantizer **6612**, inverse Haar transformer **6613**, and memory **6614**.

(274) Arithmetic decoder **6611** arithmetically decodes ZeroCnt and the coding coefficient included in a bitstream. Note that arithmetic decoder **6611** may decode various kinds of header information.

(275) Inverse quantizer **6612** inverse quantizes the arithmetically decoded coding coefficient. Inverse Haar transformer **6613** applies the inverse Haar transform to the coding coefficient after the inverse quantization. Memory **6614** stores the values of items of attribute information of a plurality of decoded three-dimensional points. For example, the attribute information of the decoded three-dimensional points stored in memory **6614** may be utilized for prediction of an undecoded three-dimensional point.

(276) Next, second encoder **4650**, which is an example of encoder **4613** that performs encoding in the second encoding method, will be described. FIG. **19** is a diagram showing a configuration of second encoder **4650**. FIG. **20** is a block diagram showing second encoder **4650**.

(277) Second encoder **4650** generates encoded data (encoded stream) by encoding point cloud data

in the second encoding method. Second encoder **4650** includes additional information generator **4651**, geometry image generator **4652**, attribute image generator **4653**, video encoder **4654**, additional information encoder **4655**, and multiplexer **4656**.

(278) Second encoder **4650** is characterized by generating a geometry image and an attribute image by projecting a three-dimensional structure onto a two-dimensional image, and encoding the generated geometry image and attribute image in an existing video encoding scheme. The second encoding method is referred to as video-based PCC (VPCC).

(279) Point cloud data is PCC point cloud data like a PLY file or PCC point cloud data generated from sensor information, and includes geometry information (position), attribute information (attribute), and other additional information (metadata).

(280) Additional information generator **4651** generates map information on a plurality of two-dimensional images by projecting a three-dimensional structure onto a two-dimensional image.

(281) Geometry image generator **4652** generates a geometry image based on the geometry information and the map information generated by additional information generator **4651**. The geometry image is a distance image in which distance (depth) is indicated as a pixel value, for example. The distance image may be an image of a plurality of point clouds viewed from one point of view (an image of a plurality of point clouds projected onto one two-dimensional plane), a plurality of images of a plurality of point clouds viewed from a plurality of points of view, or a single image integrating the plurality of images.

(282) Attribute image generator **4653** generates an attribute image based on the attribute information and the map information generated by additional information generator **4651**. The attribute image is an image in which attribute information (color (RGB), for example) is indicated as a pixel value, for example. The image may be an image of a plurality of point clouds viewed from one point of view (an image of a plurality of point clouds projected onto one two-dimensional plane), a plurality of images of a plurality of point clouds viewed from a plurality of points of view, or a single image integrating the plurality of images.

(283) Video encoder **4654** generates an encoded geometry image (compressed geometry image) and an encoded attribute image (compressed attribute image), which are encoded data, by encoding the geometry image and the attribute image in a video encoding scheme. Note that, as the video encoding scheme, any well-known encoding method can be used. For example, the video encoding scheme is AVC or HEVC.

(284) Additional information encoder **4655** generates encoded additional information (compressed metadata) by encoding the additional information, the map information and the like included in the point cloud data.

(285) Multiplexer **4656** generates an encoded stream (compressed stream), which is encoded data, by multiplexing the encoded geometry image, the encoded attribute image, the encoded additional information, and other additional information. The generated encoded stream is output to a processor in a system layer (not shown).

(286) Next, second decoder **4660**, which is an example of decoder **4624** that performs decoding in the second encoding method, will be described. FIG. 21 is a diagram showing a configuration of second decoder **4660**. FIG. 22 is a block diagram showing second decoder **4660**. Second decoder **4660** generates point cloud data by decoding encoded data (encoded stream) encoded in the second encoding method in the second encoding method. Second decoder **4660** includes demultiplexer **4661**, video decoder **4662**, additional information decoder **4663**, geometry information generator **4664**, and attribute information generator **4665**.

(287) An encoded stream (compressed stream), which is encoded data, is input to second decoder **4660** from a processor in a system layer (not shown).

(288) Demultiplexer **4661** separates an encoded geometry image (compressed geometry image), an encoded attribute image (compressed attribute image), an encoded additional information (compressed metadata), and other additional information from the encoded data.

(289) Video decoder **4662** generates a geometry image and an attribute image by decoding the encoded geometry image and the encoded attribute image in a video encoding scheme. Note that, as the video encoding scheme, any well-known encoding method can be used. For example, the video encoding scheme is AVC or HEVC.

(290) Additional information decoder **4663** generates additional information including map information or the like by decoding the encoded additional information.

(291) Geometry information generator **4664** generates geometry information from the geometry image and the map information. Attribute information generator **4665** generates attribute information from the attribute image and the map information.

(292) Second decoder **4660** uses additional information required for decoding in the decoding, and outputs additional information required for an application to the outside.

(293) In the following, a problem with the PCC encoding scheme will be described. FIG. **23** is a diagram showing a protocol stack relating to PCC-encoded data. FIG. **23** shows an example in which PCC-encoded data is multiplexed with other medium data, such as a video (HEVC, for example) or an audio, and transmitted or accumulated.

(294) A multiplexing scheme and a file format have a function of multiplexing various encoded data and transmitting or accumulating the data. To transmit or accumulate encoded data, the encoded data has to be converted into a format for the multiplexing scheme. For example, with HEVC, a technique for storing encoded data in a data structure referred to as a NAL unit and storing the NAL unit in ISOBMFF is prescribed.

(295) At present, a first encoding method (Codec1) and a second encoding method (Codec2) are under investigation as encoding methods for point cloud data. However, there is no method defined for storing the configuration of encoded data and the encoded data in a system format. Thus, there is a problem that an encoder cannot perform an MUX process (multiplexing), transmission, or accumulation of data.

(296) Note that, in the following, the term “encoding method” means any of the first encoding method and the second encoding method unless a particular encoding method is specified.

Embodiment 2

(297) In this embodiment, types of the encoded data (geometry information (geometry), attribute information (attribute), and additional information (metadata)) generated by first encoder **4630** or second encoder **4650** described above, a method of generating additional information (metadata), and a multiplexing process in the multiplexer will be described. The additional information (metadata) may be referred to as a parameter set or control information (signaling information).

(298) In this embodiment, the dynamic object (three-dimensional point cloud data that varies with time) described above with reference to FIG. **4** will be described, for example. However, the same method can also be used for the static object (three-dimensional point cloud data associated with an arbitrary time point).

(299) FIG. **24** is a diagram showing configurations of encoder **4801** and multiplexer **4802** in a three-dimensional data encoding device according to this embodiment. Encoder **4801** corresponds to first encoder **4630** or second encoder **4650** described above, for example. Multiplexer **4802** corresponds to multiplexer **4634** or **4656** described above.

(300) Encoder **4801** encodes a plurality of PCC (point cloud compression) frames of point cloud data to generate a plurality of pieces of encoded data (multiple compressed data) of geometry information, attribute information, and additional information.

(301) Multiplexer **4802** integrates a plurality of types of data (geometry information, attribute information, and additional information) into a NAL unit, thereby converting the data into a data configuration that takes data access in the decoding device into consideration.

(302) FIG. **25** is a diagram showing a configuration example of the encoded data generated by encoder **4801**. Arrows in the drawing indicate a dependence involved in decoding of the encoded data. The source of an arrow depends on data of the destination of the arrow. That is, the decoding

device decodes the data of the destination of an arrow, and decodes the data of the source of the arrow using the decoded data. In other words, “a first entity depends on a second entity” means that data of the second entity is referred to (used) in processing (encoding, decoding, or the like) of data of the first entity.

(303) First, a process of generating encoded data of geometry information will be described. Encoder **4801** encodes geometry information of each frame to generate encoded geometry data (compressed geometry data) for each frame. The encoded geometry data is denoted by $G(i)$. i denotes a frame number or a time point of a frame, for example.

(304) Furthermore, encoder **4801** generates a geometry parameter set ($GPS(i)$) for each frame. The geometry parameter set includes a parameter that can be used for decoding of the encoded geometry data. The encoded geometry data for each frame depends on an associated geometry parameter set.

(305) The encoded geometry data formed by a plurality of frames is defined as a geometry sequence. Encoder **4801** generates a geometry sequence parameter set (referred to also as geometry sequence PS or geometry SPS) that stores a parameter commonly used for a decoding process for the plurality of frames in the geometry sequence. The geometry sequence depends on the geometry SPS.

(306) Next, a process of generating encoded data of attribute information will be described. Encoder **4801** encodes attribute information of each frame to generate encoded attribute data (compressed attribute data) for each frame. The encoded attribute data is denoted by $A(i)$. FIG. 25 shows an example in which there are attribute X and attribute Y, and encoded attribute data for attribute X is denoted by $AX(i)$, and encoded attribute data for attribute Y is denoted by $AY(i)$.

(307) Furthermore, encoder **4801** generates an attribute parameter set ($APS(i)$) for each frame. The attribute parameter set for attribute X is denoted by $AXPS(i)$, and the attribute parameter set for attribute Y is denoted by $AYPS(i)$. The attribute parameter set includes a parameter that can be used for decoding of the encoded attribute information. The encoded attribute data depends on an associated attribute parameter set.

(308) The encoded attribute data formed by a plurality of frames is defined as an attribute sequence. Encoder **4801** generates an attribute sequence parameter set (referred to also as attribute sequence PS or attribute SPS) that stores a parameter commonly used for a decoding process for the plurality of frames in the attribute sequence. The attribute sequence depends on the attribute SPS.

(309) In the first encoding method, the encoded attribute data depends on the encoded geometry data.

(310) FIG. 25 shows an example in which there are two types of attribute information (attribute X and attribute Y). When there are two types of attribute information, for example, two encoders generate data and metadata for the two types of attribute information. For example, an attribute sequence is defined for each type of attribute information, and an attribute SPS is generated for each type of attribute information.

(311) Note that, although FIG. 25 shows an example in which there is one type of geometry information, and there are two types of attribute information, the present disclosure is not limited thereto. There may be one type of attribute information or three or more types of attribute information. In such cases, encoded data can be generated in the same manner. If the point cloud data has no attribute information, there may be no attribute information. In such a case, encoder **4801** does not have to generate a parameter set associated with attribute information.

(312) Next, a process of generating encoded data of additional information (metadata) will be described. Encoder **4801** generates a PCC stream PS (referred to also as PCC stream PS or stream PS), which is a parameter set for the entire PCC stream. Encoder **4801** stores a parameter that can be commonly used for a decoding process for one or more geometry sequences and one or more attribute sequences in the stream PS. For example, the stream PS includes identification

information indicating the codec for the point cloud data and information indicating an algorithm used for the encoding, for example. The geometry sequence and the attribute sequence depend on the stream PS.

(313) Next, an access unit and a GOF will be described. In this embodiment, concepts of access unit (AU) and group of frames (GOF) are newly introduced.

(314) An access unit is a basic unit for accessing data in decoding, and is formed by one or more pieces of data and one or more pieces of metadata. For example, an access unit is formed by geometry information and one or more pieces of attribute information associated with a same time point. A GOF is a random access unit, and is formed by one or more access units.

(315) Encoder **4801** generates an access unit header (AU header) as identification information indicating the top of an access unit. Encoder **4801** stores a parameter relating to the access unit in the access unit header. For example, the access unit header includes a configuration of or information on the encoded data included in the access unit. The access unit header further includes a parameter commonly used for the data included in the access unit, such as a parameter relating to decoding of the encoded data.

(316) Note that encoder **4801** may generate an access unit delimiter that includes no parameter relating to the access unit, instead of the access unit header. The access unit delimiter is used as identification information indicating the top of the access unit. The decoding device identifies the top of the access unit by detecting the access unit header or the access unit delimiter.

(317) Next, generation of identification information for the top of a GOF will be described. As identification information indicating the top of a GOF, encoder **4801** generates a GOF header. Encoder **4801** stores a parameter relating to the GOF in the GOF header. For example, the GOF header includes a configuration of or information on the encoded data included in the GOF. The GOF header further includes a parameter commonly used for the data included in the GOF, such as a parameter relating to decoding of the encoded data.

(318) Note that encoder **4801** may generate a GOF delimiter that includes no parameter relating to the GOF, instead of the GOF header. The GOF delimiter is used as identification information indicating the top of the GOF. The decoding device identifies the top of the GOF by detecting the GOF header or the GOF delimiter.

(319) In the PCC-encoded data, the access unit is defined as a PCC frame unit, for example. The decoding device accesses a PCC frame based on the identification information for the top of the access unit.

(320) For example, the GOF is defined as one random access unit. The decoding device accesses a random access unit based on the identification information for the top of the GOF. For example, if PCC frames are independent from each other and can be separately decoded, a PCC frame can be defined as a random access unit.

(321) Note that two or more PCC frames may be assigned to one access unit, and a plurality of random access units may be assigned to one GOF.

(322) Encoder **4801** may define and generate a parameter set or metadata other than those described above. For example, encoder **4801** may generate supplemental enhancement information (SEI) that stores a parameter (an optional parameter) that is not always used for decoding.

(323) Next, a configuration of encoded data and a method of storing encoded data in a NAL unit will be described.

(324) For example, a data format is defined for each type of encoded data. FIG. **26** is a diagram showing an example of encoded data and a NAL unit.

(325) For example, as shown in FIG. **26**, encoded data includes a header and a payload. The encoded data may include length information indicating the length (data amount) of the encoded data, the header, or the payload. The encoded data may include no header.

(326) The header includes identification information for identifying the data, for example. The identification information indicates a data type or a frame number, for example.

(327) The header includes identification information indicating a reference relationship, for example. The identification information is stored in the header when there is a dependence relationship between data, for example, and allows an entity to refer to another entity. For example, the header of the entity to be referred to includes identification information for identifying the data. The header of the referring entity includes identification information indicating the entity to be referred to.

(328) Note that, when the entity to be referred to or the referring entity can be identified or determined from other information, the identification information for identifying the data or identification information indicating the reference relationship can be omitted.

(329) Multiplexer **4802** stores the encoded data in the payload of the NAL unit. The NAL unit header includes `pcc_nal_unit_type`, which is identification information for the encoded data. FIG. 27 is a diagram showing a semantics example of `pcc_nal_unit_type`.

(330) As shown in FIG. 27, when `pcc_codec_type` is codec 1 (Codec1: first encoding method), values 0 to 10 of `pcc_nal_unit_type` are assigned to encoded geometry data (Geometry), encoded attribute X data (AttributeX), encoded attribute Y data (AttributeY), geometry PS (Geom. PS), attribute XPS (AttrX. S), attribute YPS (AttrY. PS), geometry SPS (Geometry Sequence PS), attribute X SPS (AttributeX Sequence PS), attribute Y SPS (AttributeY Sequence PS), AU header (AU Header), and GOF header (GOF Header) in codec 1. Values of 11 and greater are reserved in codec 1.

(331) When `pcc_codec_type` is codec 2 (Codec2: second encoding method), values of 0 to 2 of `pcc_nal_unit_type` are assigned to data A (DataA), metadata A (MetaDataA), and metadata B (MetaDataB) in the codec. Values of 3 and greater are reserved in codec 2.

(332) Next, an order of transmission of data will be described. In the following, restrictions on the order of transmission of NAL units will be described.

(333) Multiplexer **4802** transmits NAL units on a GOF basis or on an AU basis. Multiplexer **4802** arranges the GOF header at the top of a GOF, and arranges the AU header at the top of an AU.

(334) In order to allow the decoding device to decode the next AU and the following AUs even when data is lost because of a packet loss or the like, multiplexer **4802** may arrange a sequence parameter set (SPS) in each AU.

(335) When there is a dependence relationship for decoding between encoded data, the decoding device decodes the data of the entity to be referred to and then decodes the data of the referring entity. In order to allow the decoding device to perform decoding in the order of reception without rearranging the data, multiplexer **4802** first transmits the data of the entity to be referred to.

(336) FIG. 28 is a diagram showing examples of the order of transmission of NAL units. FIG. 28 shows three examples, that is, geometry information-first order, parameter-first order, and data-integrated order.

(337) The geometry information-first order of transmission is an example in which information relating to geometry information is transmitted together, and information relating to attribute information is transmitted together. In the case of this order of transmission, the transmission of the information relating to the geometry information ends earlier than the transmission of the information relating to the attribute information.

(338) For example, according to this order of transmission is used, when the decoding device does not decode attribute information, the decoding device may be able to have an idle time since the decoding device can omit decoding of attribute information. When the decoding device is required to decode geometry information early, the decoding device may be able to decode geometry information earlier since the decoding device obtains encoded data of the geometry information earlier.

(339) Note that, although in FIG. 28 the attribute X SPS and the attribute Y SPS are integrated and shown as the attribute SPS, the attribute X SPS and the attribute Y SPS may be separately arranged.

(340) In the parameter set-first order of transmission, a parameter set is first transmitted, and data is

then transmitted.

(341) As described above, as far as the restrictions on the order of transmission of NAL units are met, multiplexer **4802** can transmit NAL units in any order. For example, order identification information may be defined, and multiplexer **4802** may have a function of transmitting NAL units in a plurality of orders. For example, the order identification information for NAL units is stored in the stream PS.

(342) The three-dimensional data decoding device may perform decoding based on the order identification information. The three-dimensional data decoding device may indicate a desired order of transmission to the three-dimensional data encoding device, and the three-dimensional data encoding device (multiplexer **4802**) may control the order of transmission according to the indicated order of transmission.

(343) Note that multiplexer **4802** can generate encoded data having a plurality of functions merged to each other as in the case of the data-integrated order of transmission, as far as the restrictions on the order of transmission are met. For example, as shown in FIG. **28**, the GOF header and the AU header may be integrated, or AXPS and AYPS may be integrated. In such a case, an identifier that indicates data having a plurality of functions is defined in `pcc_nal_unit_type`.

(344) In the following, variations of this embodiment will be described. There are levels of PSs, such as a frame-level PS, a sequence-level PS, and a PCC sequence-level PS. Provided that the PCC sequence level is a higher level, and the frame level is a lower level, parameters can be stored in the manner described below.

(345) The value of a default PS is indicated in a PS at a higher level. If the value of a PS at a lower level differs from the value of the PS at a higher level, the value of the PS is indicated in the PS at the lower level. Alternatively, the value of the PS is not described in the PS at the higher level but is described in the PS at the lower level. Alternatively, information indicating whether the value of the PS is indicated in the PS at the lower level, at the higher level, or at both the levels is indicated in both or one of the PS at the lower level and the PS at the higher level. Alternatively, the PS at the lower level may be merged with the PS at the higher level. If the PS at the lower level and the PS at the higher level overlap with each other, multiplexer **4802** may omit transmission of one of the PSs.

(346) Note that encoder **4801** or multiplexer **4802** may divide data into slices or tiles and transmit each of the divided slices or tiles as divided data. The divided data includes information for identifying the divided data, and a parameter used for decoding of the divided data is included in the parameter set. In this case, an identifier that indicates that the data is data relating to a tile or slice or data storing a parameter is defined in `pcc_nal_unit_type`.

(347) In the following, a process relating to order identification information will be described. FIG. **29** is a flowchart showing a process performed by the three-dimensional data encoding device (encoder **4801** and multiplexer **4802**) that involves the order of transmission of NAL units.

(348) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device determines the order of transmission of NAL units (geometry information-first or parameter set-first) (**S4801**). For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device determines the order of transmission based on a specification from a user or an external device (the three-dimensional data decoding device, for example).

(349) If the determined order of transmission is geometry information-first (if “geometry information-first” in **S4802**), the three-dimensional data encoding device sets the order identification information included in the stream PS to geometry information-first (**S4803**). That is, in this case, the order identification information indicates that the NAL units are transmitted in the geometry information-first order. The three-dimensional data encoding device then transmits the NAL units in the geometry information-first order (**S4804**).

(350) On the other hand, if the determined order of transmission is parameter set-first (if “parameter set-first” in **S4802**), the three-dimensional data encoding device sets the order identification information included in the stream PS to parameter set-first (**S4805**). That is, in this case, the order identification information indicates that the NAL units are transmitted in the

parameter set-first order. The three-dimensional data encoding device then transmits the NAL units in the parameter set-first order (**S4806**).

(351) FIG. **30** is a flowchart showing a process performed by the three-dimensional data decoding device that involves the order of transmission of NAL units. First, the three-dimensional data decoding device analyzes the order identification information included in the stream PS (**S4811**).

(352) If the order of transmission indicated by the order identification information is geometry information-first (if “geometry information-first” in **S4812**), the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes the NAL units based on the determination that the order of transmission of the NAL units is geometry information-first (**S4813**).

(353) On the other hand, if the order of transmission indicated by the order identification information is parameter set-first (if “parameter set-first” in **S4812**), the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes the NAL units based on the determination that the order of transmission of the NAL units is parameter set-first (**S4814**).

(354) For example, if the three-dimensional data decoding device does not decode attribute information, in step **S4813**, the three-dimensional data decoding device does not obtain the entire NAL units but can obtain a part of a NAL unit relating to the geometry information and decode the obtained NAL unit to obtain the geometry information.

(355) Next, a process relating to generation of an AU and a GOF will be described. FIG. **31** is a flowchart showing a process performed by the three-dimensional data encoding device (multiplexer **4802**) that relates to generation of an AU and a GOF in multiplexing of NAL units.

(356) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device determines the type of the encoded data (**S4821**). Specifically, the three-dimensional data encoding device determines whether the encoded data to be processed is AU-first data, GOF-first data, or other data.

(357) If the encoded data is GOF-first data (if “GOF-first” in **S4822**), the three-dimensional data encoding device generates NAL units by arranging a GOF header and an AU header at the top of the encoded data belonging to the GOF (**S4823**).

(358) If the encoded data is AU-first data (if “AU-first” in **S4822**), the three-dimensional data encoding device generates NAL units by arranging an AU header at the top of the encoded data belonging to the AU (**S4824**).

(359) If the encoded data is neither GOF-first data nor AU-first data (if “other than GOF-first and AU-first” in **S4822**), the three-dimensional data encoding device generates NAL units by arranging the encoded data to follow the AU header of the AU to which the encoded data belongs (**S4825**).

(360) Next, a process relating to access to an AU and a GOF will be described. FIG. **32** is a flowchart showing a process performed by the three-dimensional data decoding device that involves accessing to an AU and a GOF in demultiplexing of a NAL unit.

(361) First, the three-dimensional data decoding device determines the type of the encoded data included in the NAL unit by analyzing `nal_unit_type` in the NAL unit (**S4831**). Specifically, the three-dimensional data decoding device determines whether the encoded data included in the NAL unit is AU-first data, GOF-first data, or other data.

(362) If the encoded data included in the NAL unit is GOF-first data (if “GOF-first” in **S4832**), the three-dimensional data decoding device determines that the NAL unit is a start position of random access, accesses the NAL unit, and starts the decoding process (**S4833**).

(363) If the encoded data included in the NAL unit is AU-first data (if “AU-first” in **S4832**), the three-dimensional data decoding device determines that the NAL unit is AU-first, accesses the data included in the NAL unit, and decodes the AU (**S4834**).

(364) If the encoded data included in the NAL unit is neither GOF-first data nor AU-first data (if “other than GOF-first and AU-first” in **S4832**), the three-dimensional data decoding device does not process the NAL unit.

Embodiment 3

(365) Information of a three-dimensional point cloud includes geometry information (geometry)

and attribute information (attribute). Geometry information includes coordinates (x-coordinate, y-coordinate, z-coordinate) with respect to a certain point. When geometry information is encoded, a method of representing the position of each of three-dimensional points in octree representation and encoding the octree information to reduce a code amount is used instead of directly encoding the coordinates of the three-dimensional point.

(366) On the other hand, attribute information includes information indicating, for example, color information (RGB, YUV, etc.) of each three-dimensional point, a reflectance, and a normal vector. For example, a three-dimensional data encoding device is capable of encoding attribute information using an encoding method different from a method used to encode geometry information.

(367) In the present embodiment, a method of encoding attribute information is explained. It is to be noted that, in the present embodiment, the method is explained based on an example case using integer values as values of attribute information. For example, when each of RGB or YUV color components is of an 8-bit accuracy, the color component is an integer value in a range from 0 to 255. When a reflectance value is of 10-bit accuracy, the reflectance value is an integer in a range from 0 to 1023. It is to be noted that, when the bit accuracy of attribute information is a decimal accuracy, the three-dimensional data encoding device may multiply the value by a scale value to round it to an integer value so that the value of the attribute information becomes an integer value. It is to be noted that the three-dimensional data encoding device may add the scale value to, for example, a header of a bitstream.

(368) As a method of encoding attribute information of a three-dimensional point, it is conceivable to calculate a predicted value of the attribute information of the three-dimensional point and encode a difference (prediction residual) between the original value of the attribute information and the predicted value. For example, when the value of attribute information at three-dimensional point p is A_p and a predicted value is P_p , the three-dimensional data encoding device encodes differential absolute value $\text{Diff}_p = |A_p - P_p|$. In this case, when highly-accurate predicted value P_p can be generated, differential absolute value Diff_p is small. Thus, for example, it is possible to reduce the code amount by entropy encoding differential absolute value Diff_p using a coding table that reduces an occurrence bit count more when differential absolute value Diff_p is smaller.

(369) As a method of generating a prediction value of attribute information, it is conceivable to use attribute information of a reference three-dimensional point that is another three-dimensional point which neighbors a current three-dimensional point to be encoded. Here, a reference three-dimensional point is a three-dimensional point in a range of a predetermined distance from the current three-dimensional point. For example, when there are current three-dimensional point $p = (x_1, y_1, z_1)$ and three-dimensional point $q = (x_2, y_2, z_2)$, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates Euclidean distance $d(p, q)$ between three-dimensional point p and three-dimensional point q represented by (Equation A1).

[Math. 1]

$$d(p, q) = \sqrt{\{(x_1 - y_1)^2 + (x_2 - y_2)^2 + (x_3 - y_3)^2\}} \quad (\text{Equation A1})$$

(370) The three-dimensional data encoding device determines that the position of three-dimensional point q is closer to the position of current three-dimensional point p when Euclidean distance $d(p, q)$ is smaller than predetermined threshold value TH_d , and determines to use the value of the attribute information of three-dimensional point q to generate a predicted value of the attribute information of current three-dimensional point p . It is to be noted that the method of calculating the distance may be another method, and a Mahalanobis distance or the like may be used. In addition, the three-dimensional data encoding device may determine not to use, in prediction processing, any three-dimensional point outside the predetermined range of distance from the current three-dimensional point. For example, when three-dimensional point r is present, and distance $d(p, r)$ between current three-dimensional point p and three-dimensional point r is larger than or equal to threshold value TH_d , the three-dimensional data encoding device may determine not to use three-dimensional point r for prediction. It is to be noted that the three-

dimensional data encoding device may add the information indicating threshold value THd to, for example, a header of a bitstream.

(371) FIG. 33 is a diagram illustrating an example of three-dimensional points. In this example, distance $d(p, q)$ between current three-dimensional point p and three-dimensional point q is smaller than threshold value THd. Thus, the three-dimensional data encoding device determines that three-dimensional point q is a reference three-dimensional point of current three-dimensional point p , and determines to use the value of attribute information A_q of three-dimensional point q to generate predicted value P_p of attribute information A_p of current three-dimensional point p .

(372) In contrast, distance $d(p, r)$ between current three-dimensional point p and three-dimensional point r is larger than or equal to threshold value THd. Thus, the three-dimensional data encoding device determines that three-dimensional point r is not any reference three-dimensional point of current three-dimensional point p , and determines not to use the value of attribute information A_r of three-dimensional point r to generate predicted value P_p of attribute information A_p of current three-dimensional point p .

(373) In addition, when encoding the attribute information of the current three-dimensional point using a predicted value, the three-dimensional data encoding device uses a three-dimensional point whose attribute information has already been encoded and decoded, as a reference three-dimensional point. Likewise, when decoding the attribute information of a current three-dimensional point to be decoded, the three-dimensional data decoding device uses a three-dimensional point whose attribute information has already been decoded, as a reference three-dimensional point. In this way, it is possible to generate the same predicted value at the time of encoding and decoding. Thus, a bitstream of the three-dimensional point generated by the encoding can be decoded correctly at the decoding side.

(374) Furthermore, when encoding attribute information of each of three-dimensional points, it is conceivable to classify the three-dimensional point into one of a plurality of layers using geometry information of the three-dimensional point and then encode the attribute information. Here, each of the layers classified is referred to as a Level of Detail (LoD). A method of generating LoDs is explained with reference to FIG. 34.

(375) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device selects initial point a_0 and assigns initial point a_0 to LoD0. Next, the three-dimensional data encoding device extracts point a_1 distant from point a_0 more than threshold value $\text{Thres_LoD}[0]$ of LoD0 and assigns point a_1 to LoD0. Next, the three-dimensional data encoding device extracts point a_2 distant from point a_1 more than threshold value $\text{Thres_LoD}[0]$ of LoD0 and assigns point a_2 to LoD0. In this way, the three-dimensional data encoding device configures LoD0 in such a manner that the distance between the points in LoD0 is larger than threshold value $\text{Thres_LoD}[0]$.

(376) Next, the three-dimensional data encoding device selects point b_0 which has not yet been assigned to any LoD and assigns point b_0 to LoD1. Next, the three-dimensional data encoding device extracts point b_1 which is distant from point b_0 more than threshold value $\text{Thres_LoD}[1]$ of LoD1 and which has not yet been assigned to any LoD, and assigns point b_1 to LoD1. Next, the three-dimensional data encoding device extracts point b_2 which is distant from point b_1 more than threshold value $\text{Thres_LoD}[1]$ of LoD1 and which has not yet been assigned to any LoD, and assigns point b_2 to LoD1. In this way, the three-dimensional data encoding device configures LoD1 in such a manner that the distance between the points in LoD1 is larger than threshold value $\text{Thres_LoD}[1]$.

(377) Next, the three-dimensional data encoding device selects point c_0 which has not yet been assigned to any LoD and assigns point c_0 to LoD2. Next, the three-dimensional data encoding device extracts point c_1 which is distant from point c_0 more than threshold value $\text{Thres_LoD}[2]$ of LoD2 and which has not yet been assigned to any LoD, and assigns point c_1 to LoD2. Next, the three-dimensional data encoding device extracts point c_2 which is distant from point c_1 more than threshold value $\text{Thres_LoD}[2]$ of LoD2 and which has not yet been assigned to any LoD, and

assigns point c2 to LoD2. In this way, the three-dimensional data encoding device configures LoD2 in such a manner that the distance between the points in LoD2 is larger than threshold value Thres_LoD[2]. For example, as illustrated in FIG. 35, threshold values Thres_LoD[0], Thres_LoD[1], and Thres_LoD[2] of respective LoDs are set.

(378) In addition, the three-dimensional data encoding device may add the information indicating the threshold value of each LoD to, for example, a header of a bitstream. For example, in the case of the example illustrated in FIG. 35, the three-dimensional data encoding device may add threshold values Thres_LoD[0], Thres_LoD[1], and Thres_LoD[2] of respective LoDs to a header.

(379) Alternatively, the three-dimensional data encoding device may assign all three-dimensional points which have not yet been assigned to any LoD in the lowermost-layer LoD. In this case, the three-dimensional data encoding device is capable of reducing the code amount of the header by not assigning the threshold value of the lowermost-layer LoD to the header. For example, in the case of the example illustrated in FIG. 35, the three-dimensional data encoding device assigns threshold values Thres_LoD[0] and Thres_LoD[1] to the header, and does not assign Thres_LoD[2] to the header. In this case, the three-dimensional data encoding device may estimate value 0 of Thres_LoD[2]. In addition, the three-dimensional data encoding device may add the number of LoDs to a header. In this way, the three-dimensional data encoding device is capable of determining the lowermost-layer LoD using the number of LoDs.

(380) In addition, setting threshold values for the respective layers LoDs in such a manner that a larger threshold value is set to a higher layer makes a higher layer (layer closer to LoD0) to have a sparse point cloud (sparse) in which three-dimensional points are more distant and makes a lower layer to have a dense point cloud (dense) in which three-dimensional points are closer. It is to be noted that, in an example illustrated in FIG. 35, LoD0 is the uppermost layer.

(381) In addition, the method of selecting an initial three-dimensional point at the time of setting each LoD may depend on an encoding order at the time of geometry information encoding. For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device configures LoD0 by selecting the three-dimensional point encoded first at the time of the geometry information encoding as initial point a0 of LoD0, and selecting point a1 and point a2 from initial point a0 as the origin. The three-dimensional data encoding device then may select the three-dimensional point whose geometry information has been encoded at the earliest time among three-dimensional points which do not belong to LoD0, as initial point b0 of LoD1. In other words, the three-dimensional data encoding device may select the three-dimensional point whose geometry information has been encoded at the earliest time among three-dimensional points which do not belong to layers (LoD0 to LoDn-1) above LoDn, as initial point n0 of LoDn. In this way, the three-dimensional data encoding device is capable of configuring the same LoD as in encoding by using, in decoding, the initial point selecting method similar to the one used in the encoding, which enables appropriate decoding of a bitstream. More specifically, the three-dimensional data encoding device selects the three-dimensional point whose geometry information has been decoded at the earliest time among three-dimensional points which do not belong to layers above LoDn, as initial point n0 of LoDn.

(382) Hereinafter, a description is given of a method of generating the predicted value of the attribute information of each three-dimensional point using information of LoDs. For example, when encoding three-dimensional points starting with the three-dimensional points included in LoD0, the three-dimensional data encoding device generates current three-dimensional points which are included in LoD1 using encoded and decoded (hereinafter also simply referred to as "encoded") attribute information included in LoD0 and LoD1. In this way, the three-dimensional data encoding device generates a predicted value of attribute information of each three-dimensional point included in LoDn using encoded attribute information included in LoDn' ($n' \leq n$). In other words, the three-dimensional data encoding device does not use attribute information of each of three-dimensional points included in any layer below LoDn to calculate a predicted value of attribute information of each of the three-dimensional points included in LoDn.

(383) For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates an average of attribute information of N or less three-dimensional points among encoded three-dimensional points surrounding a current three-dimensional point to be encoded, to generate a predicted value of attribute information of the current three-dimensional point. In addition, the three-dimensional data encoding device may add value N to, for example, a header of a bitstream. It is to be noted that the three-dimensional data encoding device may change value N for each three-dimensional point, and may add value N for each three-dimensional point. This enables selection of appropriate N for each three-dimensional point, which makes it possible to increase the accuracy of the predicted value. Accordingly, it is possible to reduce the prediction residual. Alternatively, the three-dimensional data encoding device may add value N to a header of a bitstream, and may fix the value indicating N in the bitstream. This eliminates the need to encode or decode value N for each three-dimensional point, which makes it possible to reduce the processing amount. In addition, the three-dimensional data encoding device may encode the values of N separately for each LoD. In this way, it is possible to increase the coding efficiency by selecting appropriate N for each LoD.

(384) Alternatively, the three-dimensional data encoding device may calculate a predicted value of attribute information of three-dimensional point based on weighted average values of attribute information of encoded N neighbor three-dimensional points. For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates weights using distance information between a current three-dimensional point and each of N neighbor three-dimensional points.

(385) When encoding value N for each LoD, for example, the three-dimensional data encoding device sets larger value N to a higher layer LoD, and sets smaller value N to a lower layer LoD. The distance between three-dimensional points belonging to a higher layer LoD is large, there is a possibility that it is possible to increase the prediction accuracy by setting large value N, selecting a plurality of neighbor three-dimensional points, and averaging the values. Furthermore, the distance between three-dimensional points belonging to a lower layer LoD is small, it is possible to perform efficient prediction while reducing the processing amount of averaging by setting smaller value N.

(386) FIG. 36 is a diagram illustrating an example of attribute information to be used for predicted values. As described above, the predicted value of point P included in LoDN is generated using encoded neighbor point P' included in LoDN' ($N' \leq N$). Here, neighbor point P' is selected based on the distance from point P. For example, the predicted value of attribute information of point b2 illustrated in FIG. 36 is generated using attribute information of each of points a0, a1, b0, and b1.

(387) Neighbor points to be selected vary depending on the values of N described above. For example, in the case of $N=5$, a0, a1, a2, b0, and b1 are selected as neighbor points. In the case of $N=4$, a0, a1, a2, and b1 are selected based on distance information.

(388) The predicted value is calculated by distance-dependent weighted averaging. For example, in the example illustrated in FIG. 36, predicted value a2p of point a2 is calculated by weighted averaging of attribute information of each of point a0 and a1, as represented by (Equation A2) and (Equation A3). It is to be noted that A.sub.i is an attribute information value of ai.

$$(389) [\text{Math. 2}] \quad a2p = \sum_{i=0}^1 w_i \times A_i \quad (\text{Equation A2}) \quad w_i = \frac{\frac{1}{d(a2, a_i)}}{\sum_{j=0}^1 \frac{1}{d(a2, a_j)}} \quad (\text{Equation A3})$$

(390) In addition, predicted value b2p of point b2 is calculated by weighted averaging of attribute information of each of point a0, a1, a2, b0, and b1, as represented by (Equation A4) and (Equation A6). It is to be noted that B.sub.i is an attribute information value of bi.

$$(391) [\text{Math. 3}] \quad b2p = \sum_{i=0}^2 w_{a_i} \times A_i + \sum_{i=0}^1 w_{b_i} \times B_i \quad (\text{Equation A4})$$

$$w_{a_i} = \frac{\frac{1}{d(b2, a_i)}}{\sum_{j=0}^2 \frac{1}{d(b2, a_j)} + \sum_{j=0}^1 \frac{1}{d(b2, b_j)}} \quad (\text{Equation A5})$$

$$w_{b_i} = \frac{\frac{1}{d(b2, b_i)}}{\sum_{j=0}^2 \frac{1}{d(b2, a_j)} + \sum_{j=0}^1 \frac{1}{d(b2, b_j)}} \quad (\text{Equation A6})$$

(392) In addition, the three-dimensional data encoding device may calculate a difference value

(prediction residual) generated from the value of attribute information of a three-dimensional point and neighbor points, and may quantize the calculated prediction residual. For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device performs quantization by dividing the prediction residual by a quantization scale (also referred to as a quantization step). In this case, an error (quantization error) which may be generated by quantization reduces as the quantization scale is smaller. In the other case where the quantization scale is larger, the resulting quantization error is larger.

(393) It is to be noted that the three-dimensional data encoding device may change the quantization scale to be used for each LoD. For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device reduces the quantization scale more for a higher layer, and increases the quantization scale more for a lower layer. The value of attribute information of a three-dimensional point belonging to a higher layer may be used as a predicted value of attribute information of a three-dimensional point belonging to a lower layer. Thus, it is possible to increase the coding efficiency by reducing the quantization scale for the higher layer to reduce the quantization error that can be generated in the higher layer and to increase the prediction accuracy of the predicted value. It is to be noted that the three-dimensional data encoding device may add the quantization scale to be used for each LoD to, for example, a header. In this way, the three-dimensional data encoding device can decode the quantization scale correctly, thereby appropriately decoding the bitstream.

(394) In addition, the three-dimensional data encoding device may convert a signed integer value (signed quantized value) which is a quantized prediction residual into an unsigned integer value (unsigned quantized value). This eliminates the need to consider occurrence of a negative integer when entropy encoding the prediction residual. It is to be noted that the three-dimensional data encoding device does not always need to convert a signed integer value into an unsigned integer value, and, for example, that the three-dimensional data encoding device may entropy encode a sign bit separately.

(395) The prediction residual is calculated by subtracting a prediction value from the original value. For example, as represented by (Equation A7), prediction residual $a2r$ of point $a2$ is calculated by subtracting predicted value $a2p$ of point $a2$ from value $A.sub.2$ of attribute information of point $a2$. As represented by (Equation A8), prediction residual $b2r$ of point $b2$ is calculated by subtracting predicted value $b2p$ of point $b2$ from value $B.sub.2$ of attribute information of point $b2$.

$$a2r = A.sub.2 - a2p \quad (\text{Equation A7})$$

$$b2r = B.sub.2 - b2p \quad (\text{Equation A8})$$

(396) In addition, the prediction residual is quantized by being divided by a Quantization Step (QS). For example, quantized value $a2q$ of point $a2$ is calculated according to (Equation A9). Quantized value $b2q$ of point $b2$ is calculated according to (Equation A10). Here, QS_LoD0 is a QS for $LoD0$, and QS_LoD1 is a QS for $LoD1$. In other words, a QS may be changed according to an LoD.

$$a2q = a2r / QS_LoD0 \quad (\text{Equation A9})$$

$$b2q = b2r / QS_LoD1 \quad (\text{Equation A10})$$

(397) In addition, the three-dimensional data encoding device converts signed integer values which are quantized values as indicated below into unsigned integer values as indicated below. When signed integer value $a2q$ is smaller than 0, the three-dimensional data encoding device sets unsigned integer value $a2u$ to $-1 - (2 \times a2q)$. When signed integer value $a2q$ is 0 or more, the three-dimensional data encoding device sets unsigned integer value $a2u$ to $2 \times a2q$.

(398) Likewise, when signed integer value $b2q$ is smaller than 0, the three-dimensional data encoding device sets unsigned integer value $b2u$ to $-1 - (2 \times b2q)$. When signed integer value $b2q$ is 0 or more, the three-dimensional data encoding device sets unsigned integer value $b2u$ to $2 \times b2q$.

(399) In addition, the three-dimensional data encoding device may encode the quantized prediction residual (unsigned integer value) by entropy encoding. For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device may binarize the unsigned integer value and then apply binary arithmetic encoding

to the binary value.

(400) It is to be noted that, in this case, the three-dimensional data encoding device may switch binarization methods according to the value of a prediction residual. For example, when prediction residual pu is smaller than threshold value R_TH , the three-dimensional data encoding device binarizes prediction residual pu using a fixed bit count required for representing threshold value R_TH . In addition, when prediction residual pu is larger than or equal to threshold value R_TH , the three-dimensional data encoding device binarizes the binary data of threshold value R_TH and the value of $(pu - R_TH)$, using exponential-Golomb coding, or the like.

(401) For example, when threshold value R_TH is 63 and prediction residual pu is smaller than 63, the three-dimensional data encoding device binarizes prediction residual pu using 6 bits. When prediction residual pu is larger than or equal to 63, the three-dimensional data encoding device performs arithmetic encoding by binarizing the binary data (111111) of threshold value R_TH and $(pu - 63)$ using exponential-Golomb coding.

(402) In a more specific example, when prediction residual pu is 32, the three-dimensional data encoding device generates 6-bit binary data (100000), and arithmetic encodes the bit sequence. In addition, when prediction residual pu is 66, the three-dimensional data encoding device generates binary data (111111) of threshold value R_TH and a bit sequence (00100) representing value 3 ($66 - 63$) using exponential-Golomb coding, and arithmetic encodes the bit sequence (111111+00100).

(403) In this way, the three-dimensional data encoding device can perform encoding while preventing a binary bit count from increasing abruptly in the case where a prediction residual becomes large by switching binarization methods according to the magnitude of the prediction residual. It is to be noted that the three-dimensional data encoding device may add threshold value R_TH to, for example, a header of a bitstream.

(404) For example, in the case where encoding is performed at a high bit rate, that is, when a quantization scale is small, a small quantization error and a high prediction accuracy are obtained. As a result, a prediction residual may not be large. Thus, in this case, the three-dimensional data encoding device sets large threshold value R_TH . This reduces the possibility that the binary data of threshold value R_TH is encoded, which increases the coding efficiency. In the opposite case where encoding is performed at a low bit rate, that is, when a quantization scale is large, a large quantization error and a low prediction accuracy are obtained. As a result, a prediction residual may be large. Thus, in this case, the three-dimensional data encoding device sets small threshold value R_TH . In this way, it is possible to prevent abrupt increase in bit length of binary data.

(405) In addition, the three-dimensional data encoding device may switch threshold value R_TH for each LoD, and may add threshold value R_TH for each LoD to, for example, a header. In other words, the three-dimensional data encoding device may switch binarization methods for each LoD. For example, since distances between three-dimensional points are large in a higher layer, a prediction accuracy is low, which may increase a prediction residual. Thus, the three-dimensional data encoding device prevents abrupt increase in bit length of binary data by setting small threshold value R_TH to the higher layer. In addition, since distances between three-dimensional points are small in a lower layer, a prediction accuracy is high, which may reduce a prediction residual. Thus, the three-dimensional data encoding device increases the coding efficiency by setting large threshold value R_TH to the lower layer.

(406) FIG. 37 is a diagram indicating examples of exponential-Golomb codes. The diagram indicates the relationships between pre-binarization values (non-binary values) and post-binarization bits (codes). It is to be noted that 0 and 1 indicated in FIG. 37 may be inverted.

(407) The three-dimensional data encoding device applies arithmetic encoding to the binary data of prediction residuals. In this way, the coding efficiency can be increased. It is to be noted that, in the application of the arithmetic encoding, there is a possibility that occurrence probability tendencies of 0 and 1 in each bit vary, in binary data, between an n -bit code which is a part binarized by n bits and a remaining code which is a part binarized using exponential-Golomb coding. Thus, the three-

dimensional data encoding device may switch methods of applying arithmetic encoding between the n -bit code and the remaining code.

(408) For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device performs arithmetic encoding on the n -bit code using one or more coding tables (probability tables) different for each bit. At this time, the three-dimensional data encoding device may change the number of coding tables to be used for each bit. For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device performs arithmetic encoding using one coding table for first bit b_0 in an n -bit code. The three-dimensional data encoding device uses two coding tables for the next bit b_1 . The three-dimensional data encoding device switches coding tables to be used for arithmetic encoding of bit b_1 according to the value (0 or 1) of b_0 . Likewise, the three-dimensional data encoding device uses four coding tables for the next bit b_2 . The three-dimensional data encoding device switches coding tables to be used for arithmetic encoding of bit b_2 according to the values (in a range from 0 to 3) of b_0 and b_1 .

(409) In this way, the three-dimensional data encoding device uses $2^{\text{sup}.n-1}$ coding tables when arithmetic encoding each bit b_{n-1} in n -bit code. The three-dimensional data encoding device switches coding tables to be used according to the values (occurrence patterns) of bits before b_{n-1} . In this way, the three-dimensional data encoding device can use coding tables appropriate for each bit, and thus can increase the coding efficiency.

(410) It is to be noted that the three-dimensional data encoding device may reduce the number of coding tables to be used for each bit. For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device may switch $2^{\text{sup}.m}$ coding tables according to the values (occurrence patterns) of m bits ($m < n-1$) before b_{n-1} when arithmetic encoding each bit b_{n-1} . In this way, it is possible to increase the coding efficiency while reducing the number of coding tables to be used for each bit. It is to be noted that the three-dimensional data encoding device may update the occurrence probabilities of 0 and 1 in each coding table according to the values of binary data occurred actually. In addition, the three-dimensional data encoding device may fix the occurrence probabilities of 0 and 1 in coding tables for some bit(s). In this way, it is possible to reduce the number of updates of occurrence probabilities, and thus to reduce the processing amount.

(411) For example, when an n -bit code is $b_0, b_1, b_2, \dots, b_{n-1}$, the coding table for b_0 is one table (CT b_0). Coding tables for b_1 are two tables (CT b_{10} and CT b_{11}). Coding tables to be used are switched according to the value (0 or 1) of b_0 . Coding tables for b_2 are four tables (CT b_{20} , CT b_{21} , CT b_{22} , and CT b_{23}). Coding tables to be used are switched according to the values (in the range from 0 to 3) of b_0 and b_1 . Coding tables for b_{n-1} are $2^{\text{sup}.n-1}$ tables (CT b_{n0} , CT b_{n1} , $\dots$, CT $b_{n(2^{\text{sup}.n-1}-1)}$). Coding tables to be used are switched according to the values (in a range from 0 to $2^{\text{sup}.n-1}-1$) of $b_0, b_1, \dots, b_{n-2}$.

(412) It is to be noted that the three-dimensional data encoding device may apply, to an n -bit code, arithmetic encoding ($m=2^{\text{sup}.n}$) by m -ary that sets the value in the range from 0 to $2^{\text{sup}.n}-1$ without binarization. When the three-dimensional data encoding device arithmetic encodes an n -bit code by an m -ary, the three-dimensional data decoding device may reconstruct the n -bit code by arithmetic decoding the m -ary.

(413) FIG. 38 is a diagram for illustrating processing in the case where remaining codes are exponential-Golomb codes. As indicated in FIG. 38, each remaining code which is a part binarized using exponential-Golomb coding includes a prefix and a suffix. For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device switches coding tables between the prefix and the suffix. In other words, the three-dimensional data encoding device arithmetic encodes each of bits included in the prefix using coding tables for the prefix, and arithmetic encodes each of bits included in the suffix using coding tables for the suffix.

(414) It is to be noted that the three-dimensional data encoding device may update the occurrence probabilities of 0 and 1 in each coding table according to the values of binary data occurred actually. In addition, the three-dimensional data encoding device may fix the occurrence probabilities of 0 and 1 in one of coding tables. In this way, it is possible to reduce the number of

updates of occurrence probabilities, and thus to reduce the processing amount. For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device may update the occurrence probabilities for the prefix, and may fix the occurrence probabilities for the suffix.

(415) In addition, the three-dimensional data encoding device decodes a quantized prediction residual by inverse quantization and reconstruction, and uses a decoded value which is the decoded prediction residual for prediction of a current three-dimensional point to be encoded and the following three-dimensional point(s). More specifically, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates an inverse quantized value by multiplying the quantized prediction residual (quantized value) with a quantization scale, and adds the inverse quantized value and a prediction value to obtain the decoded value (reconstructed value).

(416) For example, quantized value $a2iq$ of point $a2$ is calculated using quantized value $a2q$ of point $a2$ according to (Equation A11). Inverse quantized value $b2iq$ of point $b2q$ is calculated using quantized value $b2q$ of point $b2$ according to (Equation A12). Here, QS_LoD0 is a QS for $LoD0$, and QS_LoD1 is a QS for $LoD1$. In other words, a QS may be changed according to an LoD .

$$a2iq = a2q \times QS_LoD0 \quad (\text{Equation A11})$$

$$b2iq = b2q \times QS_LoD1 \quad (\text{Equation A12})$$

(417) For example, as represented by (Equation A13), decoded value $a2rec$ of point $a2$ is calculated by adding inverse quantization value $a2iq$ of point $a2$ to predicted value $a2p$ of point $a2$. As represented by (Equation A14), decoded value $b2rec$ of point $b2$ is calculated by adding inverse quantized value $b2iq$ of point $b2$ to predicted value $b2p$ of point $b2$.

$$a2rec = a2iq + a2p \quad (\text{Equation A13})$$

$$b2rec = b2iq + b2p \quad (\text{Equation A14})$$

(418) Hereinafter, a syntax example of a bitstream according to the present embodiment is described. FIG. 39 is a diagram indicating the syntax example of an attribute header (attribute_header) according to the present embodiment. The attribute header is header information of attribute information. As indicated in FIG. 39, the attribute header includes the number of layers information (NumLoD), the number of three-dimensional points information (NumOfPoint[i]), a layer threshold value (Thres_LoD[i]), the number of neighbor points information (NumNeighborPoint[i]), a prediction threshold value (THd[i]), a quantization scale (QS[i]), and a binarization threshold value (R_TH[i]).

(419) The number of layers information (NumLoD) indicates the number of LoDs to be used.

(420) The number of three-dimensional points information (NumOfPoint[i]) indicates the number of three-dimensional points belonging to layer i . It is to be noted that the three-dimensional data encoding device may add, to another header, the number of three-dimensional points information indicating the total number of three-dimensional points. In this case, the three-dimensional data encoding device does not need to add, to a header, NumOfPoint [NumLoD-1] indicating the number of three-dimensional points belonging to the lowermost layer. In this case, the three-dimensional data decoding device is capable of calculating NumOfPoint [NumLoD-1] according to (Equation A15). In this case, it is possible to reduce the code amount of the header.

(421) [Math . 4]

$$\text{NumOfPoint}[\text{NumLoD} - 1] = \text{AllNumOfPoint} - \sum_{j=0}^{\text{NumLoD}} \text{Math. NumOfPoint}[j] \quad (\text{Equation A15})$$

(422) The layer threshold value (Thres_LoD[i]) is a threshold value to be used to set layer i . The three-dimensional data encoding device and the three-dimensional data decoding device configure $LoDi$ in such a manner that the distance between points in $LoDi$ becomes larger than threshold value Thres_LoD[i]. The three-dimensional data encoding device does not need to add the value of Thres_LoD [NumLoD-1] (lowermost layer) to a header. In this case, the three-dimensional data decoding device may estimate 0 as the value of Thres_LoD [NumLoD-1]. In this case, it is possible to reduce the code amount of the header.

(423) The number of neighbor points information (NumNeighborPoint[i]) indicates the upper limit

value of the number of neighbor points to be used to generate a predicted value of a three-dimensional point belonging to layer i . The three-dimensional data encoding device may calculate a predicted value using the number of neighbor points M when the number of neighbor points M is smaller than $\text{NumNeighborPoint}[i]$ ($M < \text{NumNeighborPoint}[i]$). Furthermore, when there is no need to differentiate the values of $\text{NumNeighborPoint}[i]$ for respective LoDs, the three-dimensional data encoding device may add a piece of the number of neighbor points information (NumNeighborPoint) to be used in all LoDs to a header.

(424) The prediction threshold value ($\text{THd}[i]$) indicates the upper limit value of the distance between a current three-dimensional point to be encoded or decoded in layer i and each of neighbor three-dimensional points to be used to predict the current three-dimensional point. The three-dimensional data encoding device and the three-dimensional data decoding device do not use, for prediction, any three-dimensional point distant from the current three-dimensional point over $\text{THd}[i]$. It is to be noted that, when there is no need to differentiate the values of $\text{THd}[i]$ for respective LoDs, the three-dimensional data encoding device may add a single prediction threshold value (THd) to be used in all LoDs to a header.

(425) The quantization scale ($\text{QS}[i]$) indicates a quantization scale to be used for quantization and inverse quantization in layer i .

(426) The binarization threshold value ($\text{R_TH}[i]$) is a threshold value for switching binarization methods of prediction residuals of three-dimensional points belonging to layer i . For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device binarizes prediction residual pu using a fixed bit count when a prediction residual is smaller than threshold value R_TH , and binarizes the binary data of threshold value R_TH and the value of $(\text{pu} - \text{R_TH})$ using exponential-Golomb coding when a prediction residual is larger than or equal to threshold value R_TH . It is to be noted that, when there is no need to switch the values of $\text{R_TH}[i]$ between LoDs, the three-dimensional data encoding device may add a single binarization threshold value (R_TH) to be used in all LoDs to a header.

(427) It is to be noted that $\text{R_TH}[i]$ may be the maximum value which can be represented by n bits. For example, R_TH is 63 in the case of 6 bits, and R_TH is 255 in the case of 8 bits. Alternatively, the three-dimensional data encoding device may encode a bit count instead of encoding the maximum value which can be represented by n bits as a binarization threshold value. For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device may add value 6 in the case of $\text{R_TH}[i] = 63$ to a header, and may add value 8 in the case of $\text{R_TH}[i] = 255$ to a header. Alternatively, the three-dimensional data encoding device may define the minimum value (minimum bit count) representing $\text{R_TH}[i]$, and add a relative bit count from the minimum value to a header. For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device may add value 0 to a header when $\text{R_TH}[i] = 63$ is satisfied and the minimum bit count is 6, and may add value 2 to a header when $\text{R_TH}[i] = 255$ is satisfied and the minimum bit count is 6.

(428) Alternatively, the three-dimensional data encoding device may entropy encode at least one of NumLoD , $\text{Thres_LoD}[i]$, $\text{NumNeighborPoint}[i]$, $\text{THd}[i]$, $\text{QS}[i]$, and $\text{R_TH}[i]$, and add the entropy encoded one to a header. For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device may binarize each value and perform arithmetic encoding on the binary value. In addition, the three-dimensional data encoding device may encode each value using a fixed length in order to reduce the processing amount.

(429) Alternatively, the three-dimensional data encoding device does not always need to add at least one of NumLoD , $\text{Thres_LoD}[i]$, $\text{NumNeighborPoint}[i]$, $\text{THd}[i]$, $\text{QS}[i]$, and $\text{R_TH}[i]$ to a header. For example, at least one of these values may be defined by a profile or a level in a standard, or the like. In this way, it is possible to reduce the bit amount of the header.

(430) FIG. 40 is a diagram indicating the syntax example of attribute data (attribute_data) according to the present embodiment. The attribute data includes encoded data of the attribute information of a plurality of three-dimensional points. As indicated in FIG. 40, the attribute data

includes an n-bit code and a remaining code.

(431) The n-bit code is encoded data of a prediction residual of a value of attribute information or a part of the encoded data. The bit length of the n-bit code depends on value $R_TH[i]$. For example, the bit length of the n-bit code is 6 bits when the value indicated by $R_TH[i]$ is 63, the bit length of the n-bit code is 8 bits when the value indicated by $R_TH[i]$ is 255.

(432) The remaining code is encoded data encoded using exponential-Golomb coding among encoded data of the prediction residual of the value of the attribute information. The remaining code is encoded or decoded when the value of the n-bit code is equal to $R_TH[i]$. The three-dimensional data decoding device decodes the prediction residual by adding the value of the n-bit code and the value of the remaining code. It is to be noted that the remaining code does not always need to be encoded or decoded when the value of the n-bit code is not equal to $R_TH[i]$.

(433) Hereinafter, a description is given of a flow of processing in the three-dimensional data encoding device. FIG. 41 is a flowchart of a three-dimensional data encoding process performed by the three-dimensional data encoding device.

(434) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device encodes geometry information (geometry) (**S3001**). For example, the three-dimensional data encoding is performed using octree representation.

(435) When the positions of three-dimensional points changed by quantization, etc., after the encoding of the geometry information, the three-dimensional data encoding device re-assigns attribute information of the original three-dimensional points to the post-change three-dimensional points (**S3002**). For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device interpolates values of attribute information according to the amounts of change in position to re-assign the attribute information. For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device detects pre-change N three-dimensional points closer to the post-change three-dimensional positions, and performs weighted averaging of the values of attribute information of the N three-dimensional points. For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device determines weights based on distances from the post-change three-dimensional positions to the respective N three-dimensional positions in weighted averaging. The three-dimensional data encoding device then determines the values obtained through the weighted averaging to be the values of the attribute information of the post-change three-dimensional points. When two or more of the three-dimensional points are changed to the same three-dimensional position through quantization, etc., the three-dimensional data encoding device may assign the average value of the attribute information of the pre-change two or more three-dimensional points as the values of the attribute information of the post-change three-dimensional points.

(436) Next, the three-dimensional data encoding device encodes the attribute information (attribute) re-assigned (**S3003**). For example, when encoding a plurality of kinds of attribute information, the three-dimensional data encoding device may encode the plurality of kinds of attribute information in order. For example, when encoding colors and reflectances as attribute information, the three-dimensional data encoding device may generate a bitstream added with the color encoding results and the reflectance encoding results after the color encoding results. It is to be noted that the order of the plurality of encoding results of attribute information to be added to a bitstream is not limited to the order, and may be any order.

(437) Alternatively, the three-dimensional data encoding device may add, to a header for example, information indicating the start location of encoded data of each attribute information in a bitstream. In this way, the three-dimensional data decoding device is capable of selectively decoding attribute information required to be decoded, and thus is capable of skipping the decoding process of the attribute information not required to be decoded. Accordingly, it is possible to reduce the amount of processing by the three-dimensional data decoding device. Alternatively, the three-dimensional data encoding device may encode a plurality of kinds of attribute information in parallel, and may integrate the encoding results into a single bitstream. In this way, the three-

dimensional data encoding device is capable of encoding the plurality of kinds of attribute information at high speed.

(438) FIG. 42 is a flowchart of an attribute information encoding process (S3003). First, the three-dimensional data encoding device sets LoDs (S3011). In other words, the three-dimensional data encoding device assigns each of three-dimensional points to any one of the plurality of LoDs.

(439) Next, the three-dimensional data encoding device starts a loop for each LoD (S3012). In other words, the three-dimensional data encoding device iteratively performs the processes of Steps from S3013 to S3021 for each LoD.

(440) Next, the three-dimensional data encoding device starts a loop for each three-dimensional point (S3013). In other words, the three-dimensional data encoding device iteratively performs the processes of Steps from S3014 to S3020 for each three-dimensional point.

(441) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device searches a plurality of neighbor points which are three-dimensional points present in the neighborhood of a current three-dimensional point to be processed and are to be used to calculate a predicted value of the current three-dimensional point (S3014). Next, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates the weighted average of the values of attribute information of the plurality of neighbor points, and sets the resulting value to predicted value P (S3015). Next, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates a prediction residual which is the difference between the attribute information of the current three-dimensional point and the predicted value (S3016). Next, the three-dimensional data encoding device quantizes the prediction residual to calculate a quantized value (S3017). Next, the three-dimensional data encoding device arithmetic encodes the quantized value (S3018).

(442) Next, the three-dimensional data encoding device inverse quantizes the quantized value to calculate an inverse quantized value (S3019). Next, the three-dimensional data encoding device adds a prediction value to the inverse quantized value to generate a decoded value (S3020). Next, the three-dimensional data encoding device ends the loop for each three-dimensional point (S3021). Next, the three-dimensional data encoding device ends the loop for each LoD (S3022).

(443) Hereinafter, a description is given of a three-dimensional data decoding process in the three-dimensional data decoding device which decodes a bitstream generated by the three-dimensional data encoding device.

(444) The three-dimensional data decoding device generates decoded binary data by arithmetic decoding the binary data of the attribute information in the bitstream generated by the three-dimensional data encoding device, according to the method similar to the one performed by the three-dimensional data encoding device. It is to be noted that when methods of applying arithmetic encoding are switched between the part (n-bit code) binarized using n bits and the part (remaining code) binarized using exponential-Golomb coding in the three-dimensional data encoding device, the three-dimensional data decoding device performs decoding in conformity with the arithmetic encoding, when applying arithmetic decoding.

(445) For example, the three-dimensional data decoding device performs arithmetic decoding using coding tables (decoding tables) different for each bit in the arithmetic decoding of the n-bit code. At this time, the three-dimensional data decoding device may change the number of coding tables to be used for each bit. For example, the three-dimensional data decoding device performs arithmetic decoding using one coding table for first bit b0 in the n-bit code. The three-dimensional data decoding device uses two coding tables for the next bit b1. The three-dimensional data decoding device switches coding tables to be used for arithmetic decoding of bit b1 according to the value (0 or 1) of b0. Likewise, the three-dimensional data decoding device uses four coding tables for the next bit b2. The three-dimensional data decoding device switches coding tables to be used for arithmetic decoding of bit b2 according to the values (in the range from 0 to 3) of b0 and b1.

(446) In this way, the three-dimensional data decoding device uses $2.\sup.n-1$ coding tables when arithmetic decoding each bit b_{n-1} in the n-bit code. The three-dimensional data decoding device

switches coding tables to be used according to the values (occurrence patterns) of bits before b_{n-1} . In this way, the three-dimensional data decoding device is capable of appropriately decoding a bitstream encoded at an increased coding efficiency using the coding tables appropriate for each bit.

(447) It is to be noted that the three-dimensional data decoding device may reduce the number of coding tables to be used for each bit. For example, the three-dimensional data decoding device may switch $2.\sup.m$ coding tables according to the values (occurrence patterns) of m bits ($m < n-1$) before b_{n-1} when arithmetic decoding each bit b_{n-1} . In this way, the three-dimensional data decoding device is capable of appropriately decoding the bitstream encoded at the increased coding efficiency while reducing the number of coding tables to be used for each bit. It is to be noted that the three-dimensional data decoding device may update the occurrence probabilities of 0 and 1 in each coding table according to the values of binary data occurred actually. In addition, the three-dimensional data decoding device may fix the occurrence probabilities of 0 and 1 in coding tables for some bit(s). In this way, it is possible to reduce the number of updates of occurrence probabilities, and thus to reduce the processing amount.

(448) For example, when an n -bit code is $b_0, b_1, b_2, \dots, b_{n-1}$, the coding table for b_0 is one (CTb0). Coding tables for b_1 are two tables (CTb10 and CTb11). Coding tables to be used are switched according to the value (0 or 1) of b_0 . Coding tables for b_2 are four tables (CTb20, CTb21, CTb22, and CTb23). Coding tables to be used according to the values (in the range from 0 to 3) of b_0 and b_1 . Coding tables for b_{n-1} are $2.\sup.n-1$ tables (CTbn0, CTbn1, $\dots$, CTbn ($2.\sup.n-1-1$)). Coding tables to be used are switched according to the values (in the range from 0 to $2.\sup.n-1-1$) of $b_0, b_1, \dots, b_{n-2}$.

(449) FIG. 43 is a diagram for illustrating processing in the case where remaining codes are exponential-Golomb codes. As indicated in FIG. 43, the part (remaining part) binarized and encoded by the three-dimensional data encoding device using exponential-Golomb coding includes a prefix and a suffix. For example, the three-dimensional data decoding device switches coding tables between the prefix and the suffix. In other words, the three-dimensional data decoding device arithmetic decodes each of bits included in the prefix using coding tables for the prefix, and arithmetic decodes each of bits included in the suffix using coding tables for the suffix.

(450) It is to be noted that the three-dimensional data decoding device may update the occurrence probabilities of 0 and 1 in each coding table according to the values of binary data occurred at the time of decoding. In addition, the three-dimensional data decoding device may fix the occurrence probabilities of 0 and 1 in one of coding tables. In this way, it is possible to reduce the number of updates of occurrence probabilities, and thus to reduce the processing amount. For example, the three-dimensional data decoding device may update the occurrence probabilities for the prefix, and may fix the occurrence probabilities for the suffix.

(451) Furthermore, the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes the quantized prediction residual (unsigned integer value) by debinarizing the binary data of the prediction residual arithmetic decoded according to a method in conformity with the encoding method used by the three-dimensional data encoding device. The three-dimensional data decoding device first arithmetic decodes the binary data of an n -bit code to calculate a value of the n -bit code. Next, the three-dimensional data decoding device compares the value of the n -bit code with threshold value R_TH .

(452) In the case where the value of the n -bit code and threshold value R_TH match, the three-dimensional data decoding device determines that a bit encoded using exponential-Golomb coding is present next, and arithmetic decodes the remaining code which is the binary data encoded using exponential-Golomb coding. The three-dimensional data decoding device then calculates, from the decoded remaining code, a value of the remaining code using a reverse lookup table indicating the relationship between the remaining code and the value. FIG. 44 is a diagram indicating an example of a reverse lookup table indicating relationships between remaining codes and the values thereof.

Next, the three-dimensional data decoding device adds the obtained value of the remaining code to R_TH, thereby obtaining a debinarized quantized prediction residual.

(453) In the opposite case where the value of the n-bit code and threshold value R_TH do not match (the value of the n-bit code is smaller than value R_TH), the three-dimensional data decoding device determines the value of the n-bit code to be the debinarized quantized prediction residual as it is. In this way, the three-dimensional data decoding device is capable of appropriately decoding the bitstream generated while switching the binarization methods according to the values of the prediction residuals by the three-dimensional data encoding device.

(454) It is to be noted that, when threshold value R_TH is added to, for example, a header of a bitstream, the three-dimensional data decoding device may decode threshold value R_TH from the header, and may switch decoding methods using decoded threshold value R_TH. When threshold value R_TH is added to, for example, a header for each LoD, the three-dimensional data decoding device switch decoding methods using threshold value R_TH decoded for each LoD.

(455) For example, when threshold value R_TH is 63 and the value of the decoded n-bit code is 63, the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes the remaining code using exponential-Golomb coding, thereby obtaining the value of the remaining code. For example, in the example indicated in FIG. 44, the remaining code is 00100, and 3 is obtained as the value of the remaining code.

Next, the three-dimensional data decoding device adds 63 that is threshold value R_TH and 3 that is the value of the remaining code, thereby obtaining **66** that is the value of the prediction residual.

(456) In addition, when the value of the decoded n-bit code is 32, the three-dimensional data decoding device sets **32** that is the value of the n-bit code to the value of the prediction residual.

(457) In addition, the three-dimensional data decoding device converts the decoded quantized prediction residual, for example, from an unsigned integer value to a signed integer value, through processing inverse to the processing in the three-dimensional data encoding device. In this way, when entropy decoding the prediction residual, the three-dimensional data decoding device is capable of appropriately decoding the bitstream generated without considering occurrence of a negative integer. It is to be noted that the three-dimensional data decoding device does not always need to convert an unsigned integer value to a signed integer value, and that, for example, the three-dimensional data decoding device may decode a sign bit when decoding a bitstream generated by separately entropy encoding the sign bit.

(458) The three-dimensional data decoding device performs decoding by inverse quantizing and reconstructing the quantized prediction residual after being converted to the signed integer value, to obtain a decoded value. The three-dimensional data decoding device uses the generated decoded value for prediction of a current three-dimensional point to be decoded and the following three-dimensional point(s). More specifically, the three-dimensional data decoding device multiplies the quantized prediction residual by a decoded quantization scale to calculate an inverse quantized value and adds the inverse quantized value and the predicted value to obtain the decoded value.

(459) The decoded unsigned integer value (unsigned quantized value) is converted into a signed integer value through the processing indicated below. When the least significant bit (LSB) of decoded unsigned integer value a2u is 1, the three-dimensional data decoding device sets signed integer value a2q to $-((a2u+1)>>1)$. When the LSB of unsigned integer value a2u is not 1, the three-dimensional data decoding device sets signed integer value a2q to $((a2u>>1)$.

(460) Likewise, when an LSB of decoded unsigned integer value b2u is 1, the three-dimensional data decoding device sets signed integer value b2q to $-((b2u+1)>>1)$. When the LSB of decoded unsigned integer value n2u is not 1, the three-dimensional data decoding device sets signed integer value b2q to $((b2u>>1)$.

(461) Details of the inverse quantization and reconstruction processing by the three-dimensional data decoding device are similar to the inverse quantization and reconstruction processing in the three-dimensional data encoding device.

(462) Hereinafter, a description is given of a flow of processing in the three-dimensional data

decoding device. FIG. 45 is a flowchart of a three-dimensional data decoding process performed by the three-dimensional data decoding device. First, the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes geometry information (geometry) from a bitstream (S3031). For example, the three-dimensional data decoding device performs decoding using octree representation.

(463) Next, the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes attribute information (attribute) from the bitstream (S3032). For example, when decoding a plurality of kinds of attribute information, the three-dimensional data decoding device may decode the plurality of kinds of attribute information in order. For example, when decoding colors and reflectances as attribute information, the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes the color encoding results and the reflectance encoding results in order of assignment in the bitstream. For example, when the reflectance encoding results are added after the color encoding results in a bitstream, the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes the color encoding results, and then decodes the reflectance encoding results. It is to be noted that the three-dimensional data decoding device may decode, in any order, the encoding results of the attribute information added to the bitstream.

(464) Alternatively, the three-dimensional data encoding device may add, to a header for example, information indicating the start location of encoded data of each attribute information in a bitstream. In this way, the three-dimensional data decoding device is capable of selectively decoding attribute information required to be decoded, and thus is capable of skipping the decoding process of the attribute information not required to be decoded. Accordingly, it is possible to reduce the amount of processing by the three-dimensional data decoding device. In addition, the three-dimensional data decoding device may decode a plurality of kinds of attribute information in parallel, and may integrate the decoding results into a single three-dimensional point cloud. In this way, the three-dimensional data decoding device is capable of decoding the plurality of kinds of attribute information at high speed.

(465) FIG. 46 is a flowchart of an attribute information decoding process (S3032). First, the three-dimensional data decoding device sets LoDs (S3041). In other words, the three-dimensional data decoding device assigns each of three-dimensional points having the decoded geometry information to any one of the plurality of LoDs. For example, this assignment method is the same as the assignment method used in the three-dimensional data encoding device.

(466) Next, the three-dimensional data decoding device starts a loop for each LoD (S3042). In other words, the three-dimensional data decoding device iteratively performs the processes of Steps from S3043 to S3049 for each LoD.

(467) Next, the three-dimensional data decoding device starts a loop for each three-dimensional point (S3043). In other words, the three-dimensional data decoding device iteratively performs the processes of Steps from S3044 to S3048 for each three-dimensional point.

(468) First, the three-dimensional data decoding device searches a plurality of neighbor points which are three-dimensional points present in the neighborhood of a current three-dimensional point to be processed and are to be used to calculate a predicted value of the current three-dimensional point to be processed (S3044). Next, the three-dimensional data decoding device calculates the weighted average of the values of attribute information of the plurality of neighbor points, and sets the resulting value to predicted value P (S3045). It is to be noted that these processes are similar to the processes in the three-dimensional data encoding device.

(469) Next, the three-dimensional data decoding device arithmetic decodes the quantized value from the bitstream (S3046). The three-dimensional data decoding device inverse quantizes the decoded quantized value to calculate an inverse quantized value (S3047). Next, the three-dimensional data decoding device adds a predicted value to the inverse quantized value to generate a decoded value (S3048). Next, the three-dimensional data decoding device ends the loop for each three-dimensional point (S3049). Next, the three-dimensional data encoding device ends the loop for each LoD (S3050).

(470) The following describes configurations of the three-dimensional data encoding device and

three-dimensional data decoding device according to the present embodiment. FIG. 47 is a block diagram illustrating a configuration of three-dimensional data encoding device **3000** according to the present embodiment. Three-dimensional data encoding device **3000** includes geometry information encoder **3001**, attribute information re-assigner **3002**, and attribute information encoder **3003**.

(471) Attribute information encoder **3003** encodes geometry information (geometry) of a plurality of three-dimensional points included in an input point cloud. Attribute information re-assigner **3002** re-assigns the values of attribute information of the plurality of three-dimensional points included in the input point cloud, using the encoding and decoding results of the geometry information. Attribute information encoder **3003** encodes the re-assigned attribute information (attribute). Furthermore, three-dimensional data encoding device **3000** generates a bitstream including the encoded geometry information and the encoded attribute information.

(472) FIG. 48 is a block diagram illustrating a configuration of three-dimensional data decoding device **3010** according to the present embodiment. Three-dimensional data decoding device **3010** includes geometry information decoder **3011** and attribute information decoder **3012**.

(473) Geometry information decoder **3011** decodes the geometry information (geometry) of a plurality of three-dimensional points from a bitstream. Attribute information decoder **3012** decodes the attribute information (attribute) of the plurality of three-dimensional points from the bitstream. Furthermore, three-dimensional data decoding device **3010** integrates the decoded geometry information and the decoded attribute information to generate an output point cloud.

Embodiment 4

(474) Hereinafter, a three-dimensional point to be encoded is referred to as a first three-dimensional point, and one or more three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the first three-dimensional point is referred to as one or more second three-dimensional points in some cases.

(475) For example, in generating of a predicted value of an attribute information item (attribute information) of a three-dimensional point, an attribute value as it is of a closest three-dimensional point among encoded and decoded three-dimensional points in the vicinity of a three-dimensional point to be encoded may be generated as a predicted value. In the generating of the predicted value, prediction mode information (PredMode) may be appended for each three-dimensional point, and one predicted value may be selected from a plurality of predicted values to allow generation of a predicted value. Specifically, for example, it is conceivable that, for total number M of prediction modes, an average value is assigned to prediction mode 0, an attribute value of three-dimensional point A is assigned to prediction mode 1, . . . , and an attribute value of three-dimensional point Z is assigned to prediction mode $M-1$, and the prediction mode used for prediction is appended to a bitstream for each three-dimensional point. As such, a first prediction mode value indicating a first prediction mode for calculating, as a predicted value, an average of attribute information items of the surrounding three-dimensional points may be smaller than a second prediction mode value indicating a second prediction mode for calculating, as a predicted value, an attribute information item as it is of a surrounding three-dimensional point. Here, the “average value” as the predicted value calculated in prediction mode 0 is an average value of the attribute values of the three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the three-dimensional point to be encoded.

(476) FIG. 49 is a diagram showing a first example of a table representing predicted values calculated in the prediction modes according to Embodiment 4. FIG. 50 is a diagram showing examples of attribute information items used as the predicted values according to Embodiment 4. FIG. 51 is a diagram showing a second example of a table representing predicted values calculated in the prediction modes according to Embodiment 4.

(477) Number M of prediction modes may be appended to a bitstream. Number M of prediction modes may be defined by a profile or a level of standards rather than appended to the bitstream. Number M of prediction modes may be also calculated from number N of three-dimensional points used for prediction. For example, number M of prediction modes may be calculated by $M=N+1$.

(478) The table in FIG. 49 is an example of a case with number N of three-dimensional points used for prediction being 4 and number M of prediction modes being 5. A predicted value of an attribute information item of point b2 can be generated by using attribute information items of points a0, a1, a2, b1. In selecting one prediction mode from a plurality of prediction modes, a prediction mode for generating, as a predicted value, an attribute value of each of points a0, a1, a2, b1 may be selected in accordance with distance information from point b2 to each of points a0, a1, a2, b1. The prediction mode is appended for each three-dimensional point to be encoded. The predicted value is calculated in accordance with a value corresponding to the appended prediction mode.

(479) The table in FIG. 51 is, as in FIG. 49, an example of a case with number N of three-dimensional points used for prediction being 4 and number M of prediction modes being 5. A predicted value of an attribute information item of point a2 can be generated by using attribute information items of points a0, a1. In selecting one prediction mode from a plurality of prediction modes, a prediction mode for generating, as a predicted value, an attribute value of each of points a0 and a1 may be selected in accordance with distance information from point a2 to each of points a0, a1. The prediction mode is appended for each three-dimensional point to be encoded. The predicted value is calculated in accordance with a value corresponding to the appended prediction mode.

(480) When the number of neighboring points, that is, number N of surrounding three-dimensional points is smaller than four such as at point a2 above, a prediction mode to which a predicted value is not assigned may be written as “not available” in the table.

(481) Assignment of values of the prediction modes may be determined in accordance with the distance from the three-dimensional point to be encoded. For example, prediction mode values indicating a plurality of prediction modes decrease with decreasing distance from the three-dimensional point to be encoded to the surrounding three-dimensional points having the attribute information items used as the predicted values. The example in FIG. 49 shows that points b1, a2, a1, a0 are sequentially located closer to point b2 as the three-dimensional point to be encoded. For example, in the calculating of the predicted value, the attribute information item of point b1 is calculated as the predicted value in a prediction mode indicated by a prediction mode value of “1” among two or more prediction modes, and the attribute information item of point a2 is calculated as the predicted value in a prediction mode indicated by a prediction mode value of “2”. As such, the prediction mode value indicating the prediction mode for calculating, as the predicted value, the attribute information item of point b1 is smaller than the prediction mode value indicating the prediction mode for calculating, as the predicted value, the attribute information item of point a2 farther from point b2 than point b1.

(482) Thus, a small prediction mode value can be assigned to a point that is more likely to be predicted and selected due to a short distance, thereby reducing a bit number for encoding the prediction mode value. Also, a small prediction mode value may be preferentially assigned to a three-dimensional point belonging to the same LoD as the three-dimensional point to be encoded.

(483) FIG. 52 is a diagram showing a third example of a table representing predicted values calculated in the prediction modes according to Embodiment 4. Specifically, the third example is an example of a case where an attribute information item used as a predicted value is a value of color information (YUV) of a surrounding three-dimensional point. As such, the attribute information item used as the predicted value may be color information indicating a color of the three-dimensional point.

(484) As shown in FIG. 52, a predicted value calculated in a prediction mode indicated by a prediction mode value of “0” is an average of Y, U, and V components defining a YUV color space. Specifically, the predicted value includes a weighted average Yave of Y component values Yb1, Ya2, Ya1, Ya0 corresponding to points b1, a2, a1, a0, respectively, a weighted average Uave of U component values Ub1, Ua2, Ua1, Ua0 corresponding to points b1, a2, a1, a0, respectively, and a weighted average Vave of V component values Vb1, Va2, Va1, Va0 corresponding to points b1, a2,

a1, a0, respectively. Predicted values calculated in prediction modes indicated by prediction mode values of “1” to “4” include color information of the surrounding three-dimensional points b1, a2, a1, a0. The color information is indicated by combinations of the Y, U, and V component values. (485) In FIG. 52, the color information is indicated by a value defined by the YUV color space, but not limited to the YUV color space. The color information may be indicated by a value defined by an RGB color space or a value defined by any other color space.

(486) As such, in the calculating of the predicted value, two or more averages or two or more attribute information items may be calculated as the predicted values of the prediction modes. The two or more averages or the two or more attribute information items may indicate two or more component values each defining a color space.

(487) For example, when a prediction mode indicated by a prediction mode value of “2” in the table in FIG. 52 is selected, a Y component, a U component, and a V component as attribute values of the three-dimensional point to be encoded may be encoded as predicted values Ya2, Ua2, Va2. In this case, the prediction mode value of “2” is appended to the bitstream.

(488) FIG. 53 is a diagram showing a fourth example of a table representing predicted values calculated in the prediction modes according to Embodiment 4. Specifically, the fourth example is an example of a case where an attribute information item used as a predicted value is a value of reflectance information of a surrounding three-dimensional point. The reflectance information is, for example, information indicating reflectance R.

(489) As shown in FIG. 53, a predicted value calculated in a prediction mode indicated by a prediction mode value of “0” is weighted average Rave of reflectances Rb1, Ra2, Ra1, Ra0 corresponding to points b1, a2, a1, a0, respectively. Predicted values calculated in prediction modes indicated by prediction mode values of “1” to “4” are reflectances Rb1, Ra2, Ra1, Ra0 of surrounding three-dimensional points b1, a2, a1, a0, respectively.

(490) For example, when a prediction mode indicated by a prediction mode value of “3” in the table in FIG. 53 is selected, a reflectance as an attribute value of a three-dimensional point to be encoded may be encoded as predicted value Ra1. In this case, the prediction mode value of “3” is appended to the bitstream.

(491) As shown in FIGS. 52 and 53, the attribute information item may include a first attribute information item and a second attribute information item different from the first attribute information item. The first attribute information item is, for example, color information. The second attribute information item is, for example, reflectance information. In the calculating of the predicted value, a first predicted value may be calculated by using the first attribute information item, and a second predicted value may be calculated by using the second attribute information item.

(492) When the attribute information item includes a plurality of components like color information such as a YUV color space or an RGB color space, predicted values may be calculated in different prediction modes for the respective components. For example, for the YUV space, predicted values using a Y component, a U component, and a V component may be calculated in prediction modes selected for the respective components. For example, prediction mode values may be selected in prediction mode Y for calculating the predicted value using the Y component, prediction mode U for calculating the predicted value using the U component, and prediction mode V for calculating the predicted value using the V component. In this case, values in tables in FIGS. 54 to 56 described later may be used as the prediction mode values indicating the prediction modes of the components, and the prediction mode values may be appended to the bitstream. The YUV color space has been described above, but the same applies to the RGB color space.

(493) Predicted values including two or more components among a plurality of components of an attribute information item may be calculated in a common prediction mode. For example, for the YUV color space, prediction mode values may be selected in prediction mode Y for calculating the predicted value using the Y component and prediction mode UV for calculating the predicted value

using the UV components. In this case, values in tables in FIGS. 54 and 57 described later may be used as the prediction mode values indicating the prediction modes of the components, and the prediction mode values may be appended to the bitstream.

(494) FIG. 54 is a diagram showing a fifth example of a table representing predicted values calculated in the prediction modes according to Embodiment 4. Specifically, the fifth example is an example of a case where an attribute information item used as a predicted value is a Y component value of color information of a surrounding three-dimensional point.

(495) As shown in FIG. 54, a predicted value calculated in prediction mode Y indicated by a prediction mode value of "0" is weighted average Yave of Y component values Yb1, Ya2, Ya1, Ya0 corresponding to points b1, a2, a1, a0, respectively. Predicted values calculated in prediction modes indicated by prediction mode values of "1" to "4" are Y component values Yb1, Ya2, Ya1, Ya0 of surrounding three-dimensional points b1, a2, a1, a0, respectively.

(496) For example, when prediction mode Y indicated by a prediction mode value of "2" in the table in FIG. 54 is selected, a Y component as an attribute value of a three-dimensional point to be encoded may be used as predicted value Ya2 and encoded. In this case, the prediction mode value of "2" is appended to the bitstream.

(497) FIG. 55 is a diagram showing a sixth example of a table representing predicted values calculated in the prediction modes according to Embodiment 4. Specifically, the sixth example is an example of a case where an attribute information item used as a predicted value is a U component value of color information of a surrounding three-dimensional point.

(498) As shown in FIG. 55, a predicted value calculated in prediction mode U indicated by a prediction mode value of "0" is weighted average Uave of U component values Ub1, Ua2, Ua1, Ua0 corresponding to points b1, a2, a1, a0, respectively. Predicted values calculated in prediction modes indicated by prediction mode values of "1" to "4" are U component values Ub1, Ua2, Ua1, Ua0 of surrounding three-dimensional points b1, a2, a1, a0, respectively.

(499) For example, when prediction mode U indicated by a prediction mode value of "1" in the table in FIG. 55 is selected, a U component as an attribute value of a three-dimensional point to be encoded may be encoded as predicted value Ub1. In this case, the prediction mode value of "1" is appended to the bitstream.

(500) FIG. 56 is a diagram showing a seventh example of a table representing predicted values calculated in the prediction modes according to Embodiment 4. Specifically, the seventh example is an example of a case where an attribute information item used as a predicted value is a V component value of color information of a surrounding three-dimensional point.

(501) As shown in FIG. 56, a predicted value calculated in prediction mode V indicated by a prediction mode value of "0" is weighted average Vave of V component values Vb1, Va2, Va1, Va0 corresponding to points b1, a2, a1, a0, respectively. Predicted values calculated in prediction modes indicated by prediction mode values of "1" to "4" are V component values Vb1, Va2, Va1, Va0 of surrounding three-dimensional points b1, a2, a1, a0, respectively.

(502) For example, when prediction mode V indicated by a prediction mode value of "4" in the table in FIG. 56 is selected, a V component as an attribute value of a three-dimensional point to be encoded may be used as predicted value Va0 and encoded. In this case, the prediction mode value of "4" is appended to the bitstream.

(503) FIG. 57 is a diagram showing an eighth example of a table representing predicted values calculated in the prediction modes according to Embodiment 4. Specifically, the eighth example is an example of a case where attribute information items used as predicted values are a U component value and a V component value of color information of a surrounding three-dimensional point.

(504) As shown in FIG. 57, a predicted value calculated in prediction mode U indicated by a prediction mode value of "0" includes weighted average Uave of U component values Ub1, Ub2, Ua1, Ua0 corresponding to points b1, a2, a1, a0, respectively and weighted average Vave of V component values Vb1, Va2, Va1, Va0 corresponding to points b1, a2, a1, a0, respectively.

Predicted values calculated in prediction modes indicated by prediction mode values of “1” to “4” include U component values and V component values of surrounding three-dimensional points b1, a2, a1, a0, respectively.

(505) For example, when prediction mode UV indicated by a prediction mode value of “1” in the table in FIG. 57 is selected, a U component and a V component as attribute values of a three-dimensional point to be encoded may be used as predicted values Ub1, Vb1 and encoded. In this case, the prediction mode value of “1” is appended to the bitstream.

(506) A prediction mode in encoding may be selected by RD optimization. For example, it is conceivable that cost cost(P) when certain prediction mode P is selected is calculated, and prediction mode P with minimum cost(P) is selected. Cost cost(P) may be calculated by Equation D1 using, for example, prediction residual residual(P) when a predicted value of prediction mode P is used, bit number bit(P) required for encoding prediction mode P, and adjustment parameter value λ .

$$\text{cost}(P) = \text{abs}(\text{residual}(P)) + \lambda \times \text{bit}(P) \quad (\text{Equation D1})$$

where abs(x) denotes an absolute value of x.

(507) A square value of x may be used instead of abs(x).

(508) Using Equation D1 above allows selection of a prediction mode considering balance between a size of a prediction residual and a bit number required for encoding the prediction mode.

Different adjustment parameter values λ may be set in accordance with values of a quantization scale. For example, at a small quantization scale (at a high bit rate), value λ may be set smaller to select a prediction mode with smaller prediction residual residual(P) to increase prediction accuracy as much as possible. At a large quantization scale (at a low bit rate), value λ may be set larger to select an appropriate prediction mode while considering bit number bit(P) required for encoding prediction mode P.

(509) “At a small quantization scale” is, for example, when the quantization scale is smaller than a first quantization scale. “At a large quantization scale” is, for example, when the quantization scale is larger than a second quantization scale equal to or greater than the first quantization scale. Values λ may be set smaller at smaller quantization scales.

(510) Prediction residual residual(P) is calculated by subtracting a predicted value of prediction mode P from an attribute value of a three-dimensional point to be encoded. Instead of prediction residual residual(P) in calculating of cost, prediction residual residual(P) may be quantized or inverse quantized and added to the predicted value to obtain a decoded value, and a difference (encoding error) from a decoded value when an attribute value of an original three-dimensional point and prediction mode P are used may be reflected in the cost value. This allows selection of a prediction mode with a small encoding error.

(511) In binarizing and encoding a prediction mode, for example, a binarized bit number may be used as bit number bit(P) required for encoding prediction mode P. For example, with number M of prediction modes being 5, as in FIG. 58, a prediction mode value indicating the prediction mode may be binarized by a truncated unary code in accordance with number M of prediction modes with a maximum value of 5. In this case, 1 bit for a prediction mode value of “0”, 2 bits for a prediction mode value of “1”, 3 bits for a prediction mode value of “2”, and 4 bits for prediction mode values of “4” and “5” are used as bit numbers bit(P) required for encoding the prediction mode values. By using the truncated unary code, the bit number is set smaller for smaller prediction mode values. This can reduce an encoding amount of a prediction mode value indicating a prediction mode for calculating a predicted value that is more likely to be selected, for example, that is more likely to minimize cost(P), such as an average value calculated as a predicted value when the prediction mode value is “0”, or an attribute information item of a three-dimensional point calculated as a predicted value when the prediction mode value is “1”, that is, an attribute information item of a three-dimensional point close to the three-dimensional point to be encoded.

(512) When a maximum value of the number of prediction modes is not determined, as in FIG. 59,

a prediction mode value indicating a prediction mode may be binarized by a unary code. When a probability of appearance of each prediction mode is close, as shown in FIG. 60, the prediction mode value indicating the prediction mode may be binarized by a fixed code to reduce an encoding amount.

(513) As bit number $\text{bit}(P)$ required for encoding the prediction mode value indicating prediction mode P , binarized data of the prediction mode value indicating prediction mode P may be arithmetic-encoded, and an encoding amount after the arithmetic-encoding may be used as a value of $\text{bit}(P)$. This allows calculation of cost using more accurate required bit number $\text{bit}(P)$, thereby allowing selection of a more appropriate prediction mode.

(514) FIG. 58 is a diagram showing a first example of a binarization table in binarizing and encoding the prediction mode values according to Embodiment 4. Specifically, the first example is an example of binarizing the prediction mode values with a truncated unary code with number M of prediction modes being 5.

(515) FIG. 59 is a diagram showing a second example of a binarization table in binarizing and encoding the prediction mode values according to Embodiment 4. Specifically, the second example is an example of binarizing the prediction mode values with a unary code with number M of prediction modes being 5.

(516) FIG. 60 is a diagram showing a third example of a binarization table in binarizing and encoding the prediction mode values according to Embodiment 4. Specifically, the third example is an example of binarizing the prediction mode values with a fixed code with number M of prediction modes being 5.

(517) A prediction mode value indicating a prediction mode (PredMode) may be arithmetic-encoded after binarized, and appended to the bitstream. As described above, the prediction mode value may be binarized, for example, by the truncated unary code in accordance with number M of prediction modes. In this case, a maximum bit number after binarization of the prediction mode value is $M-1$.

(518) The binary data after binarization may be arithmetic-encoded with reference to an encoding table. In this case, for example, encoding tables may be switched for encoding for each bit of the binary data, thereby improving an encoding efficiency. Also, to reduce the number of encoding tables, among the binary data, the beginning bit one bit may be encoded with reference to encoding table A for one bit, and each of remaining bits may be encoded with reference to encoding table B for remaining bits. For example, in encoding binarized data "1110" with a prediction mode value of "3" in FIG. 61, the beginning bit one bit "1" may be encoded with reference to encoding table A, and each of remaining bits "110" may be encoded with reference to encoding table B.

(519) FIG. 61 is a diagram for describing an example of encoding binary data in the binarization table in binarizing and encoding the prediction modes according to Embodiment 4. The binarization table in FIG. 61 is an example of binarizing the prediction mode values with a truncated unary code with number M of prediction modes being 5.

(520) Thus, an encoding efficiency can be improved by switching the encoding tables in accordance with a bit position of the binary data while reducing the number of encoding tables. Further, in encoding the remaining bits, arithmetic-encoding may be performed by switching the encoding tables for each bit, or decoding may be performed by switching the encoding tables in accordance with a result of the arithmetic-encoding.

(521) In binarizing and encoding the prediction mode value with the truncated unary code using number M of prediction modes, number M of prediction modes used in the truncated unary code may be appended to a header and the like of the bitstream so that the prediction mode can be specified from binary data decoded on a decoding side. Also, value MaxM that may be a value of the number of prediction modes may be defined by standards or the like, and value $\text{MaxM}-M$ ($M \leq \text{MaxM}$) may be appended to the header. Number M of prediction modes may be defined by a profile or a level of standards rather than appended to the stream.

(522) It is considered that the prediction mode value binarized by the truncated unary code is arithmetic-encoded by switching the encoding tables between one bit part and a remaining part as described above. The probability of appearance of 0 and 1 in each encoding table may be updated in accordance with actually generated binary data. Also, the probability of appearance of 0 and 1 in either of the encoding tables may be fixed. Thus, an update frequency of the probability of appearance may be reduced to reduce a processing amount. For example, the probability of appearance of the one bit part may be updated, and the probability of appearance of the remaining bit part may be fixed.

(523) FIG. 62 is a flowchart of an example of encoding a prediction mode value according to Embodiment 4. FIG. 63 is a flowchart of an example of decoding a prediction mode value according to Embodiment 4.

(524) As shown in FIG. 62, in encoding the prediction mode value, first, the prediction mode value is binarized by a truncated unary code in accordance with number M of prediction modes (S3401).

(525) Then, binary data of the truncated unary code is arithmetic-encoded (S3402). Thus, the binary data is included as a prediction mode in the bitstream.

(526) Also, as shown in FIG. 63, in decoding the prediction mode value, first, the bitstream is arithmetic-decoded by using number M of prediction modes to generate binary data of the truncated unary code (S3403).

(527) Then, the prediction mode value is calculated from the binary data of the truncated unary code (S3404).

(528) As a method of binarizing the prediction mode value indicating the prediction mode (PredMode), the example of binarizing with the truncated unary code using number M of prediction modes has been described, but not limited to this. For example, the prediction mode value may be binarized by a truncated unary code in accordance with number L ($L \leq M$) of prediction modes assigned with predicted values. For example, with number M of prediction modes being 5, when two surrounding three-dimensional points are available for prediction of a certain three-dimensional point to be encoded, as shown in FIG. 64, three prediction modes are available and the remaining two prediction modes are not available in some cases. For example, as shown in FIG. 64, with number M of prediction modes being 5, two three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the three-dimensional point to be encoded are available for prediction, and predicted values are not assigned to prediction modes indicated by prediction mode values of “3” and “4” in some cases.

(529) In this case, as shown in FIG. 65, the prediction mode value is binarized by a truncated unary code in accordance with number L of prediction modes assigned with predicted values as a maximum value. This may reduce the bit number after binarization as compared to when the prediction mode value is binarized by the truncated unary code in accordance with number M of prediction modes. For example, in this case, L is 3, and the prediction mode value can be binarized by a truncated unary code in accordance with a maximum value of 3 to reduce the bit number. As such, binarization by the truncated unary code in accordance with number L of prediction modes assigned with predicted values as a maximum value may reduce the bit number after binarization of the prediction mode value.

(530) The binary data after binarization may be arithmetic-encoded with reference to an encoding table. In this case, for example, encoding tables may be switched for encoding for each bit of the binary data, thereby improving an encoding efficiency. Also, to reduce the number of encoding tables, among binarized data, the beginning bit one bit may be encoded with reference to encoding table A for one bit, and each of remaining bits may be encoded with reference to encoding table B for remaining bits. For example, in encoding binarized data “11” with a prediction mode value of “2” in FIG. 65, the beginning bit one bit “1” may be encoded with reference to encoding table A, and remaining bit “1” may be encoded with reference to encoding table B.

(531) FIG. 65 is a diagram for describing an example of encoding binary data in the binarization

table in binarizing and encoding the prediction modes according to Embodiment 4. The binarization table in FIG. 65 is an example of binarizing the prediction mode values with a truncated unary code with number L of prediction modes assigned with predicted values being 3. (532) Thus, an encoding efficiency can be improved by switching the encoding tables in accordance with a bit position of the binary data while reducing the number of encoding tables. Further, in encoding the remaining bits, arithmetic-encoding may be performed by switching the encoding tables for each bit, or decoding may be performed by switching the encoding tables in accordance with a result of the arithmetic-encoding.

(533) In binarizing and encoding the prediction mode value with the truncated unary code using number L of prediction modes assigned with predicted values, a predicted value may be assigned to a prediction mode to calculate number L in the same manner as in encoding and the prediction mode may be decoded by using calculated number L so that the prediction mode can be specified from binary data decoded on a decoding side.

(534) It is considered that the prediction mode value binarized by the truncated unary code is arithmetic-encoded by switching the encoding tables between one bit part and a remaining part as described above. The probability of appearance of 0 and 1 in each encoding table may be updated in accordance with actually generated binary data. Also, the probability of appearance of 0 and 1 in either of the encoding tables may be fixed. Thus, an update frequency of the probability of appearance may be reduced to reduce a processing amount. For example, the probability of appearance of the one bit part may be updated, and the probability of appearance of the remaining bit part may be fixed.

(535) FIG. 66 is flowchart of another example of encoding a prediction mode value according to Embodiment 4. FIG. 67 is a flowchart of another example of decoding a prediction mode value according to Embodiment 4.

(536) As shown in FIG. 66, in encoding the prediction mode value, first, number L of prediction modes assigned with predicted values is calculated (S3411).

(537) Then, the prediction mode value is binarized by a truncated unary code in accordance with number L (S3412).

(538) Then, binary data of the truncated unary code is arithmetic-encoded (S3413).

(539) Also, as shown in FIG. 67, in decoding the prediction mode value, first, number L of prediction modes assigned with predicted values is calculated (S3414).

(540) Then, the bitstream is arithmetic-decoded by using number L to generate binary data of the truncated unary code (S3415).

(541) Then, the prediction mode value is calculated from the binary data of the truncated unary code (S3416).

(542) The prediction mode value needs not be appended for all attribute values. For example, if a certain condition is satisfied, the prediction mode may be fixed so that the prediction mode value is not appended to the bitstream, and if the certain condition is not satisfied, the prediction mode may be selected to append the prediction mode value to the bitstream. For example, if condition A is satisfied, the prediction mode value may be fixed at “0” and a predicted value may be calculated from an average value of surrounding three-dimensional points. If condition A is not satisfied, one prediction mode may be selected from a plurality of prediction modes and a prediction mode value indicating the selected prediction mode may be append to the bitstream.

(543) Certain condition A is, for example, that calculated maximum absolute differential value $\maxdiff$ of attribute values ($a[0]$ to $a[N-1]$) of N (encoded and decoded) three-dimensional points in the vicinity of a three-dimensional point to be encoded is smaller than threshold Th_{fix} . When the maximum absolute differential value of the attribute values of the surrounding three-dimensional points is smaller than threshold Th_{fix} , it is determined that there is a small difference between the attribute values of the three-dimensional points and selecting a prediction mode causes no difference in the predicted value. Then, the prediction mode value is fixed at “0” and the prediction

mode value is not encoded, thereby allowing generation of an appropriate predicted value while reducing an encoding amount for encoding the prediction mode.

(544) Threshold Thfix may be appended to the header and the like of the bitstream, and the encoder may perform encoding while changing threshold Thfix. For example, in encoding at a high bit rate, the encoder may set threshold Thfix smaller than that at a low bit rate and append threshold Thfix to the header and increase the case of encoding by selecting a prediction mode, and thus perform encoding so that the prediction residual is as small as possible. Also, in encoding at the low bit rate, the encoder sets threshold Thfix larger than that at the high bit rate and appends threshold Thfix to the header, and performs encoding in a fixed prediction mode. As such, increasing the case of encoding in the fixed prediction mode at the low bit rate can improve an encoding efficiency while reducing a bit amount for encoding the prediction mode. Threshold Thfix may be defined by a profile or a level of standards rather than appended to the bitstream.

(545) The N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the three-dimensional point to be encoded, which are used for prediction, are N encoded and decoded three-dimensional points with a distance from the three-dimensional point to be encoded being smaller than threshold THd. A maximum value of N may be appended as NumNeighborPoint to the bitstream. The value of N needs not always match NumNeighborPoint as in the case where the number of surrounding encoded and decoded three-dimensional points is smaller than NumNeighborPoint.

(546) The example has been given in which the prediction mode value is fixed at “0” if maximum absolute differential value maxdiff of the attribute values of the three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the three-dimensional point to be encoded, which are used for prediction, is smaller than threshold Thfix[i]. However, not limited to this, the prediction mode value may be fixed at any of “0” to “M-1”. The prediction mode value to be fixed may be appended to the bitstream.

(547) FIG. 68 is a flowchart of an example of a process of determining whether or not a prediction mode value is fixed under condition A in encoding according to Embodiment 4. FIG. 69 is a flowchart of an example of a process of determining whether the prediction mode value is fixed or decoded under condition A in decoding according to Embodiment 4.

(548) As shown in FIG. 68, first, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates maximum absolute differential value maxdiff of attribute values of N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of a three-dimensional point to be encoded (S3421).

(549) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device determines whether or not maximum absolute differential value maxdiff is smaller than threshold Thfix (S3422). Threshold Thfix may be encoded and appended to the header and the like of the stream.

(550) When maximum absolute differential value maxdiff is smaller than threshold Thfix (Yes in S3422), the three-dimensional data encoding device sets the prediction mode value to “0” (S3423).

(551) When maximum absolute differential value maxdiff is equal to or greater than threshold Thfix (No in S3422), the three-dimensional data encoding device selects one prediction mode from a plurality of prediction modes (S3424). A process of selecting the prediction mode will be described later in detail with reference to FIG. 76.

(552) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device arithmetic-encodes a prediction mode value indicating the selected prediction mode (S3425). Specifically, the three-dimensional data encoding device performs steps S3401 and S3402 described with reference to FIG. 62 to arithmetic-encode the prediction mode value. The three-dimensional data encoding device may perform arithmetic-encoding by binarizing prediction mode PredMode with a truncated unary code using the number of prediction modes assigned with predicted values. Specifically, the three-dimensional data encoding device may perform steps S3411 to S3413 described with reference to FIG. 66 to arithmetic-encode the prediction mode value.

(553) The three-dimensional data encoding device calculates a predicted value of the prediction mode set in step S3423 or the prediction mode selected in step S3425 to output the calculated predicted value (S3426). When using the prediction mode value set in step S3423, the three-

dimensional data encoding device calculates an average of attribute values of N surrounding three-dimensional points as a predicted value of a prediction mode indicated by the prediction mode value of “0”.

(554) Also, as shown in FIG. 69, first, the three-dimensional data decoding device calculates maximum absolute differential value maxdiff of attribute values of N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of a three-dimensional point to be decoded (S3431). Maximum absolute differential value maxdiff may be calculated as shown in FIG. 70. Maximum absolute differential value maxdiff is, for example, a maximum value of a plurality of calculated absolute values of differences between all possible pairs when any two of the N surrounding three-dimensional points are paired.

(555) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device determines whether or not maximum absolute differential value maxdiff is smaller than threshold Thfix (S3432). Threshold Thfix may be set by decoding the header and the like of the stream.

(556) When maximum absolute differential value maxdiff is smaller than threshold Thfix (Yes in S3432), the three-dimensional data decoding device sets the prediction mode value to “0” (S3433).

(557) When maximum absolute differential value maxdiff is equal to or greater than threshold Thfix (No in S3432), the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes the prediction mode value from the bitstream (S3434).

(558) The three-dimensional data decoding device calculates a predicted value of a prediction mode indicated by the prediction mode value set in step S3433 or the prediction mode value decoded in step S3434 to output the calculated predicted value (S3435). When using the prediction mode value set in step S3433, the three-dimensional data decoding device calculates an average of attribute values of N surrounding three-dimensional points as a predicted value of a prediction mode indicated by the prediction mode value of “0”.

(559) FIG. 71 is a diagram showing an example of a syntax according to Embodiment 4. NumLoD, NumNeighborPoint[i], NumPredMode[i], Thfix[i], and NumOfPoint[i] in the syntax in FIG. 71 will be sequentially described.

(560) NumLoD indicates the number of LoDs.

(561) NumNeighborPoint[i] indicates an upper limit value of the number of surrounding points used for generating a predicted value of a three-dimensional point belonging to level i. When number M of surrounding points is smaller than NumNeighborPoint[i] ($M < \text{NumNeighborPoint}[i]$), the predicted value may be calculated by using number M of surrounding points. When a value of NumNeighborPoint[i] needs not be divided among LoDs, one NumNeighborPoint may be appended to the header.

(562) NumPredMode[i] is a total number (M) of prediction modes used for predicting an attribute value of level i. Possible value MaxM of the number of prediction modes may be defined by standards or the like, and value MaxM-M ($0 < M \leq \text{MaxM}$) may be appended to the header as NumPredMode[i] and binarized by a truncated unary code in accordance with maximum value MaxM-1 and encoded. Number of prediction modes NumPredMode[i] may be defined by a profile or a level of standards rather than appended to the stream. The number of prediction modes may be defined by NumNeighborPoint[i]+NumPredMode[i]. When the value of NumPredMode[i] needs not be divided among LoDs, one NumPredMode may be appended to the header.

(563) Thfix[i] indicates a threshold of a maximum absolute differential value for determining whether or not a prediction mode of level i is fixed. If the maximum absolute differential value of attribute values of surrounding three-dimensional points used for prediction is smaller than Thfix[i], the prediction mode is fixed at 0. Thfix[i] may be defined by a profile or a level of standards rather than appended to the stream. When the value of Thfix[i] needs not be divided among LoDs, one Thfix may be appended to the header.

(564) NumOfPoint[i] indicates the number of three-dimensional points belonging to level i. When total number AllNumOfPoint of three-dimensional points is appended to another header,

NumOfPoint[NumLoD-1] (the number of three-dimensional points belonging to the lowest level) may be calculated by the following equation:

[Math. 5]

$$\text{AllNumOfPoint} - \sum_{j=0}^{\text{NumLoD}-2} \text{NumOfPoint}[j] \quad (\text{Equation D2})$$

rather than appended to the header. This can reduce an encoding amount of the header.

(565) As a setting example of NumPredMode[i], the value of NumPredMode[i] may be set larger for a higher level at which prediction is more difficult due to a longer distance between three-dimensional points belonging to the level, thereby increasing the number of selectable prediction modes. Also, the value NumPredMode[i] may be set smaller for a lower level at which prediction is easy, thereby reducing a bit amount required for encoding the prediction mode. Such setting can increase the number of selectable prediction modes to reduce a prediction residual at the upper level, and reduce an encoding amount of a prediction mode at the lower level, thereby improving an encoding efficiency.

(566) As a setting example of Thfix[i], the value of Thfix[i] may be set smaller for a higher level at which prediction is difficult due to a long distance from the three-dimensional point belonging to LoD, thereby increasing the case of selecting the prediction mode. Also, the value of Thfix[i] may be set larger value for a lower level at which prediction is easy, and the prediction mode may be fixed to reduce a bit amount required for encoding the prediction mode. Such setting can increase the case of selecting the prediction mode to reduce a prediction residual at the upper level, and fix the prediction mode to reduce an encoding amount of the prediction mode at the lower level, thereby improving an encoding efficiency.

(567) NumLoD, NumNeighborPoint[i], NumPredMode[i], Thfix[i], or NumOfPoint[i] described above may be entropy encoded and appended to the header. For example, the values may be binarized and arithmetic-encoded. The values may be encoded at a fixed length to reduce a processing amount.

(568) FIG. 72 is a diagram showing an example of a syntax according to Embodiment 4.

PredMode, n-bit code, and remaining code in the syntax in FIG. 72 will be sequentially described.

(569) PredMode indicates a prediction mode for encoding and decoding an attribute value of a j-th three-dimensional point in level i. PredMode is “0” to “M-1” (M is a total number of prediction modes). When PredMode is not in the bitstream ($\text{maxdiff} \geq \text{Thfix}[i] \ \&\& \ \text{NumPredMode}[i] > 1$ as a condition is not satisfied), the value of PredMode may be estimated as 0. The value of PredMode may be estimated as any of “0” to “M-1”, not limited to “0”. An estimated value when PredMode is not in the bitstream may be separately appended to the header and the like. PredMode may be binarized by a truncated unary code in accordance with the number of prediction modes assigned with predicted values and arithmetic-encoded.

(570) The n-bit code indicates encoded data of a prediction residual of a value of an attribute information item. A bit length of the n-bit code depends on a value of R_TH[i]. The bit length of the n-bit code is, for example, 6 bits when the value of R_TH[i] is 63, and 8 bits when the value of R_TH[i] is 255.

(571) The remaining code indicates encoded data encoded by Exponential-Golomb among encoded data of the prediction residual of the attribute information item. The remaining code is decoded when the n-bit code is equal to R_TH[i], and the value of the n-bit code is added to the value of the remaining code to decode the prediction residual. When the n-bit code is not equal to R_TH[i], the remaining code needs not be decoded.

(572) Now, a flow of a process of the three-dimensional data encoding device will be described.

FIG. 73 is a flowchart of a three-dimensional data encoding process by the three-dimensional data encoding device according to Embodiment 4.

(573) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device encodes geometry information (geometry) (S3441). For example, three-dimensional data encoding is encoding by using an octree representation.

(574) When a position of a three-dimensional point is changed by quantization or the like after encoding of geometry information, the three-dimensional data encoding device reassigns an attribute information item of an original three-dimensional point to the three-dimensional point after change (S3442). For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device performs reassignment by interpolating a value of the attribute information item in accordance with a change amount of the position. For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device detects N three-dimensional points before change close to the three-dimensional position after change, and performs weighted averaging of values of attribute information items of the N three-dimensional points. For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device determines, in the weighted averaging, a weight based on a distance from the three-dimensional position after change to each of the N three-dimensional points. Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device sets the value obtained by the weighted averaging to a value of an attribute information item of the three-dimensional point after change. When two or more three-dimensional points are changed to the same three-dimensional position by quantization or the like, the three-dimensional data encoding device may assign an average value of attribute information items of two or more three-dimensional points before change as a value of an attribute information item of a three-dimensional point after change.

(575) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device encodes the attribute information item (Attribute) after reassignment (S3443). For example, when encoding multiple types of attribute information items, the three-dimensional data encoding device may sequentially encode the multiple types of attribute information items. For example, when encoding a color and a reflectance as attribute information items, the three-dimensional data encoding device may generate a bitstream appended with a color encoding result followed by a reflectance encoding result. The plurality of encoding results of the attribute information items may be appended to the bitstream in any order, not limited to this.

(576) The three-dimensional data encoding device may append information indicating an encoded data start location of each attribute information item in the bitstream to the header and the like. Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device can selectively decode an attribute information item that requires decoding, thereby omitting a decoding process of an attribute information item that does not require decoding. This can reduce a processing amount of the three-dimensional data decoding device. The three-dimensional data encoding device may concurrently encode multiple types of attribute information items, and combine encoding results into one bitstream. Thus, the three-dimensional data encoding device can quickly encode the multiple types of attribute information items.

(577) FIG. 74 is a flowchart of an attribute information item encoding process (S3443) according to Embodiment 4. First, the three-dimensional data encoding device sets LoD (S3451). Specifically, the three-dimensional data encoding device assigns each three-dimensional point to any of a plurality of LoDs.

(578) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device starts a loop for each LoD (S3452). Specifically, the three-dimensional data encoding device repeats processes in steps S3453 to S3461 for each LoD.

(579) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device starts a loop for each three-dimensional point (S3453). Specifically, the three-dimensional data encoding device repeats processes in steps S3454 to S3460 for each three-dimensional point.

(580) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device searches a plurality of surrounding points that are three-dimensional points in the vicinity of a target three-dimensional point to be processed and used for calculating a predicted value of the target three-dimensional point (S3454).

(581) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates predicted value P of the target three-dimensional point (S3455). A specific example of a calculation process of predicted value P will be described later with reference to FIG. 75.

(582) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates, as a prediction residual, a difference between an attribute information item of the target three-dimensional point and the predicted value (S3456).

(583) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device quantizes the prediction residual to calculate a quantized value (S3457).

(584) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device arithmetic-encodes the quantized value (S3458).

(585) The three-dimensional data encoding device inverse quantizes the quantized value to calculate an inverse quantized value (S3459).

(586) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device adds the predicted value to the inverse quantized value to generate a decoded value (S3460).

(587) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device finishes the loop for each three-dimensional point (S3461).

(588) The three-dimensional data encoding device also finishes the loop for each LoD (S3462).

(589) FIG. 75 is a flowchart of a predicted value calculation process (S3455) by the three-dimensional data encoding device according to Embodiment 4.

(590) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates a weighted average of attribute values of the N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the target three-dimensional point to be processed, which can be used for predicting a predicted value of the target three-dimensional point, and assigns the calculated weighted average to a prediction mode indicated by a prediction mode value of "0" (S3420).

(591) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device performs steps S3421 to S3426 described with reference to FIG. 68 to output a predicted value of the target three-dimensional point.

(592) FIG. 76 is a flowchart of a prediction mode selection process (S3424) according to Embodiment 4.

(593) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device assigns attribute information items of the N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the target three-dimensional point to prediction mode values of "1" to "N" in one increment sequentially from a three-dimensional point closer to the target three-dimensional point (S3427). The prediction mode values of "0" to "N" are assigned, and thus a total of N+1 prediction modes are generated. When N+1 is larger than maximum number M of prediction modes (NumPredMode) appended to the bitstream, the three-dimensional data encoding device may generate up to M prediction modes.

(594) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates cost of each prediction mode, and selects a prediction mode with minimum cost (S3428).

(595) FIG. 77 is a flowchart of a prediction mode selection process (S3428) that minimizes cost according to Embodiment 4.

(596) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device sets $i=0$ and $\text{mincost}=\infty$ as initial values (S3471). The set initial values of i and mincost are stored in a memory of the three-dimensional data encoding device.

(597) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates cost $\text{cost}[i]$ of i -th prediction mode $\text{PredMode}[i]$ using, for example, Equation D1 (S3472).

(598) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device determines whether or not calculated cost $\text{cost}[i]$ is smaller than mincost stored in the memory (S3473).

(599) Then, when calculated cost $\text{cost}[i]$ is smaller than mincost stored in the memory (Yes in S3473), the three-dimensional data encoding device sets $\text{mincost}=\text{cost}[i]$, sets the prediction mode to $\text{predmode}[i]$ (S3474), and goes to step S3475. Specifically, the value of mincost stored in the memory is updated to the value of $\text{cost}[i]$, and $\text{predmode}[i]$ is stored as a prediction mode in the memory.

(600) When, calculated cost $\text{cost}[i]$ is equal to or greater than mincost stored in the memory (No in S3473), the three-dimensional data encoding device goes to step S3475.

(601) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device increments the value of i by one (S3475).

(602) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device determines whether or not i is smaller than the number of prediction modes (S3476).

(603) When i is smaller than the number of prediction modes (Yes in S3476), the three-dimensional data encoding device returns to step S3472, and when not (No in S3476), the three-dimensional data encoding device finishes the process of selecting the prediction mode that minimizes cost.

(604) Now, a flow of a process of the three-dimensional data decoding device will be described. FIG. 78 is a flowchart of a three-dimensional data decoding process by the three-dimensional data decoding device according to Embodiment 4. First, the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes the geometry information (geometry) from the bitstream (S3444). For example, the three-dimensional data decoding device performs decoding by using an octree representation.

(605) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes an attribute information item (Attribute) from the bitstream (S3445). For example, when decoding multiple types of attribute information items, the three-dimensional data decoding device may sequentially decode the multiple types of attribute information items. For example, when decoding a color and a reflectance as attribute information items, the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes a color encoding result and a reflectance encoding result in the order of appending to the bitstream. For example, when the bitstream is appended with the color encoding result followed by the reflectance encoding result, the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes the color encoding result and then decodes the reflectance encoding result. The three-dimensional data decoding device may decode encoding results of the attribute information items appended to the bitstream in any order.

(606) The three-dimensional data decoding device may obtain information indicating an encoded data start location of each attribute information item in the bitstream by decoding the header and the like. Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device can selectively decode an attribute information item that requires decoding, thereby omitting a decoding process of an attribute information item that does not require decoding. This can reduce a processing amount of the three-dimensional data decoding device. The three-dimensional data decoding device may concurrently decode multiple types of attribute information items, and combine decoding results into one three-dimensional point cloud. Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device can quickly decode the multiple types of attribute information items.

(607) FIG. 79 is a flowchart of an attribute information item decoding process (S3445) according to Embodiment 4. First, the three-dimensional data decoding device sets LoD (S3481). Specifically, the three-dimensional data decoding device assigns each of a plurality of three-dimensional points having decoded geometry information to any of a plurality of LoDs. For example, this assignment method is the same as that used by the three-dimensional data encoding device.

(608) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device starts a loop for each LoD (S3482). Specifically, the three-dimensional data decoding device repeats processes in steps S3483 to S3489 for each LoD.

(609) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device starts a loop for each three-dimensional point (S3483). Specifically, the three-dimensional data decoding device repeats processes in steps S3484 to S3488 for each three-dimensional point.

(610) First, the three-dimensional data decoding device searches a plurality of surrounding points that are three-dimensional points in the vicinity of a target three-dimensional point to be processed and used for calculating a predicted value of the target three-dimensional point (S3484). This process is the same as that by the three-dimensional data encoding device.

(611) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device calculates predicted value P of the target three-dimensional point (S3485).

(612) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device arithmetic-decodes a quantized value from the bitstream (S3486).

(613) The three-dimensional data decoding device also inverse quantizes the decoded quantized

value to calculate an inverse quantized value (S3487).

(614) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device adds the predicted value to the inverse quantized value to generate a decoded value (S3488).

(615) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device finishes the loop for each three-dimensional point (S3489).

(616) The three-dimensional data decoding device also finishes the loop for each LoD (S3490).

(617) FIG. 80 is a flowchart of a predicted value calculation process (S3485) by the three-dimensional data decoding device according to Embodiment 4.

(618) First, the three-dimensional data decoding device calculates a weighted average of attribute values of the N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the target three-dimensional point to be processed, which can be used for predicting a predicted value of the target three-dimensional point, and assigns the calculated weighted average to a prediction mode indicated by a prediction mode value of "0" (S3430).

(619) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device performs steps S3431 to S3435 described with reference to FIG. 69 to output a predicted value of the target three-dimensional point.

(620) Instead of performing step S3430, after it is determined Yes in step S3432 or when the prediction mode value decoded in step S3434 is "0", the weighted average of the attribute values of the N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the target three-dimensional point to be processed, which can be used for predicting a predicted value of the target three-dimensional point, may be calculated as a predicted value. This eliminates the need to calculate the average value in prediction modes other than the prediction mode indicated by the prediction mode value of "0", thereby reducing a processing amount.

(621) FIG. 81 is a flowchart of a prediction mode decoding process (S3434) according to Embodiment 4.

(622) First, the three-dimensional data decoding device assigns attribute information items of the N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the target three-dimensional point to prediction mode values of "1" to "N" in one increment sequentially from a three-dimensional point closer to the target three-dimensional point (S3491). The prediction mode values of "0" to "N" are assigned, and thus a total of N+1 prediction modes are generated. When N+1 is larger than maximum number M of prediction modes (NumPredMode) appended to the bitstream, the three-dimensional data decoding device may generate up to M prediction modes.

(623) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device arithmetic-decodes the prediction mode by using the number of prediction modes (S3492). Specifically, the three-dimensional data decoding device may perform steps S3403 and S3404 described with reference to FIG. 63 to arithmetic-decode the prediction mode. The three-dimensional data decoding device may also perform steps S3414 to S3416 described with reference to FIG. 67 to arithmetic-decode the prediction mode.

(624) FIG. 82 is a block diagram showing a configuration of attribute information encoder 3100 included in the three-dimensional data encoding device according to Embodiment 4. FIG. 82 shows an attribute information encoder in detail among a geometry information encoder, an attribute information item reassigner, and the attribute information encoder included in the three-dimensional data encoding device.

(625) Attribute information encoder 3400 includes LoD generator 3401, surrounding searcher 3402, predictor 3403, prediction residual calculator 3404, quantizer 3405, arithmetic encoder 3406, inverse quantizer 3407, decoded value generator 3408, and memory 3409.

(626) LoD generator 3401 generates LoD by using geometry information (geometry) of a three-dimensional point.

(627) Surrounding searcher 3402 searches a neighboring three-dimensional point adjacent to each three-dimensional point by using an LoD generation result by LoD generator 3401 and distance information indicating a distance between three-dimensional points.

(628) Predictor 3403 generates a predicted value of an attribute information item of a target three-

dimensional point to be encoded. Specifically, predictor **3403** assigns predicted values to prediction modes indicated by prediction mode values of “0” to “M-1”, and selects a prediction mode. Predictor **3403** outputs the selected prediction mode, specifically, the prediction mode value indicating the prediction mode to the arithmetic encoder. Predictor **3403** performs, for example, the process in step **S3455**.

(629) Prediction residual calculator **3404** calculates (generates) a prediction residual of the predicted value of the attribute information item generated by predictor **3403**. Prediction residual calculator **3404** performs the process in step **S3456**.

(630) Quantizer **3405** quantizes the prediction residual of the attribute information item calculated by prediction residual calculator **3404**.

(631) Arithmetic encoder **3106** arithmetic-encodes the prediction residual quantized by quantizer **3105**. Arithmetic encoder **3406** outputs a bitstream including the arithmetic-encoded prediction residual, for example, to the three-dimensional data decoding device.

(632) The prediction residual may be binarized, for example, by quantizer **3405** before arithmetic-encoded by arithmetic encoder **3406**. Arithmetic encoder **3406** may generate and encode various header information items (header information). Arithmetic encoder **3406** may also obtain a prediction mode used for encoding from Prediction block, and arithmetic-encode and append the prediction mode to the bitstream.

(633) Inverse quantizer **3407** inverse quantizes the prediction residual quantized by quantizer **3405**. Inverse quantizer **3407** performs the process in step **S3459**.

(634) Decoded value generator **3408** adds the predicted value of the attribute information item generated by predictor **3403** to the prediction residual inverse quantized by inverse quantizer **3407** to generate a decoded value.

(635) Memory **3409** stores a decoded value of an attribute information item of each three-dimensional point decoded by decoded value generator **3408**. For example, when generating a predicted value of a three-dimensional point having been not yet encoded, predictor **3403** generates a predicted value by using the decoded value of the attribute information item of each three-dimensional point stored in memory **3409**.

(636) FIG. **83** is a block diagram of a configuration of attribute information decoder **3410** included in the three-dimensional data decoding device according to Embodiment 4. FIG. **83** shows an attribute information decoder in detail among a geometry information decoder and the attribute information decoder included in the three-dimensional data decoding device.

(637) Attribute information decoder **3410** includes LoD generator **3411**, surrounding searcher **3412**, predictor **3413**, arithmetic decoder **3414**, inverse quantizer **3415**, decoded value generator **3416**, and memory **3417**.

(638) LoD generator **3411** generates LoD by using geometry information (geometry information) of a three-dimensional point decoded by a geometry information decoder (not shown).

(639) Surrounding searcher **3412** searches a neighboring three-dimensional point adjacent to each three-dimensional point by using an LoD generation result by LoD generator **3411** and distance information indicating a distance between three-dimensional points.

(640) Predictor **3413** generates a predicted value of an attribute information item of a target three-dimensional point to be decoded. Predictor **3413** performs, for example, the process in step **S3485**.

(641) Arithmetic decoder **3414** arithmetic-decodes the prediction residual in the bitstream obtained by attribute information encoder **3400**. Arithmetic decoder **3414** may decode various header information items. Arithmetic decoder **3414** may also output an arithmetic-decoded prediction mode to predictor **3413**. In this case, predictor **3413** may calculate a predicted value by using the prediction mode obtained by arithmetic decoding by arithmetic decoder **3414**.

(642) Inverse quantizer **3415** inverse quantizes the prediction residual arithmetic-decoded by arithmetic decoder **3414**.

(643) Decoded value generator **3416** adds the predicted value generated by predictor **3413** and the

prediction residual inverse quantized by inverse quantizer **3415** to generate a decoded value. Decoded value generator **3416** outputs decoded attribute information data to any other device. (644) Memory **3417** stores a decoded value of an attribute information item of each three-dimensional point decoded by decoded value generator **3416**. For example, when generating a predicted value of a three-dimensional point having been not yet decoded, predictor **3413** generates a predicted value by using the decoded value of the attribute information item of each three-dimensional point stored in memory **3417**;

Embodiment 5

(645) As described above, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates a maximum absolute differential value of attribute values of N three-dimensional points (surrounding three-dimensional points) in the vicinity of a target three-dimensional point to be encoded, which can be used for prediction by the three-dimensional data encoding device and the three-dimensional data decoding device (that is, a maximum absolute value of a difference between attribute values of any two three-dimensional points among the N three-dimensional points). The three-dimensional data encoding device also switches between fixing a prediction mode in accordance with the calculated maximum absolute differential value, that is, using an arbitrarily predetermined prediction mode, and selecting and appending a prediction mode to the bitstream.

(646) However, the three-dimensional data encoding device needs not switch between fixing a prediction mode in accordance with the maximum absolute differential value, and selecting and appending a prediction mode to the bitstream. For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device may select whether to fix the prediction mode under the condition described above or select the prediction mode, and append the result as a prediction mode fixing flag to the bitstream.

(647) Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device can decode the prediction mode fixing flag appended to the bitstream to determine whether the three-dimensional data encoding device has fixed the prediction mode or has selected and encoded the prediction mode.

(648) When the three-dimensional data encoding device has fixed the prediction mode, the three-dimensional data decoding device can determine that the prediction mode is not encoded in the bitstream. When the three-dimensional data encoding device has selected the prediction mode, the three-dimensional data decoding device can determine that the prediction mode in the bitstream requires decoding. Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device can correctly decode the encoded prediction mode included in the bitstream.

(649) Also, the three-dimensional data decoding device can arithmetic-decode the prediction mode without calculating a maximum absolute differential value of attribute values of N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of a target three-dimensional point to be encoded, which can be used for prediction. Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device can concurrently perform arithmetic-decoding of the bitstream and LoD generation and the like. As a result, the three-dimensional data decoding device can increase throughput of the entire process.

(650) The three-dimensional data encoding device may append a prediction mode fixing flag for each three-dimensional point.

(651) Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device can switch between fixing the prediction mode and selecting the prediction mode for each three-dimensional point in accordance with the prediction mode fixing flag. Thus, the three-dimensional data encoding device can improve an encoding efficiency.

(652) The three-dimensional data encoding device may set a prediction mode fixing flag for each LoD. For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device sets the prediction mode fixing flag to 0 to select a prediction mode for an upper level, among LoDs, at which prediction is difficult, and sets the prediction mode fixing flag to 1 to fix the prediction mode for a lower level at which prediction is easy. Thus, the three-dimensional data encoding device can reduce an encoding amount for appending the prediction mode.

(653) FIG. **84** is a flowchart of a prediction mode determination process performed by the three-

dimensional data encoding device according to this embodiment.

(654) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates maximum absolute differential value maxdiff of attribute values of N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of a target three-dimensional point to be encoded (S3501).

(655) FIG. 85 is a diagram showing an example of a syntax of the prediction mode determination process performed by the three-dimensional data encoding device according to this embodiment. Specifically, FIG. 85 shows an example of a syntax in step S3501 shown in FIG. 84.

(656) In FIG. 85, the attribute values of the N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the target three-dimensional point to be encoded are denoted by $a[0]$ to $a[N-1]$, and the maximum absolute differential value is denoted by maxdiff . The attribute values of the N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the target three-dimensional point to be encoded are attribute values encoded by the three-dimensional data encoding device and decoded by the three-dimensional data decoding device.

(657) The three-dimensional data encoding device calculates maximum absolute differential value maxdiff , for example, by the example of the syntax shown in FIG. 85.

(658) The N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the target three-dimensional point to be encoded, which are used for prediction by the three-dimensional data encoding device, are N encoded and decoded three-dimensional points with a distance from the target three-dimensional point to be encoded shorter than threshold THd .

(659) Here, as described above, the three-dimensional data encoding device may append a maximum value of N as NumNeighborPoint to the bitstream. The value of N needs not match NumNeighborPoint as in the case where the number of encoded and decoded three-dimensional points in attribute information items (pieces of attribute information) of the three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the target three-dimensional point to be encoded is smaller than NumNeighborPoint .

(660) Again with reference to FIG. 84, the three-dimensional data encoding device then determines whether or not $\text{maxdiff} < \text{Thfix}$ is satisfied (S3502). Thfix is an arbitrarily predetermined constant.

(661) When determining that $\text{maxdiff} < \text{Thfix}$ is satisfied (Yes in S3502), the three-dimensional data encoding device performs arithmetic-encoding with a prediction mode fixing flag (fixedPredMode) being 1 (S3503).

(662) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device sets a prediction mode value (PredMode /hereinafter also simply referred to as a prediction mode) to 0 (S3504).

(663) When determining that $\text{maxdiff} < \text{Thfix}$ is not satisfied (No in S3502), the three-dimensional data encoding device performs arithmetic-encoding with the prediction mode fixing flag being 0 (S3505).

(664) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device selects a prediction mode (S3506).

(665) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device arithmetic-encodes the selected prediction mode (S3507).

(666) The example has been given above in which the three-dimensional data encoding device fixes the prediction mode at 0 if the maximum absolute differential value of the attribute values of the three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the target three-dimensional point to be encoded, which are used for prediction, is smaller than $\text{Thfix}[i]$, but not limited to this. For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device may fix the prediction mode at any of 0 to $M-1$.

(667) The three-dimensional data encoding device may append a value of a fixed prediction mode (also referred to as PredMode or mode number) to the bitstream.

(668) FIG. 86 is a flowchart of a prediction mode determination process performed by the three-dimensional data decoding device according to this embodiment.

(669) First, the three-dimensional data decoding device arithmetic-decodes an encoded prediction mode fixing flag included in the bitstream (S3511).

(670) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device determines whether or not the prediction

mode fixing flag==1 is satisfied (S3512).

(671) When determining that the prediction mode fixing flag==1 is satisfied (Yes in S3512), the three-dimensional data decoding device sets the prediction mode value to 0 (S3513).

(672) When determining that the prediction mode fixing flag==1 is not satisfied (No in S3512), the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes the prediction mode value from the bitstream and determines the prediction mode value (S3514).

(673) The three-dimensional data decoding device determines a predicted value in accordance with the determined prediction mode.

(674) The prediction mode fixing flag may be provided in any position.

(675) FIG. 87 is a diagram showing an example of a syntax of attribute data when a prediction mode fixing flag is provided for each three-dimensional point.

(676) fixedPredMode is a flag indicating if the three-dimensional data encoding device fixes a prediction mode. For example, when a value of fixedPredMode is 1, the three-dimensional data encoding device may fix a prediction mode, and when the value of fixedPredMode is 0, the three-dimensional data encoding device may select a prediction mode.

(677) fixedPredMode may be also set for each LoD as in FIG. 88.

(678) FIG. 88 is a diagram showing an example of a syntax of attribute data when a prediction mode fixing flag is provided for each LoD.

(679) fixedPredMode[i] is a flag indicating if a prediction mode of level i of LoD is fixed.

(680) PredMode is a value indicating a prediction mode for encoding and decoding an attribute value of a j-th three-dimensional point at level i. PredMode takes any of 0 to M-1 (M is a total number of prediction modes). When PredMode is not in the bitstream (specifically, when !fixedPredMode&&NumPredMode[i]>1 is not satisfied), the three-dimensional data decoding device may estimate PredMode as 0.

(681) When PredMode is not in the bitstream, the three-dimensional data decoding device needs not set PredMode to 0, and may use any of 0 to M-1 as an estimated value.

(682) The three-dimensional data encoding device may separately append, to a header and the like, the estimated value when PredMode is not in the bitstream.

(683) As described above, the three-dimensional data encoding device may binarize PredMode by truncated unary coding using total number M of prediction modes, and arithmetic-encode the binarized value.

(684) The truncated unary coding is one method of binarization. By using the truncated unary coding, for a multivalued signal taking a value other than a maximum value, a signal is generated including the same number of 1s as indicated by the multivalued signal, with 0 at the end. For a multivalued signal taking a maximum value, the maximum value is previously set, and a signal is generated including the same number of 1s as indicated by the multivalued signal (without 0 at the end). For example, as described above, when the number of prediction modes is 5, and the three-dimensional data encoding device binarizes each of the prediction modes by using the truncated unary coding, prediction modes 0 to 4 are sequentially represented by 0, 10, 110, 1110, 1111. As such, the three-dimensional data encoding device binarizes the prediction mode by the truncated unary coding using the number of prediction modes (that is, in accordance with the number of prediction modes).

(685) By using the truncated unary coding, for a multivalued signal taking a value other than the maximum value, a signal may be generated including the same number of 0s as indicated by the multivalued signal, with 1 at the end. Specifically, 0(s) and 1(s) described above may be inverted.

(686) The three-dimensional data encoding device may arithmetic-encode, as NumPredMode, the value of total number M of prediction modes, and append NumPredMode to the header.

(687) NumPredMode is a value indicating the total number of prediction modes.

(688) Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device can decode NumPredMode in the header to calculate total number M of prediction modes, and decode PredMode in accordance with total

number M of prediction modes. Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device can set (generate) LoD, calculate three-dimensional points in the vicinity of a target three-dimensional point to be decoded, which can be used for prediction, and perform arithmetic-decoding of the bitstream without waiting for calculation of the number of prediction modes assigned with predicted values. As a result, the three-dimensional data decoding device can concurrently perform arithmetic-decoding of the bitstream and LoD generation and the like, thereby increasing throughput of the entire process.

(689) An n-bit code is encoded data of a prediction residual of a value of an attribute information item (attribute information). A bit length of the n-bit code depends on a value of R_TH[i]. For example, the bit length is 6 bits when the value of R_TH[i] is 63, and 8 bits when the value of R_TH[i] is 255. Any value of R_TH may be previously set.

(690) A remaining code is encoded data encoded by an Exponential-Golomb code among encoded data of the prediction residual of the value of the attribute information item. The three-dimensional data decoding device decodes the remaining code when the n-bit code is equal to R_TH[i], and adds the value of the n-bit code to the value of the remaining code to decode the prediction residual.

(691) When the n-bit code is not equal to R_TH[i], the three-dimensional data decoding device needs not decode the remaining code.

(692) FIG. **89** is a flowchart of an example of a prediction mode encoding process by the three-dimensional data encoding device.

(693) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device binarizes the prediction mode by the truncated unary coding using total number M of prediction modes (S3521).

(694) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device arithmetic-encodes binary data of the truncated unary coding (S3522).

(695) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device appends total number M of prediction modes as NumPredMode to the header and encodes NumPredMode (S3523).

(696) The three-dimensional data encoding device transmits a bitstream including, for example, encoded NumPredMode to the three-dimensional data decoding device.

(697) FIG. **90** is a flowchart of an example of a prediction mode decoding process by the three-dimensional data decoding device.

(698) First, the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes encoded NumPredMode included in the bitstream to set total number M of prediction modes (S3524).

(699) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device arithmetic-decodes encoded PredMode in accordance with decoded total number M of prediction modes, and generates binary data of the truncated unary coding (S3525).

(700) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device calculates a prediction mode from the binary data of the truncated unary coding (S3526).

(701) The three-dimensional data encoding device may arithmetic-encode fixedPredMode described above with reference to an encoding table. The three-dimensional data encoding device may update the probability of appearance of 0 and 1 in the encoding table in accordance with a value of actually generated fixedPredMode. The three-dimensional data encoding device may fix the probability of appearance of 0 and 1 in either of encoding tables. Thus, the three-dimensional data encoding device can reduce an update frequency of the probability of appearance of 0 and 1 in the encoding table to reduce a processing amount.

(702) FIG. **91** is a flowchart of a three-dimensional data encoding process by the three-dimensional data encoding device according to this embodiment.

(703) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device encodes geometry information (geometry) (S3531). For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device may perform encoding by using an octree representation.

(704) Then, when a position of a three-dimensional point is changed by quantization or the like

after encoding of the geometry information, the three-dimensional data encoding device reassigns an attribute information item of an original three-dimensional point to the three-dimensional point after change (S3532).

(705) The three-dimensional data encoding device may perform reassignment by interpolating a value of the attribute information item in accordance with a change amount of the position. For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device may detect N three-dimensional points before change in the vicinity of a target three-dimensional point to be encoded, which are close to the three-dimensional position after change. Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device may perform weighted averaging of values of attribute information items of the detected N three-dimensional points in accordance with a distance from the target three-dimensional position to be encoded after change to each of the N three-dimensional points, and set the weighted average value as a value of an attribute information item of the three-dimensional point after change. When two or more three-dimensional points are changed to the same three-dimensional position by quantization or the like, the three-dimensional data encoding device may assign an average value of attribute information items of two or more three-dimensional points before change as a value of an attribute information item of a three-dimensional point after change.

(706) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device encodes the attribute information item (Attribute) after reassignment (S3533). For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device may sequentially encode a plurality of attribute information items.

(707) Also, for example, when encoding a color and a reflectance as attribute information items, the three-dimensional data encoding device may generate a bitstream appended with a color encoding result followed by a reflectance encoding result.

(708) The three-dimensional data encoding device may append the encoding results of the attribute information items to the bitstream in any order. The three-dimensional data encoding device may append, to the header and the like, an encoded data start location of each attribute information item in the bitstream.

(709) Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device can decode an attribute information item that requires decoding. As a result, the three-dimensional data decoding device can omit a decoding process of an attribute information item that does not require decoding, thereby reducing a processing amount.

(710) The three-dimensional data encoding device may concurrently encode a plurality of attribute information items, and combine encoding results into one bitstream.

(711) Thus, the three-dimensional data encoding device can quickly encode the plurality of attribute information items.

(712) FIG. 92 is a flowchart of an attribute information item encoding process (S3533) shown in FIG. 91.

(713) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device sets LoD (S35331). Specifically, the three-dimensional data encoding device assigns each three-dimensional point to any of a plurality of LoDs.

(714) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device starts a loop for each LoD (S35332). Specifically, the three-dimensional data encoding device repeats processes in steps S35333 to S35341 for each LoD.

(715) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device starts a loop for each three-dimensional point (S35333). Specifically, the three-dimensional data encoding device repeats processes in steps S35334 to S35340 for each three-dimensional point at a certain LoD. FIG. 92 shows encoding of target three-dimensional point P to be encoded.

(716) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device searches a plurality of surrounding points that are three-dimensional points in the vicinity of target three-dimensional point P to be processed and used for calculating a predicted value of target three-dimensional point P (S35334).

(717) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates a predicted value of target three-

dimensional point P (S35335).

(718) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates, as a prediction residual, a difference between an attribute information item of target three-dimensional point P and the predicted value (S35336).

(719) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device quantizes the prediction residual to calculate a quantized value (S35337).

(720) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device arithmetic-encodes the quantized value (S35338).

(721) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device inverse quantizes the quantized value to calculate an inverse quantized value (S35339).

(722) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device adds the predicted value to the inverse quantized value to generate a decoded value (S35340).

(723) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device finishes the loop for each three-dimensional point (S35341).

(724) The three-dimensional data encoding device also finishes the loop for each LoD (S35342).

(725) FIG. 93 is a flowchart of a predicted-value calculation process (S35335) shown in FIG. 92.

(726) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates a weighted average value of attribute values of the N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the target three-dimensional point to be encoded, which can be used for prediction, and assigns the calculated weighted average value to prediction mode 0 (S353351).

(727) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates maximum absolute differential value maxdiff of the attribute values of the N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the target three-dimensional point to be encoded (S353352).

(728) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device determines whether or not maximum absolute differential value maxdiff<Thfix is satisfied (S353353).

(729) When determining that maximum absolute differential value maxdiff<Thfix is satisfied (Yes in S353353), the three-dimensional data encoding device performs arithmetic-encoding with a prediction mode fixing flag being 1 (S353354).

(730) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device sets the prediction mode to 0 (prediction mode for indicating the weighted average value as a predicted value) (S353355).

(731) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device arithmetic-encodes the predicted value of the set prediction mode, and outputs the predicted value to, for example, the three-dimensional data decoding device (S353356).

(732) When determining that maximum absolute differential value maxdiff<Thfix is not satisfied (No in S353353), the three-dimensional data encoding device performs arithmetic-encoding with the prediction mode fixing flag being 0 (S353357).

(733) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device selects and determines a prediction mode (S353358).

(734) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device arithmetic-encodes the selected and determined prediction mode (S353359).

(735) As described above, the three-dimensional data encoding device may binarize prediction mode PredMode by truncated unary coding using total number M of prediction modes and arithmetic-encode PredMode. The three-dimensional data encoding device may encode total number M of prediction modes as NumPredMode and append NumPredMode to the header.

(736) Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device can decode NumPredMode in the header, thereby correctly decoding prediction mode PredMode.

(737) When NumPredMode is 1, the three-dimensional data encoding device needs not encode PredMode. Thus, the three-dimensional data encoding device can reduce an encoding amount when NumPredMode is 1.

(738) FIG. 94 is a flowchart of a prediction mode selection process (S353358) shown in FIG. 93.

(739) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device assigns attribute information items of the N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the target three-dimensional point to be encoded to prediction modes 1 to N sequentially from a three-dimensional point closer to the target three-dimensional point (S3541). For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device generates N+1 prediction modes. When N+1 is larger than total number M of prediction modes (NumPredMode) appended to the bitstream, the three-dimensional data encoding device may generate up to M prediction modes.

(740) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates cost of each prediction mode, and selects a prediction mode with minimum cost (S3542).

(741) FIG. 95 is a flowchart of a specific example of the prediction mode selection process (S3542) shown in FIG. 94.

(742) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device sets $i=0$ and $\text{mincost}=\infty$ (S35421).

(743) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates cost ($\text{cost}[i]$) of i -th prediction mode $\text{PredMode}[i]$ (S35422).

(744) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device determines whether or not $\text{cost}[i]<\text{mincost}$ is satisfied (S35423).

(745) Then, when determining that $\text{cost}[i]<\text{mincost}$ is satisfied (Yes in S35423), the three-dimensional data encoding device sets $\text{mincost}=\text{cost}[i]$, and sets the prediction mode to $\text{PredMode}[i]$ (S35424).

(746) Following step S35424 or when determining that $\text{cost}[i]<\text{mincost}$ is not satisfied (No in S35423), the three-dimensional data encoding device sets $i=i+1$ (S35425).

(747) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device determines whether or not $i<\text{the number of prediction modes (total number of prediction modes)}$ is satisfied (S35426).

(748) When determining that $i<\text{the number of prediction modes}$ is not satisfied (No in S35426), the three-dimensional data encoding device finishes the selection process. When determining that $i<\text{the number of prediction modes}$ is satisfied (Yes in S35426), the three-dimensional data encoding device returns the process to step S35422.

(749) FIG. 96 is a flowchart of a three-dimensional data decoding process by the three-dimensional data decoding device according to this embodiment.

(750) The three-dimensional data decoding device decodes geometry information (geometry) of an encoded three-dimensional point (S3551). For example, the three-dimensional data decoding device may decode the geometry information by using an octree representation.

(751) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes an attribute information item of the encoded three-dimensional point (S3552).

(752) The three-dimensional data decoding device may sequentially decode a plurality of attribute information items. For example, when decoding a color and a reflectance as attribute information items, the three-dimensional data decoding device may decode a bitstream appended with a color encoding result followed by a reflectance encoding result in this order.

(753) The three-dimensional data decoding device may decode the encoding results of the attribute information items appended to the bitstream in any order.

(754) The three-dimensional data decoding device may obtain an encoded data start location of each attribute information item in the bitstream by decoding the header and the like.

(755) Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device can decode an attribute information item that requires decoding. As a result, the three-dimensional data decoding device can omit a decoding process of an attribute information item that does not require decoding, thereby reducing a processing amount.

(756) The three-dimensional data decoding device may concurrently decode a plurality of attribute information items, and combine decoding results into one three-dimensional point cloud.

(757) Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device can quickly decode the plurality of attribute information items.

(758) FIG. 97 is a flowchart of a calculation process of a predicted value of P (S3552) shown in FIG. 96.

(759) First, the three-dimensional data decoding device obtains decoded geometry information of a three-dimensional point included in the bitstream (S35520). Specifically, the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes encoded geometry information of a three-dimensional point included in the bitstream transmitted from the three-dimensional data encoding device, and thus obtains the decoded geometry information.

(760) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device sets LoD (S35521). Specifically, the three-dimensional data decoding device assigns each three-dimensional point to any of a plurality of LoDs.

(761) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device starts a loop for each LoD (S35522). Specifically, the three-dimensional data decoding device repeats processes in steps S35523 to S35528 for each LoD.

(762) The three-dimensional data decoding device obtains an attribute information item included in the bitstream concurrently with, for example, the processes in step S35520 and thereafter (S355201).

(763) The three-dimensional data decoding device decodes PredMode and a quantized value of P (S355211).

(764) For example, in steps in the dashed-line encircled portion (more specifically, steps S35521 and step S355211) in FIG. 97, the three-dimensional data decoding device can append the number of three-dimensional points NumOfPoint for each LoD to the header and the like, and thus independently perform a decoding process of PredMode in the bitstream and a process of calculating three-dimensional points in the vicinity of a target three-dimensional point to be decoded, which can be used for prediction after LoD generation. Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device can independently perform LoD generation and searching of a neighboring point of P, and an arithmetic-decoding process of PredMode, an n-bit code, and a remaining code (decoding of PredMode and quantized value of P). Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device may concurrently perform the processes.

(765) Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device can reduce time for the entire process.

(766) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device starts a loop for each three-dimensional point (S35523). Specifically, the three-dimensional data decoding device repeats processes in steps S35524 to S35527 for each three-dimensional point at a certain LoD. FIG. 97 shows decoding of target three-dimensional point P to be decoded.

(767) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device searches a plurality of surrounding points that are three-dimensional points in the vicinity of target three-dimensional point P to be processed and used for calculating a predicted value of target three-dimensional point P (S35524).

(768) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device calculates a predicted value of target three-dimensional point P in accordance with PredMode (that is, a prediction mode value) decoded in step S355211 (S35525).

(769) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device inverse quantizes a quantized value in accordance with a quantized value of P decoded in step S355211 to calculate an inverse quantized value (S35526).

(770) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device adds the predicted value to the inverse quantized value to generate a decoded value (S35527).

(771) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device finishes the loop for each three-dimensional point (S35528).

(772) The three-dimensional data decoding device also finishes the loop for each LoD (S35529).

(773) FIG. 98 is a flowchart of details of the calculation process of the predicted value of P (S35525) shown in FIG. 97.

(774) First, the three-dimensional data decoding device calculates a weighted average value of

attribute values of the N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the target three-dimensional point to be decoded, which can be used for prediction, and assigns the calculated weighted average value to prediction mode 0 (S355251).

(775) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device assigns attribute information items of the N three-dimensional points to prediction modes 1 to N sequentially from a three-dimensional point closer to the target three-dimensional point to be decoded (S355252).

(776) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device outputs the predicted value of the prediction mode decoded in step S355211 shown in FIG. 97 (S355253).

(777) The three-dimensional data encoding device may calculate a weighted average value of attribute values of the N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the target three-dimensional point to be encoded after setting the prediction mode to 0, that is, when $\text{maxdiff} < \text{Thfix}$ is true or the decoded prediction mode is 0.

(778) Thus, when the prediction mode is other than 0, the three-dimensional data decoding device needs not calculate a weighted average value. Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device can reduce a processing amount.

(779) FIG. 99 is a flowchart of a calculation process of a prediction mode and a quantized value of P (S355211) shown in FIG. 98.

(780) First, the three-dimensional data decoding device arithmetic-decodes a prediction mode fixing flag (S3561).

(781) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device determines whether or not the arithmetic-decoded prediction mode fixing flag==1 is satisfied (S3562).

(782) Then, when determining that the prediction mode fixing flag==1 is satisfied (Yes in S3562), the three-dimensional data decoding device fixes the prediction mode at 0 (weighted average value) (S3563).

(783) When determining that the prediction mode fixing flag=1 is not satisfied (No in S3562), the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes the prediction mode from the bitstream (S3564).

(784) As described above, the three-dimensional data decoding device may arithmetic-decode prediction mode PredMode in accordance with total number M of prediction modes obtained by decoding the header of the bitstream.

(785) When total number M of prediction modes is 1, the three-dimensional data decoding device may estimate PredMode as 0 without decoding PredMode.

(786) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device determines whether or not a value of an n-bit code==R_TH[LoDN] is satisfied (S3565).

(787) When determining that the value of the n-bit code==R_TH[LoDN] is satisfied (Yes in S3565), the three-dimensional data decoding device arithmetic-decodes a remaining code (S3566).

(788) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device calculates a value of the remaining code with reference to a table for an Exponential-Golomb code (S3567).

(789) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device sets (R_TH[LoDN]+value of remaining code) as a prediction residual (S3568).

(790) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device transforms the decoded prediction residual from an unsigned integer value to a signed integer value (S3569).

(791) When determining that the value of the n-bit code==R_TH[LoDN] is not satisfied (No in S3565), the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes the prediction mode from the bitstream (S3570), and performs step S3569.

(792) As described above, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates a maximum absolute differential value of attribute values of N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of a target three-dimensional point to be encoded, which can be used for prediction by the three-dimensional data encoding device and the three-dimensional data decoding device. The three-dimensional data encoding device also switches between fixing a prediction mode in accordance with the calculated maximum absolute differential value and selecting and appending a prediction

mode to the bitstream.

(793) However, the three-dimensional data encoding device needs not switch between fixing a prediction mode in accordance with the maximum absolute differential value, and selecting and appending a prediction mode to the bitstream. For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device may always select a prediction mode and append the prediction mode to the bitstream.

(794) Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device can always decode the prediction mode appended to the bitstream, thereby correctly decoding the bitstream.

(795) Also, the three-dimensional data decoding device can arithmetic-decode the prediction mode without calculating a maximum absolute differential value of attribute values of N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of a target three-dimensional point to be decoded, which can be used for prediction. Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device can concurrently perform arithmetic-decoding of the bitstream and LoD generation and the like. As a result, the three-dimensional data decoding device can increase throughput of the entire process.

(796) When total number M of prediction modes is 1, the three-dimensional data decoding device can estimate the prediction mode value as 0 without reference to the value. Thus, when total number M of prediction modes is 1, the three-dimensional data encoding device needs not append the prediction mode to the bitstream.

(797) Thus, the three-dimensional data encoding device can reduce an encoding amount when total number M of prediction modes is 1.

(798) FIG. **100** is a flowchart of a process when the three-dimensional data encoding device does not fix a prediction mode according to this embodiment.

(799) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device selects a prediction mode (**S3571**).

(800) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device arithmetic-encodes the selected prediction mode (**S3572**).

(801) FIG. **101** is a flowchart of a process when the three-dimensional data decoding device does not fix a prediction mode according to this embodiment.

(802) The three-dimensional data decoding device decodes the prediction mode from the bitstream (**S3573**).

(803) The three-dimensional data encoding device may always select a prediction mode by any method. For example, $Thfix[i]=0$ in the example of the syntax may be used. Thus, the three-dimensional data encoding device can always append PredMode to the bitstream because a minimum value of maxdiff is 0.

(804) For the three-dimensional data encoding device to always append PredMode to the bitstream, $Thfix[i]$ may be any value as long as $maxdiff \geq Thfix[i]$ is true.

(805) FIG. **102** is a diagram showing another example of a syntax of attribute data according to this embodiment.

(806) PredMode is a value indicating a prediction mode for encoding and decoding an attribute value of a j-th three-dimensional point at level i of LoD. PredMode takes any of 0 to M-1 (M is a total number of prediction modes).

(807) When PredMode is not in the bitstream (specifically, $NumPredMode[i]>1$ is not satisfied), the three-dimensional data decoding device may estimate PredMode as 0.

(808) When PredMode is not in the bitstream, the three-dimensional data decoding device needs not set PredMode to 0, and may use any of 0 to M-1 as an estimated value.

(809) The three-dimensional data encoding device may separately append, to the header and the like, the estimated value when PredMode is not in the bitstream.

(810) As described above, the three-dimensional data encoding device may binarize PredMode by truncated unary coding using total number M of prediction modes, and arithmetic-encode the binarized value.

(811) The three-dimensional data encoding device may encode, as NumPredMode, the value of total number M of prediction modes, and append NumPredMode to the header of the bitstream.

(812) Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device can decode NumPredMode in the header to calculate total number M of prediction modes, and decode PredMode in accordance with total number M of prediction modes. As a result, the three-dimensional data decoding device can generate LoD, calculate three-dimensional points in the vicinity of a target three-dimensional point to be decoded, which can be used for prediction, and perform arithmetic-decoding of the bitstream without waiting for calculation of the number of prediction modes assigned with predicted values.

(813) Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device can concurrently perform arithmetic-decoding of the bitstream and LoD generation and the like. As a result, the three-dimensional data decoding device can increase throughput of the entire process.

(814) An n-bit code is encoded data of a prediction residual of a value of an attribute information item. A bit length of the n-bit code depends on a value of R_TH[i]. For example, the bit length is 6 bits when the value of R_TH[i] is 63, and 8 bits when the value of R_TH[i] is 255.

(815) A remaining code is encoded data encoded by an Exponential-Golomb code among encoded data of the prediction residual of the value of the attribute information item. The three-dimensional data decoding device decodes the remaining code when the n-bit code is equal to R_TH[i], and adds the value of the n-bit code to the value of the remaining code to decode the prediction residual.

(816) When the n-bit code is not equal to R_TH[i], the three-dimensional data decoding device needs not decode the remaining code.

(817) FIG. **103** is a flowchart of an example of a prediction mode encoding process by the three-dimensional data encoding device according to this embodiment.

(818) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device binarizes the prediction mode by the truncated unary coding using total number M of prediction modes (S3574).

(819) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device arithmetic-encodes binary data of the truncated unary coding (S3575).

(820) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device appends total number M of prediction modes as NumPredMode to the header and encodes NumPredMode (S3576).

(821) FIG. **104** is a flowchart of an example of a prediction mode decoding process by the three-dimensional data decoding device according to this embodiment.

(822) First, the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes encoded NumPredMode included in the bitstream to set total number M of prediction modes (S3577).

(823) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device arithmetic-decodes encoded PredMode in accordance with decoded total number M of prediction modes, and generates binary data of the truncated unary coding (S3578).

(824) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device calculates a prediction mode from the binary data of the truncated unary coding (S3579).

(825) FIG. **105** is a flowchart of another example of the predicted-value calculation process (step S35335) shown in FIG. **92**.

(826) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates a weighted average value of attribute values of the N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the target three-dimensional point to be encoded, which can be used for prediction, and assigns the calculated weighted average value to prediction mode 0 (S3581).

(827) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device selects and determines a prediction mode (S3582).

(828) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device arithmetic-encodes the selected and determined prediction mode (S3583).

(829) The three-dimensional data encoding device outputs a predicted value of the determined prediction mode (S3584).

(830) As described above, the three-dimensional data encoding device may binarize prediction mode PredMode in accordance with total number M of prediction modes and arithmetic-encodes

PredMode. The three-dimensional data encoding device may encode total number M of prediction modes as NumPredMode and append NumPredMode to the header.

(831) Thus, the three-dimensional data decoding device can decode NumPredMode in the header, thereby correctly decoding prediction mode PredMode.

(832) When NumPredMode is 1, the three-dimensional data encoding device needs not encode PredMode.

(833) Thus, the three-dimensional data encoding device can reduce an encoding amount when NumPredMode is 1.

(834) FIG. 106 is a flowchart of a prediction mode selection process (S3582) shown in FIG. 105.

(835) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device assigns attribute information items of the N three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the target three-dimensional point to be encoded to prediction modes 1 to N sequentially from a three-dimensional point closer to the target three-dimensional point (S35821). For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device generates $N+1$ prediction modes. When $N+1$ is larger than total number M of prediction modes (NumPredMode) appended to the bitstream, the three-dimensional data encoding device may generate up to M prediction modes.

(836) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates cost of each prediction mode, and selects a prediction mode with minimum cost (S35822).

(837) FIG. 107 is a flowchart of a specific example of a prediction mode selection process (S35822) shown in FIG. 106.

(838) First, the three-dimensional data encoding device sets $i=0$ and $\text{mincost}=\infty$ (S358221).

(839) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates $\text{cost}[i]$ of i -th prediction mode PredMode[i] (S358222).

(840) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device determines whether or not $\text{cost}[i]<\text{mincost}$ is satisfied (S358223).

(841) Then, when determining that $\text{cost}[i]<\text{mincost}$ is satisfied (Yes in S358223), the three-dimensional data encoding device sets $\text{mincost}=\text{cost}[i]$, and sets the prediction mode to PredMode[i] (S358224).

(842) Following step S358224 or when determining that $\text{cost}[i]<\text{mincost}$ is not satisfied (No in S358223), the three-dimensional data encoding device sets $i=i+1$ (S358225).

(843) Then, the three-dimensional data encoding device determines whether or not $i<\text{the number of prediction modes}$ is satisfied (S358226).

(844) When determining that $i<\text{the number of prediction modes}$ is not satisfied (No in S358226), the three-dimensional data encoding device finishes the selection process. When determining that $i<\text{the number of prediction modes}$ is satisfied (Yes in S358226), the three-dimensional data encoding device returns the process to step S358222.

(845) When the number of three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the target three-dimensional point to be encoded is N , the three-dimensional data encoding device generates $N+1$ prediction modes. When $N+1$ is larger than total number M of prediction modes (NumPredMode) appended to the bitstream, the three-dimensional data encoding device may generate up to M prediction modes.

(846) FIG. 108 is a flowchart of another example of the calculation process of a prediction mode and a quantized value of P (S355211) shown in FIG. 97.

(847) First, the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes the prediction mode from the bitstream (S3552111).

(848) As described above, the three-dimensional data decoding device may arithmetic-decode prediction mode PredMode in accordance with total number M of prediction modes obtained by decoding the header.

(849) When total number M of prediction modes is 1, the three-dimensional data decoding device may estimate PredMode as 0 without decoding PredMode.

(850) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device arithmetic-decodes an n -bit code

(S3552112).

(851) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device determines whether or not a value of the n-bit code==R_TH[LoDN] is satisfied (S3552113).

(852) When determining that the value of the n-bit code==R_TH[LoDN] is satisfied (Yes in S3552113), the three-dimensional data decoding device arithmetic-decodes a remaining code (S3552114).

(853) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device calculates a value of the remaining code with reference to a table for an Exponential-Golomb code (S3552115).

(854) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device sets (R_TH[LoDN]+value of remaining code) as a prediction residual (S3552116).

(855) Then, the three-dimensional data decoding device transforms the decoded prediction residual from an unsigned integer value to a signed integer value (S3552117).

(856) When determining that the value of the n-bit code==R_TH[LoDN] is not satisfied (No in S3552113), the three-dimensional data decoding device decodes the prediction mode from the bitstream (S3552118), and performs step S3552117.

Embodiment 6

(857) In the present embodiment, a method of calculating a predicted value of attribute information of a three-dimensional point is described.

(858) In order to encode or decode attribute information of a three-dimensional point cloud, the attribute information is encoded or decoded using a predicted value of the attribute information. Calculating an optimum predicted value (optimum prediction) leads to improving the coding efficiency.

(859) Note that the optimum prediction need not necessarily be minimizing a bitstream or adopting the highest compression ratio. Moreover, being optimum depends on user's definition, and refers to maintaining the quality rather than fixed compression in some cases.

(860) For example, as illustrated in FIG. 109, for encoding attribute information of a current three-dimensional point to be encoded, attribute information of prediction candidate 2 and attribute information of prediction candidate 4 can be used. Prediction candidate 2 has a similar color and a slightly different pattern, and prediction candidate 4 has a different color and the same pattern. Note that FIG. 109 is a diagram illustrating an example of the current three-dimensional point (first three-dimensional point) to be encoded and one or more three-dimensional points (second three-dimensional points) in the vicinity (neighborhood) of the first three-dimensional point.

(861) In the case where an encoding process of attribute information is performed with more emphasis on the color than the pattern, the attribute information of prediction candidate 2 is used as illustrated in FIG. 110. If prediction candidate 2 is used for encoding the attribute information, costs for encoding the color can be reduced while the pattern is encoded. In order to realize a higher compression ratio, there is a technique of calculating costs for encoding each three-dimensional point; encoding the attribute information through prediction using the attribute information of one point or some points; and thus selecting an optimum method for improving the coding efficiency. Note that FIG. 110 is a diagram illustrating an example of the current three-dimensional point (first three-dimensional point) to be encoded and the one or more three-dimensional points (second three-dimensional points) in the vicinity (neighborhood) of the first three-dimensional point.

(862) In the case where the encoding process of the attribute information is performed with more emphasis on the pattern than the color, the attribute information of prediction candidate 4 is used as illustrated in FIG. 111. If prediction candidate 4 is used for encoding the attribute information, costs for encoding the pattern can be reduced while the color is encoded. Moreover, even if the compression performance decreases depending on user's preference and settings, the prediction candidate can be also changed on the basis of a particular standard on which the user puts emphasis.

(863) In order to control algorithm better, an optimum candidate is selected as a prediction factor. To achieve this, some additional parameters are necessary. The introduced parameters include an offset and λ . The offset is a parameter for directly changing a threshold value according to a given method. λ is a parameter for changing the slope of a function depending on other parameters of the algorithm. The cost calculation in a predictor can be easily changed by combining the offset and λ . (864) This makes the following possible. The cost calculation in the case of using a different predictor can be more efficiently performed, and more accurate predictor algorithm can be constructed. Characteristics of a predictor can be changed so as to suit user's utilization scene and a data set. Even if the offset or the lambda value is changed, the basic algorithm remains the same, and hence the same performance and characteristics can be maintained.

(865) For example, if the offset is changed, a graph in FIG. 112 illustrating a relation between a cost and a bit count can be changed to a graph illustrated in FIG. 113. Moreover, if λ is changed, a graph illustrated in FIG. 112 can be changed to a graph illustrated in FIG. 114.

(866) A prediction mode at the time of encoding may be selected by RD optimization. Note that the prediction mode is information indicating a method of calculating (how to calculate) a predicted value. For example, it is conceivable to: calculate cost $\text{cost}(P)$ in the case of selecting given prediction mode P ; and select prediction mode P in which $\text{cost}(P)$ is the smallest. Cost $\text{cost}(P)$ may be calculated according to Equation Y1 using, for example: predicted residual $\text{residual}(P)$ in the case of using a predicted value in prediction mode P ; and bit count $\text{bit}(P)$, an adjustment parameter λ value, or offset value $\text{offset}(P)$ necessary to encode prediction mode P .

$\text{cost}(P) = \text{abs}(\text{residual}(P)) + \lambda \times \text{bit}(P) - \text{offset}(P)$ (Equation Y1) $\text{abs}(x)$ indicates an absolute value of x .

(867) A square value of x may be used instead of $\text{abs}(x)$.

(868) The use of Equation Y1 given above makes it possible to select a prediction mode for which the balance between the size of a prediction residual and the bit count or the offset value necessary to encode the prediction mode is taken into consideration. Note that the value of adjustment parameter λ may be set to a different value in accordance with the value of a quantization scale. For example, in the case where the quantization scale is small (at a high bit rate), a prediction mode in which predicted residual $\text{residual}(P)$ is small may be selected by making the λ value smaller, whereby the prediction precision may be improved as much as possible. In the case where the quantization scale is large (at a low bit rate), an appropriate prediction mode may be selected while bit count $\text{bit}(P)$ necessary to encode prediction mode P is taken into consideration by making the λ value larger.

(869) Note that the case where the quantization scale is small means, for example, the case where the quantization scale is smaller than a first quantization scale. The case where the quantization scale is large means, for example, the case where the quantization scale is larger than a second quantization scale that is larger than or equal to the first quantization scale. Moreover, as the quantization scale becomes smaller, the λ value may be set to a smaller value.

(870) Moreover, offset value $\text{offset}(P)$ may be controlled to a value based on given prediction mode P . For example, the following control may be performed: $\text{offset}=30$ is set for prediction mode 0 in which prediction mode information indicates "0"; $\text{offset}=0$ is set for prediction modes other than prediction mode 0; and the cost value in prediction mode 0 is thus made smaller, whereby the selection rate of prediction mode 0 is raised. In this way, if the selection rate of the given prediction mode is improved by controlling the offset value, fluctuations in the selected prediction mode can be suppressed, and the code amount at the time of entropically encoding the prediction mode information can be reduced.

(871) Moreover, the selection rate of prediction mode 0 is improved by controlling the offset value, and, as illustrated in FIG. 115 or FIG. 116, the code amount of a prediction mode in the case where binarized data whose bit length is short is assigned to prediction mode 0 is thus reduced, whereby the coding efficiency may be improved. Note that the offset value may be set to a value based on

the value of the quantization scale. For example, in the case where the value of the quantization scale is small (at a high bit rate), a prediction mode in which predicted residual residual(P) is small may be selected by setting the offset value to a small value, whereby the prediction precision may be improved as much as possible. Moreover, in the case where the quantization scale is large (at a low bit rate), the selection rate of given prediction mode P may be improved by setting the offset value to a large value, whereby fluctuations in selection of the prediction mode may be suppressed and the bit count for entropically encoding the prediction mode information may be reduced.

(872) Note that the cost of prediction mode P is increased by setting the offset to a negative value, whereby the selection rate of prediction mode P may be decreased and the selection rates other than that of prediction mode P may be improved. In this manner, fluctuations in selection of the prediction mode may be suppressed, and the bit count for entropically encoding the prediction mode information may be reduced.

(873) Note that switching may be made to at least one of the λ value and the offset value in accordance with attribute information to be encoded. For example, in the case where the attribute information is information including three elements and where one prediction mode is used for three residual values (prediction residuals), a prediction mode in which three predicted residuals residual(P) are small may be selected by setting at least one of the λ value and the offset value in prediction mode 0 to a small value, whereby the prediction precision may be improved as much as possible. In this manner, the encoding efficiency may be improved. Note that examples of the attribute information that is information including three elements include: color information having three elements of RGB; and a normal vector having x-, y-, and z-directional vectors.

(874) Moreover, in the case where the attribute information is information including one element and where one prediction mode is used for one residual value, the selection rate of given prediction mode 0 may be improved by setting at least one of the λ value and the offset value in prediction mode 0 to a large value, whereby fluctuations in selection of the prediction mode may be suppressed and the bit count for entropically encoding the prediction mode information may be reduced. In this manner, the coding efficiency may be improved. Note that the attribute information that is information including one element is, for example, a reflectance.

(875) Predicted residual residual(P) is calculated by subtracting the predicted value in prediction mode P from an attribute value of the current three-dimensional point to be encoded. Note that, instead of predicted residual residual(P) at the time of cost calculation, it is acceptable to: quantize and inversely quantize predicted residual residual(P); add the result to the predicted value to obtain a decoded value; and reflect, in the cost value, a difference (encoding error) between an attribute value of the original three-dimensional point and the decoded value in the case of using prediction mode P. This makes it possible to select a prediction mode in which the encoding error is small.

(876) For example, in the case where the prediction mode is binarized and encoded, a bit count after the binarization may be used as bit count bit(P) necessary to encode prediction mode P. For example, in the case where number M of prediction modes=5, a prediction mode value may be binarized, the prediction mode value indicating the prediction mode by means of a truncated unary code with the maximum value being 5 using number M of prediction modes, as illustrated in FIG. 115. In this case, as respective bit counts bit(P) necessary to encode the following prediction mode values, used are: 1 bit in the case where the prediction mode value is "0"; 2 bits in the case where the prediction mode value is "1"; 3 bits in the case where the prediction mode value is "2"; and 4 bits in the case where the prediction mode values are "3" and "4". If the truncated unary code is used, the bit count becomes lower as the value in the prediction mode becomes smaller. Therefore, the code amount of a prediction mode value can be reduced, the prediction mode value indicating a prediction mode for calculating a predicted value that is more likely to be selected, for example, more likely to make cost(P) the smallest. Examples of such a predicted value include: an average value that is calculated as a predicted value in the case where the prediction mode value is "0"; and attribute information of a three-dimensional point that is calculated as a predicted value in the case

where the prediction mode value is “1,” that is, attribute information of a three-dimensional point near the current three-dimensional point to be encoded.

(877) Moreover, in the case where the maximum value of the number of prediction modes is not determined, as illustrated in FIG. 116, the prediction mode value indicating the prediction mode may be binarized by means of a unary code. Moreover, in the case where the respective occurrence probabilities of the prediction modes are close to one another, as illustrated in FIG. 117, the prediction mode value indicating each prediction mode may be binarized by means of a fixed code, and the code amount may thus be reduced.

(878) Note that, as bit count $\text{bit}(P)$ necessary to encode the prediction mode value indicating prediction mode P , it is acceptable to arithmetically encode binarized data of the prediction mode value indicating prediction mode P and use the code amount after this arithmetic encoding, as the value of $\text{bit}(P)$. In this manner, the cost can be calculated using more accurate necessary bit count $\text{bit}(P)$, and hence a more appropriate prediction mode can be selected.

(879) Note that FIG. 115 is a diagram illustrating a first example of a binarization table in the case where the prediction mode value is binarized and encoded. Specifically, the first example is an example in which, in the case where number M of prediction modes=5, the prediction mode value is binarized by means of a truncated unary code.

(880) Moreover, FIG. 116 is a diagram illustrating a second example of the binarization table in the case where the prediction mode value is binarized and encoded. Specifically, the second example is an example in which, in the case where number M of prediction modes=5, the prediction mode value is binarized by means of a unary code.

(881) Moreover, FIG. 117 is a diagram illustrating a third example of the binarization table in the case where the prediction mode value is binarized and encoded. Specifically, the third example is an example in which, in the case where number M of prediction modes=5, the prediction mode value is binarized by means of a fixed code.

(882) Note that, in the present embodiment, description is given of the example in which: at the time of cost calculation, the offset value in given prediction mode P is set to be larger than those in other prediction modes; and the selection rate of prediction mode P is thus improved, but the present disclosure is not necessarily limited to this. It is acceptable to adopt any method as long as the method enables preferentially selecting prediction mode P . For example, in order to improve the selection rate of prediction mode 0 as an example of prediction mode P , the selection rate of prediction mode 0 may be improved by multiplying the cost value in prediction mode 0 by $\frac{1}{2}$. In this way, because the selection rate of prediction mode 0 is improved, fluctuations in the selected prediction mode can be suppressed, and the code amount at the time of entropically encoding the prediction mode information can be reduced.

(883) Note that, in the present embodiment, description is given of the example in which: the selection rate of prediction mode 0 is improved, for example, prediction mode 0 is set to be more easily selected, by controlling at least one value of the λ value and the offset value; fluctuations in the value in the selected prediction mode are thus suppressed; and the code amount is thus reduced, but the present disclosure is not necessarily limited to this. For example, a three-dimensional data encoding device may make switching between: selecting a prediction mode from among a plurality of prediction modes; and using a fixed prediction mode (for example, prediction mode 0), in accordance with the type of attribute information to be encoded.

(884) Specifically, the three-dimensional data encoding device may calculate a predicted value using one prediction mode among two or more prediction modes, when the type of attribute information is attribute information (first attribute information) including elements the total number of which is greater than a predetermined threshold value. The first attribute information may be information including three elements, and examples of the first attribute information include: color information indicating color of a three-dimensional point and having three elements of RGB; and a normal vector having x-, y-, and z-directional vectors of a three-dimensional point. In the case

where one prediction mode is used to calculate a predicted value for calculating the prediction residual of each element in the attribute information including three elements, a prediction mode in which three predicted residuals residual(P) are small may be selected from a plurality of prediction candidates, whereby the encoding efficiency may be improved.

(885) Moreover, the three-dimensional data encoding device may calculate a predicted value using one fixed prediction mode, when the type of attribute information is attribute information (second attribute information) including elements the total number of which is smaller than or equal to the predetermined threshold value. The one fixed prediction mode may be one prediction mode among two or more prediction modes, and may be, for example, prediction mode 0. The second attribute information may be information including one element, and examples of the second attribute information include reflectance information indicating a reflectance of a three-dimensional point. In the case where one prediction mode is used to calculate a predicted value for calculating one prediction residual in the attribute information including one element, the prediction mode may be fixed to 0.

(886) Note that the predetermined threshold value may be 1. That is, in accordance with whether or not the attribute information includes a plurality of elements, the three-dimensional data encoding device may determine whether to calculate the predicted value in one prediction mode among two or more prediction modes or to calculate the predicted value in the one fixed prediction mode.

(887) In this way, in the case where the fixed prediction mode is used as the prediction mode for calculating the predicted value, the three-dimensional data encoding device need not add the prediction mode information indicating the fixed prediction mode, to the bitstream. That is, in the case where the prediction mode for calculating the predicted value is the one fixed prediction mode, the bitstream need not include the prediction mode information (index value) indicating the prediction mode. This is because a three-dimensional data decoding device can determine that the fixed prediction mode is used as the prediction mode in the case where the bitstream does not include the prediction mode information. In this case, the prediction mode information is not added to the bitstream, and hence the code amount can be reduced.

(888) In this way, on the basis of whether or not the prediction mode information is added to the bitstream, the three-dimensional data encoding device can indicate whether or not the one fixed prediction mode is used as the prediction mode. That is, the bitstream indicates whether or not the prediction mode is the one fixed prediction mode.

(889) Note that the three-dimensional data encoding device may add at least one value of the λ value and the offset value at the time of cost calculation, to the bitstream. This enables the three-dimensional data decoding device to know, by decoding the bitstream, at least one value of the λ value and the offset value used by the three-dimensional data encoding device and to know according to what method the prediction mode is selected to generate the bitstream.

(890) Moreover, the three-dimensional data encoding device may calculate, as the predicted value of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point, the average value of the one or more items of attribute information of the one or more second three-dimensional points in the vicinity (neighborhood) of the first three-dimensional point, when the value indicated by the prediction mode information is 0, that is, in the case of prediction mode 0. That is, the predicted value of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point in the case of prediction mode 0 is the average value of the one or more items of attribute information of the one or more second three-dimensional points.

(891) FIG. 118 is a flowchart illustrating a method of determining whether or not to fix the prediction mode by the three-dimensional data encoding device.

(892) The three-dimensional data encoding device determines whether or not the type of attribute information of a current three-dimensional point to be encoded is information including a plurality of elements (S13201). The three-dimensional data encoding device determines whether the type of the attribute information of the current three-dimensional point to be encoded is the first attribute

information including elements the total number of which is greater than the predetermined threshold value or the second attribute information including elements the total number of which is smaller than or equal to the predetermined threshold value.

(893) In the case where the three-dimensional data encoding device determines that the type of the attribute information of the current three-dimensional point to be encoded is the information including the plurality of elements (Yes in **S13201**), the three-dimensional data encoding device selects one prediction mode from the plurality of prediction modes to perform encoding (**S13202**). That is, in the case where the three-dimensional data encoding device determines that the attribute information of the current three-dimensional point to be encoded is the first attribute information, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates a predicted value using one prediction mode among two or more prediction modes, and encodes the attribute information of the current three-dimensional point to be encoded, using this predicted value. In this case, the three-dimensional data encoding device adds the prediction mode information indicating the selected one prediction mode, to the bitstream.

(894) In the case where the three-dimensional data encoding device determines that the type of the attribute information of the current three-dimensional point to be encoded is different from the information including the plurality of elements (No in **S13201**), the three-dimensional data encoding device performs encoding using prediction mode 0 (**S13203**). That is, in the case where the three-dimensional data encoding device determines that the attribute information of the current three-dimensional point to be encoded is the second attribute information, the three-dimensional data encoding device calculates a predicted value using one fixed prediction mode, and encodes the attribute information of the current three-dimensional point to be encoded, using this predicted value. In this case, the three-dimensional data encoding device may add the prediction mode information indicating the one fixed prediction mode (for example, prediction mode 0), to the bitstream. Moreover, the three-dimensional data encoding device need not add the prediction mode information to the bitstream.

(895) FIG. **119** is a flowchart illustrating a decoding method by the three-dimensional data decoding device.

(896) The three-dimensional data decoding device determines whether or not the type of attribute information of a current three-dimensional point to be decoded is information including a plurality of elements (**S13211**). The three-dimensional data decoding device determines whether the type of the attribute information of the current three-dimensional point to be decoded is the first attribute information including elements the total number of which is greater than a predetermined threshold value or the second attribute information including elements the total number of which is smaller than or equal to the predetermined threshold value. Note that, for example, the predetermined threshold value is 1.

(897) In the case where the three-dimensional data decoding device determines that the type of the attribute information of the current three-dimensional point to be decoded is the information including the plurality of elements (Yes in **S13211**), the three-dimensional data decoding device performs decoding using the prediction mode indicated by the prediction mode information included in the bitstream (**S13212**). That is, in the case where the three-dimensional data decoding device determines that the attribute information of the current three-dimensional point to be decoded is the first attribute information, the three-dimensional data decoding device calculates a predicted value using the prediction mode indicated by the prediction mode information included in the bitstream, and decodes the attribute information of the current three-dimensional point to be decoded, using this predicted value.

(898) In the case where the three-dimensional data decoding device determines that the type of the attribute information of the current three-dimensional point to be decoded is different from the information including the plurality of elements (No in **S13211**), the three-dimensional data decoding device performs decoding using prediction mode 0 (**S13213**). That is, in the case where

the three-dimensional data decoding device determines that the attribute information of the current three-dimensional point to be decoded is the second attribute information, the three-dimensional data decoding device calculates a predicted value using prediction mode 0, and decodes the attribute information of the current three-dimensional point to be decoded, using this predicted value.

(899) Note that the determining in Step **S13211** may be performed in accordance with whether or not the bitstream indicates that the used prediction mode is the one fixed prediction mode. In the case where the bitstream indicates that the used prediction mode is different from the one fixed prediction mode, for example, in the case where the bitstream includes the prediction mode information, the three-dimensional data decoding device may calculate the predicted value in the prediction mode indicated by the prediction mode information. Moreover, in the case where the bitstream indicates that the used prediction mode is the one fixed prediction mode, for example, in the case where the bitstream does not include the prediction mode information, the three-dimensional data decoding device may calculate the predicted value in the one fixed prediction mode.

(900) Moreover, the bitstream may indicate whether or not the used prediction mode is the one fixed prediction mode, by means of NumPredMode (number of prediction modes) indicating the number of prediction modes. For example, in the case where NumPredMode is greater than 1, it may be indicated that the used prediction mode is different from the one fixed prediction mode. In the case where NumPredMode is 1, it may be indicated that the used prediction mode is the one fixed prediction mode. That is, in the case where NumPredMode is greater than 1, the three-dimensional data decoding device may execute Step **S13212**. In the case where NumPredMode is 1, the three-dimensional data decoding device may execute Step **S13213**.

(901) As described above, the three-dimensional data encoding device according to the present embodiment performs processing illustrated in FIG. **120**. The three-dimensional data encoding device calculates the predicted value of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point in the prediction mode for calculating the predicted value, using the one or more items of attribute information of the one or more second three-dimensional points in the vicinity of the first three-dimensional point (**S13221**). The three-dimensional data encoding device calculates a prediction residual that is a difference between the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point and the predicted value calculated (**S13222**). The three-dimensional data encoding device generates the bitstream including the prediction residual and the prediction mode information indicating the prediction mode (**S13223**). The prediction mode is one prediction mode among two or more prediction modes when the type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is the first attribute information including elements the total number of which is greater than the predetermined threshold value. The prediction mode is one fixed prediction mode when the type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is the second attribute information including elements the total number of which is smaller than or equal to the predetermined threshold value.

(902) Accordingly, attribute information including a large number of elements can be encoded using one prediction mode selected from two or more prediction modes. Hence, the overhead can be reduced, and the coding efficiency of the attribute information can be improved.

(903) For example, the bitstream indicates whether or not the prediction mode is the one fixed prediction mode.

(904) For example, the predetermined threshold value is 1.

(905) For example, the bitstream does not include the prediction mode information when the one prediction mode is the one fixed prediction mode.

(906) For example, the predicted value is the average value of the one or more items of attribute information of the one or more second three-dimensional points, when the value indicated by the prediction mode information is 0.

(907) For example, the first attribute information is color information indicating color of a three-dimensional point, and the second attribute information is information indicating a reflectance of a three-dimensional point.

(908) For example, the three-dimensional data encoding device includes a processor and a memory, and the processor performs the above-mentioned processing using the memory.

(909) Moreover, the three-dimensional data decoding device according to the present embodiment performs processing illustrated in FIG. 121. The three-dimensional data decoding device obtains the prediction residual and the prediction mode information indicating the prediction mode for the first three-dimensional point among the plurality of three-dimensional points, by obtaining the bitstream (S13231). The three-dimensional data decoding device calculates the predicted value in the prediction mode indicated by the prediction mode information (S13232). The three-dimensional data decoding device calculates the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point by adding the predicted value to the prediction residual (S13233). The prediction mode is one prediction mode among two or more prediction modes when the type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is the first attribute information including elements the total number of which is greater than the predetermined threshold value. The prediction mode is one fixed prediction mode when the type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is the second attribute information including elements the total number of which is smaller than or equal to the predetermined threshold value.

(910) Accordingly, the attribute information that has been encoded using the predicted value in the prediction mode indicated by the bitstream can be appropriately decoded.

(911) For example, the bitstream indicates whether or not the one prediction mode is the one fixed prediction mode. The three-dimensional data decoding device performs the calculating of the predicted value in the prediction mode indicated by the prediction mode information, when the bitstream indicates that the one prediction mode is different from the one fixed prediction mode. The three-dimensional data decoding device performs the calculating of the predicted value in the one fixed prediction mode, when the bitstream indicates that the one prediction mode is the one fixed prediction mode.

(912) For example, the predetermined threshold value is 1.

(913) For example, the three-dimensional data decoding device performs the calculating of the predicted value in the one fixed prediction mode when the bitstream does not include the prediction mode information.

(914) For example, the predicted value is the average value of the one or more items of attribute information of the one or more second three-dimensional points, when the value indicated by the prediction mode information is 0.

(915) For example, the first attribute information is color information indicating color of a three-dimensional point, and the second attribute information is information indicating a reflectance of a three-dimensional point.

(916) For example, the three-dimensional data decoding device includes a processor and a memory, and the processor performs the above-mentioned processing using the memory.

Embodiment 7

(917) The following describes the structure of three-dimensional data creation device 810 according to the present embodiment. FIG. 122 is a block diagram of an exemplary structure of three-dimensional data creation device 810 according to the present embodiment. Such three-dimensional data creation device 810 is equipped, for example, in a vehicle. Three-dimensional data creation device 810 transmits and receives three-dimensional data to and from an external cloud-based traffic monitoring system, a preceding vehicle, or a following vehicle, and creates and stores three-dimensional data.

(918) Three-dimensional data creation device 810 includes data receiver 811, communication unit 812, reception controller 813, format converter 814, a plurality of sensors 815, three-dimensional

data creator **816**, three-dimensional data synthesizer **817**, three-dimensional data storage **818**, communication unit **819**, transmission controller **820**, format converter **821**, and data transmitter **822**.

(919) Data receiver **811** receives three-dimensional data **831** from a cloud-based traffic monitoring system or a preceding vehicle. Three-dimensional data **831** includes, for example, information on a region undetectable by sensors **815** of the own vehicle, such as a point cloud, visible light video, depth information, sensor position information, and speed information.

(920) Communication unit **812** communicates with the cloud-based traffic monitoring system or the preceding vehicle to transmit a data transmission request, etc. to the cloud-based traffic monitoring system or the preceding vehicle.

(921) Reception controller **813** exchanges information, such as information on supported formats, with a communications partner via communication unit **812** to establish communication with the communications partner.

(922) Format converter **814** applies format conversion, etc. on three-dimensional data **831** received by data receiver **811** to generate three-dimensional data **832**. Format converter **814** also decompresses or decodes three-dimensional data **831** when three-dimensional data **831** is compressed or encoded.

(923) A plurality of sensors **815** are a group of sensors, such as visible light cameras and infrared cameras, that obtain information on the outside of the vehicle and generate sensor information **833**. Sensor information **833** is, for example, three-dimensional data such as a point cloud (point group data), when sensors **815** are laser sensors such as LiDARs. Note that a single sensor may serve as a plurality of sensors **815**.

(924) Three-dimensional data creator **816** generates three-dimensional data **834** from sensor information **833**. Three-dimensional data **834** includes, for example, information such as a point cloud, visible light video, depth information, sensor position information, and speed information.

(925) Three-dimensional data synthesizer **817** synthesizes three-dimensional data **834** created on the basis of sensor information **833** of the own vehicle with three-dimensional data **832** created by the cloud-based traffic monitoring system or the preceding vehicle, etc., thereby forming three-dimensional data **835** of a space that includes the space ahead of the preceding vehicle undetectable by sensors **815** of the own vehicle.

(926) Three-dimensional data storage **818** stores generated three-dimensional data **835**, etc.

(927) Communication unit **819** communicates with the cloud-based traffic monitoring system or the following vehicle to transmit a data transmission request, etc. to the cloud-based traffic monitoring system or the following vehicle.

(928) Transmission controller **820** exchanges information such as information on supported formats with a communications partner via communication unit **819** to establish communication with the communications partner. Transmission controller **820** also determines a transmission region, which is a space of the three-dimensional data to be transmitted, on the basis of three-dimensional data formation information on three-dimensional data **832** generated by three-dimensional data synthesizer **817** and the data transmission request from the communications partner.

(929) More specifically, transmission controller **820** determines a transmission region that includes the space ahead of the own vehicle undetectable by a sensor of the following vehicle, in response to the data transmission request from the cloud-based traffic monitoring system or the following vehicle. Transmission controller **820** judges, for example, whether a space is transmittable or whether the already transmitted space includes an update, on the basis of the three-dimensional data formation information to determine a transmission region. For example, transmission controller **820** determines, as a transmission region, a region that is: a region specified by the data transmission request; and a region, corresponding three-dimensional data **835** of which is present. Transmission controller **820** then notifies format converter **821** of the format supported by the communications partner and the transmission region.

(930) Of three-dimensional data **835** stored in three-dimensional data storage **818**, format converter **821** converts three-dimensional data **836** of the transmission region into the format supported by the receiver end to generate three-dimensional data **837**. Note that format converter **821** may compress or encode three-dimensional data **837** to reduce the data amount.

(931) Data transmitter **822** transmits three-dimensional data **837** to the cloud-based traffic monitoring system or the following vehicle. Such three-dimensional data **837** includes, for example, information on a blind spot, which is a region hidden from view of the following vehicle, such as a point cloud ahead of the own vehicle, visible light video, depth information, and sensor position information.

(932) Note that an example has been described in which format converter **814** and format converter **821** perform format conversion, etc., but format conversion may not be performed.

(933) With the above structure, three-dimensional data creation device **810** obtains, from an external device, three-dimensional data **831** of a region undetectable by sensors **815** of the own vehicle, and synthesizes three-dimensional data **831** with three-dimensional data **834** that is based on sensor information **833** detected by sensors **815** of the own vehicle, thereby generating three-dimensional data **835**. Three-dimensional data creation device **810** is thus capable of generating three-dimensional data of a range undetectable by sensors **815** of the own vehicle.

(934) Three-dimensional data creation device **810** is also capable of transmitting, to the cloud-based traffic monitoring system or the following vehicle, etc., three-dimensional data of a space that includes the space ahead of the own vehicle undetectable by a sensor of the following vehicle, in response to the data transmission request from the cloud-based traffic monitoring system or the following vehicle.

(935) The following describes the steps performed by three-dimensional data creation device **810** of transmitting three-dimensional data to a following vehicle. FIG. **123** is a flowchart showing exemplary steps performed by three-dimensional data creation device **810** of transmitting three-dimensional data to a cloud-based traffic monitoring system or a following vehicle.

(936) First, three-dimensional data creation device **810** generates and updates three-dimensional data **835** of a space that includes space on the road ahead of the own vehicle (**S801**). More specifically, three-dimensional data creation device **810** synthesizes three-dimensional data **834** created on the basis of sensor information **833** of the own vehicle with three-dimensional data **831** created by the cloud-based traffic monitoring system or the preceding vehicle, etc., for example, thereby forming three-dimensional data **835** of a space that also includes the space ahead of the preceding vehicle undetectable by sensors **815** of the own vehicle.

(937) Three-dimensional data creation device **810** then judges whether any change has occurred in three-dimensional data **835** of the space included in the space already transmitted (**S802**).

(938) When a change has occurred in three-dimensional data **835** of the space included in the space already transmitted due to, for example, a vehicle or a person entering such space from outside (Yes in **S802**), three-dimensional data creation device **810** transmits, to the cloud-based traffic monitoring system or the following vehicle, the three-dimensional data that includes three-dimensional data **835** of the space in which the change has occurred (**S803**).

(939) Three-dimensional data creation device **810** may transmit three-dimensional data in which a change has occurred, at the same timing of transmitting three-dimensional data that is transmitted at a predetermined time interval, or may transmit three-dimensional data in which a change has occurred soon after the detection of such change. Stated differently, three-dimensional data creation device **810** may prioritize the transmission of three-dimensional data of the space in which a change has occurred to the transmission of three-dimensional data that is transmitted at a predetermined time interval.

(940) Also, three-dimensional data creation device **810** may transmit, as three-dimensional data of a space in which a change has occurred, the whole three-dimensional data of the space in which such change has occurred, or may transmit only a difference in the three-dimensional data (e.g.,

information on three-dimensional points that have appeared or vanished, or information on the displacement of three-dimensional points).

(941) Three-dimensional data creation device **810** may also transmit, to the following vehicle, meta-data on a risk avoidance behavior of the own vehicle such as hard breaking warning, before transmitting three-dimensional data of the space in which a change has occurred. This enables the following vehicle to recognize at an early stage that the preceding vehicle is to perform hard braking, etc., and thus to start performing a risk avoidance behavior at an early stage such as speed reduction.

(942) When no change has occurred in three-dimensional data **835** of the space included in the space already transmitted (No in **S802**), or after step **S803**, three-dimensional data creation device **810** transmits, to the cloud-based traffic monitoring system or the following vehicle, three-dimensional data of the space included in the space having a predetermined shape and located ahead of the own vehicle by distance **L** (**S804**).

(943) The processes of step **S801** through step **S804** are repeated, for example at a predetermined time interval.

(944) When three-dimensional data **835** of the current space to be transmitted includes no difference from the three-dimensional map, three-dimensional data creation device **810** may not transmit three-dimensional data **837** of the space.

(945) In the present embodiment, a client device transmits sensor information obtained through a sensor to a server or another client device.

(946) A structure of a system according to the present embodiment will first be described. FIG. **124** is a diagram showing the structure of a transmission/reception system of a three-dimensional map and sensor information according to the present embodiment. This system includes server **901**, and client devices **902A** and **902B**. Note that client devices **902A** and **902B** are also referred to as client device **902** when no particular distinction is made therebetween.

(947) Client device **902** is, for example, a vehicle-mounted device equipped in a mobile object such as a vehicle. Server **901** is, for example, a cloud-based traffic monitoring system, and is capable of communicating with the plurality of client devices **902**.

(948) Server **901** transmits the three-dimensional map formed by a point cloud to client device **902**. Note that a structure of the three-dimensional map is not limited to a point cloud, and may also be another structure expressing three-dimensional data such as a mesh structure.

(949) Client device **902** transmits the sensor information obtained by client device **902** to server **901**. The sensor information includes, for example, at least one of information obtained by LiDAR, a visible light image, an infrared image, a depth image, sensor position information, or sensor speed information.

(950) The data to be transmitted and received between server **901** and client device **902** may be compressed in order to reduce data volume, and may also be transmitted uncompressed in order to maintain data precision. When compressing the data, it is possible to use a three-dimensional compression method on the point cloud based on, for example, an octree structure. It is possible to use a two-dimensional image compression method on the visible light image, the infrared image, and the depth image. The two-dimensional image compression method is, for example, MPEG-4 AVC or HEVC standardized by MPEG.

(951) Server **901** transmits the three-dimensional map managed by server **901** to client device **902** in response to a transmission request for the three-dimensional map from client device **902**. Note that server **901** may also transmit the three-dimensional map without waiting for the transmission request for the three-dimensional map from client device **902**. For example, server **901** may broadcast the three-dimensional map to at least one client device **902** located in a predetermined space. Server **901** may also transmit the three-dimensional map suited to a position of client device **902** at fixed time intervals to client device **902** that has received the transmission request once. Server **901** may also transmit the three-dimensional map managed by server **901** to client device

902 every time the three-dimensional map is updated.

(952) Client device **902** sends the transmission request for the three-dimensional map to server **901**. For example, when client device **902** wants to perform the self-location estimation during traveling, client device **902** transmits the transmission request for the three-dimensional map to server **901**.

(953) Note that in the following cases, client device **902** may send the transmission request for the three-dimensional map to server **901**. Client device **902** may send the transmission request for the three-dimensional map to server **901** when the three-dimensional map stored by client device **902** is old. For example, client device **902** may send the transmission request for the three-dimensional map to server **901** when a fixed period has passed since the three-dimensional map is obtained by client device **902**.

(954) Client device **902** may also send the transmission request for the three-dimensional map to server **901** before a fixed time when client device **902** exits a space shown in the three-dimensional map stored by client device **902**. For example, client device **902** may send the transmission request for the three-dimensional map to server **901** when client device **902** is located within a predetermined distance from a boundary of the space shown in the three-dimensional map stored by client device **902**. When a movement path and a movement speed of client device **902** are understood, a time when client device **902** exits the space shown in the three-dimensional map stored by client device **902** may be predicted based on the movement path and the movement speed of client device **902**.

(955) Client device **902** may also send the transmission request for the three-dimensional map to server **901** when an error during alignment of the three-dimensional data and the three-dimensional map created from the sensor information by client device **902** is at least at a fixed level.

(956) Client device **902** transmits the sensor information to server **901** in response to a transmission request for the sensor information from server **901**. Note that client device **902** may transmit the sensor information to server **901** without waiting for the transmission request for the sensor information from server **901**. For example, client device **902** may periodically transmit the sensor information during a fixed period when client device **902** has received the transmission request for the sensor information from server **901** once. Client device **902** may determine that there is a possibility of a change in the three-dimensional map of a surrounding area of client device **902** having occurred, and transmit this information and the sensor information to server **901**, when the error during alignment of the three-dimensional data created by client device **902** based on the sensor information and the three-dimensional map obtained from server **901** is at least at the fixed level.

(957) Server **901** sends a transmission request for the sensor information to client device **902**. For example, server **901** receives position information, such as GPS information, about client device **902** from client device **902**. Server **901** sends the transmission request for the sensor information to client device **902** in order to generate a new three-dimensional map, when it is determined that client device **902** is approaching a space in which the three-dimensional map managed by server **901** contains little information, based on the position information about client device **902**. Server **901** may also send the transmission request for the sensor information, when wanting to (i) update the three-dimensional map, (ii) check road conditions during snowfall, a disaster, or the like, or (iii) check traffic congestion conditions, accident/incident conditions, or the like.

(958) Client device **902** may set an amount of data of the sensor information to be transmitted to server **901** in accordance with communication conditions or bandwidth during reception of the transmission request for the sensor information to be received from server **901**. Setting the amount of data of the sensor information to be transmitted to server **901** is, for example, increasing/reducing the data itself or appropriately selecting a compression method.

(959) FIG. 125 is a block diagram showing an example structure of client device **902**. Client device **902** receives the three-dimensional map formed by a point cloud and the like from server **901**, and estimates a self-location of client device **902** using the three-dimensional map created based on the

sensor information of client device **902**. Client device **902** transmits the obtained sensor information to server **901**.

(960) Client device **902** includes data receiver **1011**, communication unit **1012**, reception controller **1013**, format converter **1014**, sensors **1015**, three-dimensional data creator **1016**, three-dimensional image processor **1017**, three-dimensional data storage **1018**, format converter **1019**, communication unit **1020**, transmission controller **1021**, and data transmitter **1022**.

(961) Data receiver **1011** receives three-dimensional map **1031** from server **901**. Three-dimensional map **1031** is data that includes a point cloud such as a WLD or a SWLD. Three-dimensional map **1031** may include compressed data or uncompressed data.

(962) Communication unit **1012** communicates with server **901** and transmits a data transmission request (e.g., transmission request for three-dimensional map) to server **901**.

(963) Reception controller **1013** exchanges information, such as information on supported formats, with a communications partner via communication unit **1012** to establish communication with the communications partner.

(964) Format converter **1014** performs a format conversion and the like on three-dimensional map **1031** received by data receiver **1011** to generate three-dimensional map **1032**. Format converter **1014** also performs a decompression or decoding process when three-dimensional map **1031** is compressed or encoded. Note that format converter **1014** does not perform the decompression or decoding process when three-dimensional map **1031** is uncompressed data.

(965) Sensors **1015** are a group of sensors, such as LiDARs, visible light cameras, infrared cameras, or depth sensors that obtain information about the outside of a vehicle equipped with client device **902**, and generate sensor information **1033**. Sensor information **1033** is, for example, three-dimensional data such as a point cloud (point group data) when sensors **1015** are laser sensors such as LiDARs. Note that a single sensor may serve as sensors **1015**.

(966) Three-dimensional data creator **1016** generates three-dimensional data **1034** of a surrounding area of the own vehicle based on sensor information **1033**. For example, three-dimensional data creator **1016** generates point cloud data with color information on the surrounding area of the own vehicle using information obtained by LiDAR and visible light video obtained by a visible light camera.

(967) Three-dimensional image processor **1017** performs a self-location estimation process and the like of the own vehicle, using (i) the received three-dimensional map **1032** such as a point cloud, and (ii) three-dimensional data **1034** of the surrounding area of the own vehicle generated using sensor information **1033**. Note that three-dimensional image processor **1017** may generate three-dimensional data **1035** about the surroundings of the own vehicle by merging three-dimensional map **1032** and three-dimensional data **1034**, and may perform the self-location estimation process using the created three-dimensional data **1035**.

(968) Three-dimensional data storage **1018** stores three-dimensional map **1032**, three-dimensional data **1034**, three-dimensional data **1035**, and the like.

(969) Format converter **1019** generates sensor information **1037** by converting sensor information **1033** to a format supported by a receiver end. Note that format converter **1019** may reduce the amount of data by compressing or encoding sensor information **1037**. Format converter **1019** may omit this process when format conversion is not necessary. Format converter **1019** may also control the amount of data to be transmitted in accordance with a specified transmission range.

(970) Communication unit **1020** communicates with server **901** and receives a data transmission request (transmission request for sensor information) and the like from server **901**.

(971) Transmission controller **1021** exchanges information, such as information on supported formats, with a communications partner via communication unit **1020** to establish communication with the communications partner.

(972) Data transmitter **1022** transmits sensor information **1037** to server **901**. Sensor information **1037** includes, for example, information obtained through sensors **1015**, such as information

obtained by LiDAR, a luminance image obtained by a visible light camera, an infrared image obtained by an infrared camera, a depth image obtained by a depth sensor, sensor position information, and sensor speed information.

(973) A structure of server **901** will be described next. FIG. **126** is a block diagram showing an example structure of server **901**. Server **901** transmits sensor information from client device **902** and creates three-dimensional data based on the received sensor information. Server **901** updates the three-dimensional map managed by server **901** using the created three-dimensional data. Server **901** transmits the updated three-dimensional map to client device **902** in response to a transmission request for the three-dimensional map from client device **902**.

(974) Server **901** includes data receiver **1111**, communication unit **1112**, reception controller **1113**, format converter **1114**, three-dimensional data creator **1116**, three-dimensional data merger **1117**, three-dimensional data storage **1118**, format converter **1119**, communication unit **1120**, transmission controller **1121**, and data transmitter **1122**.

(975) Data receiver **1111** receives sensor information **1037** from client device **902**. Sensor information **1037** includes, for example, information obtained by LiDAR, a luminance image obtained by a visible light camera, an infrared image obtained by an infrared camera, a depth image obtained by a depth sensor, sensor position information, sensor speed information, and the like.

(976) Communication unit **1112** communicates with client device **902** and transmits a data transmission request (e.g., transmission request for sensor information) and the like to client device **902**.

(977) Reception controller **1113** exchanges information, such as information on supported formats, with a communications partner via communication unit **1112** to establish communication with the communications partner.

(978) Format converter **1114** generates sensor information **1132** by performing a decompression or decoding process when received sensor information **1037** is compressed or encoded. Note that format converter **1114** does not perform the decompression or decoding process when sensor information **1037** is uncompressed data.

(979) Three-dimensional data creator **1116** generates three-dimensional data **1134** of a surrounding area of client device **902** based on sensor information **1132**. For example, three-dimensional data creator **1116** generates point cloud data with color information on the surrounding area of client device **902** using information obtained by LiDAR and visible light video obtained by a visible light camera.

(980) Three-dimensional data merger **1117** updates three-dimensional map **1135** by merging three-dimensional data **1134** created based on sensor information **1132** with three-dimensional map **1135** managed by server **901**.

(981) Three-dimensional data storage **1118** stores three-dimensional map **1135** and the like.

(982) Format converter **1119** generates three-dimensional map **1031** by converting three-dimensional map **1135** to a format supported by the receiver end. Note that format converter **1119** may reduce the amount of data by compressing or encoding three-dimensional map **1135**. Format converter **1119** may omit this process when format conversion is not necessary. Format converter **1119** may also control the amount of data to be transmitted in accordance with a specified transmission range.

(983) Communication unit **1120** communicates with client device **902** and receives a data transmission request (transmission request for three-dimensional map) and the like from client device **902**.

(984) Transmission controller **1121** exchanges information, such as information on supported formats, with a communications partner via communication unit **1120** to establish communication with the communications partner.

(985) Data transmitter **1122** transmits three-dimensional map **1031** to client device **902**. Three-dimensional map **1031** is data that includes a point cloud such as a WLD or a SWLD. Three-

dimensional map **1031** may include one of compressed data and uncompressed data.

(986) An operational flow of client device **902** will be described next. FIG. **127** is a flowchart of an operation when client device **902** obtains the three-dimensional map.

(987) Client device **902** first requests server **901** to transmit the three-dimensional map (point cloud, etc.) (**S1001**). At this point, by also transmitting the position information about client device **902** obtained through GPS and the like, client device **902** may also request server **901** to transmit a three-dimensional map relating to this position information.

(988) Client device **902** next receives the three-dimensional map from server **901** (**S1002**). When the received three-dimensional map is compressed data, client device **902** decodes the received three-dimensional map and generates an uncompressed three-dimensional map (**S1003**).

(989) Client device **902** next creates three-dimensional data **1034** of the surrounding area of client device **902** using sensor information **1033** obtained by sensors **1015** (**S1004**). Client device **902** next estimates the self-location of client device **902** using three-dimensional map **1032** received from server **901** and three-dimensional data **1034** created using sensor information **1033** (**S1005**).

(990) FIG. **128** is a flowchart of an operation when client device **902** transmits the sensor information. Client device **902** first receives a transmission request for the sensor information from server **901** (**S1011**). Client device **902** that has received the transmission request transmits sensor information **1037** to server **901** (**S1012**). Note that client device **902** may generate sensor information **1037** by compressing each piece of information using a compression method suited to each piece of information, when sensor information **1033** includes a plurality of pieces of information obtained by sensors **1015**.

(991) An operational flow of server **901** will be described next. FIG. **129** is a flowchart of an operation when server **901** obtains the sensor information. Server **901** first requests client device **902** to transmit the sensor information (**S1021**). Server **901** next receives sensor information **1037** transmitted from client device **902** in accordance with the request (**S1022**). Server **901** next creates three-dimensional data **1134** using the received sensor information **1037** (**S1023**). Server **901** next reflects the created three-dimensional data **1134** in three-dimensional map **1135** (**S1024**).

(992) FIG. **130** is a flowchart of an operation when server **901** transmits the three-dimensional map. Server **901** first receives a transmission request for the three-dimensional map from client device **902** (**S1031**). Server **901** that has received the transmission request for the three-dimensional map transmits the three-dimensional map to client device **902** (**S1032**). At this point, server **901** may extract a three-dimensional map of a vicinity of client device **902** along with the position information about client device **902**, and transmit the extracted three-dimensional map. Server **901** may compress the three-dimensional map formed by a point cloud using, for example, an octree structure compression method, and transmit the compressed three-dimensional map.

(993) The following describes variations of the present embodiment.

(994) Server **901** creates three-dimensional data **1134** of a vicinity of a position of client device **902** using sensor information **1037** received from client device **902**. Server **901** next calculates a difference between three-dimensional data **1134** and three-dimensional map **1135**, by matching the created three-dimensional data **1134** with three-dimensional map **1135** of the same area managed by server **901**. Server **901** determines that a type of anomaly has occurred in the surrounding area of client device **902**, when the difference is greater than or equal to a predetermined threshold. For example, it is conceivable that a large difference occurs between three-dimensional map **1135** managed by server **901** and three-dimensional data **1134** created based on sensor information **1037**, when land subsidence and the like occurs due to a natural disaster such as an earthquake.

(995) Sensor information **1037** may include information indicating at least one of a sensor type, a sensor performance, and a sensor model number. Sensor information **1037** may also be appended with a class ID and the like in accordance with the sensor performance. For example, when sensor information **1037** is obtained by LiDAR, it is conceivable to assign identifiers to the sensor performance. A sensor capable of obtaining information with precision in units of several

millimeters is class 1, a sensor capable of obtaining information with precision in units of several centimeters is class 2, and a sensor capable of obtaining information with precision in units of several meters is class 3. Server **901** may estimate sensor performance information and the like from a model number of client device **902**. For example, when client device **902** is equipped in a vehicle, server **901** may determine sensor specification information from a type of the vehicle. In this case, server **901** may obtain information on the type of the vehicle in advance, and the information may also be included in the sensor information. Server **901** may change a degree of correction with respect to three-dimensional data **1134** created using sensor information **1037**, using obtained sensor information **1037**. For example, when the sensor performance is high in precision (class 1), server **901** does not correct three-dimensional data **1134**. When the sensor performance is low in precision (class 3), server **901** corrects three-dimensional data **1134** in accordance with the precision of the sensor. For example, server **901** increases the degree (intensity) of correction with a decrease in the precision of the sensor.

(996) Server **901** may simultaneously send the transmission request for the sensor information to the plurality of client devices **902** in a certain space. Server **901** does not need to use all of the sensor information for creating three-dimensional data **1134** and may, for example, select sensor information to be used in accordance with the sensor performance, when having received a plurality of pieces of sensor information from the plurality of client devices **902**. For example, when updating three-dimensional map **1135**, server **901** may select high-precision sensor information (class 1) from among the received plurality of pieces of sensor information, and create three-dimensional data **1134** using the selected sensor information.

(997) Server **901** is not limited to only being a server such as a cloud-based traffic monitoring system, and may also be another (vehicle-mounted) client device. FIG. **131** is a diagram of a system structure in this case.

(998) For example, client device **902C** sends a transmission request for sensor information to client device **902A** located nearby, and obtains the sensor information from client device **902A**. Client device **902C** then creates three-dimensional data using the obtained sensor information of client device **902A**, and updates a three-dimensional map of client device **902C**. This enables client device **902C** to generate a three-dimensional map of a space that can be obtained from client device **902A**, and fully utilize the performance of client device **902C**. For example, such a case is conceivable when client device **902C** has high performance.

(999) In this case, client device **902A** that has provided the sensor information is given rights to obtain the high-precision three-dimensional map generated by client device **902C**. Client device **902A** receives the high-precision three-dimensional map from client device **902C** in accordance with these rights.

(1000) Server **901** may send the transmission request for the sensor information to the plurality of client devices **902** (client device **902A** and client device **902B**) located nearby client device **902C**. When a sensor of client device **902A** or client device **902B** has high performance, client device **902C** is capable of creating the three-dimensional data using the sensor information obtained by this high-performance sensor.

(1001) FIG. **132** is a block diagram showing a functionality structure of server **901** and client device **902**. Server **901** includes, for example, three-dimensional map compression/decoding processor **1201** that compresses and decodes the three-dimensional map and sensor information compression/decoding processor **1202** that compresses and decodes the sensor information.

(1002) Client device **902** includes three-dimensional map decoding processor **1211** and sensor information compression processor **1212**. Three-dimensional map decoding processor **1211** receives encoded data of the compressed three-dimensional map, decodes the encoded data, and obtains the three-dimensional map. Sensor information compression processor **1212** compresses the sensor information itself instead of the three-dimensional data created using the obtained sensor information, and transmits the encoded data of the compressed sensor information to server **901**.

With this structure, client device **902** does not need to internally store a processor that performs a process for compressing the three-dimensional data of the three-dimensional map (point cloud, etc.), as long as client device **902** internally stores a processor that performs a process for decoding the three-dimensional map (point cloud, etc.). This makes it possible to limit costs, power consumption, and the like of client device **902**.

(1003) As stated above, client device **902** according to the present embodiment is equipped in the mobile object, and creates three-dimensional data **1034** of a surrounding area of the mobile object using sensor information **1033** that is obtained through sensor **1015** equipped in the mobile object and indicates a surrounding condition of the mobile object. Client device **902** estimates a self-location of the mobile object using the created three-dimensional data **1034**. Client device **902** transmits obtained sensor information **1033** to server **901** or another client device **902**.

(1004) This enables client device **902** to transmit sensor information **1033** to server **901** or the like. This makes it possible to further reduce the amount of transmission data compared to when transmitting the three-dimensional data. Since there is no need for client device **902** to perform processes such as compressing or encoding the three-dimensional data, it is possible to reduce the processing amount of client device **902**. As such, client device **902** is capable of reducing the amount of data to be transmitted or simplifying the structure of the device.

(1005) Client device **902** further transmits the transmission request for the three-dimensional map to server **901** and receives three-dimensional map **1031** from server **901**. In the estimating of the self-location, client device **902** estimates the self-location using three-dimensional data **1034** and three-dimensional map **1032**.

(1006) Sensor information **1033** includes at least one of information obtained by a laser sensor, a luminance image, an infrared image, a depth image, sensor position information, or sensor speed information.

(1007) Sensor information **1033** includes information that indicates a performance of the sensor.

(1008) Client device **902** encodes or compresses sensor information **1033**, and in the transmitting of the sensor information, transmits sensor information **1037** that has been encoded or compressed to server **901** or another client device **902**. This enables client device **902** to reduce the amount of data to be transmitted.

(1009) For example, client device **902** includes a processor and memory. The processor performs the above processes using the memory.

(1010) Server **901** according to the present embodiment is capable of communicating with client device **902** equipped in the mobile object, and receives sensor information **1037** that is obtained through sensor **1015** equipped in the mobile object and indicates a surrounding condition of the mobile object. Server **901** creates three-dimensional data **1134** of a surrounding area of the mobile object using received sensor information **1037**.

(1011) With this, server **901** creates three-dimensional data **1134** using sensor information **1037** transmitted from client device **902**. This makes it possible to further reduce the amount of transmission data compared to when client device **902** transmits the three-dimensional data. Since there is no need for client device **902** to perform processes such as compressing or encoding the three-dimensional data, it is possible to reduce the processing amount of client device **902**. As such, server **901** is capable of reducing the amount of data to be transmitted or simplifying the structure of the device.

(1012) Server **901** further transmits a transmission request for the sensor information to client device **902**.

(1013) Server **901** further updates three-dimensional map **1135** using the created three-dimensional data **1134**, and transmits three-dimensional map **1135** to client device **902** in response to the transmission request for three-dimensional map **1135** from client device **902**.

(1014) Sensor information **1037** includes at least one of information obtained by a laser sensor, a luminance image, an infrared image, a depth image, sensor position information, or sensor speed

information.

(1015) Sensor information **1037** includes information that indicates a performance of the sensor.

(1016) Server **901** further corrects the three-dimensional data in accordance with the performance of the sensor. This enables the three-dimensional data creation method to improve the quality of the three-dimensional data.

(1017) In the receiving of the sensor information, server **901** receives a plurality of pieces of sensor information **1037** received from a plurality of client devices **902**, and selects sensor information **1037** to be used in the creating of three-dimensional data **1134**, based on a plurality of pieces of information that each indicates the performance of the sensor included in the plurality of pieces of sensor information **1037**. This enables server **901** to improve the quality of three-dimensional data **1134**.

(1018) Server **901** decodes or decompresses received sensor information **1037**, and creates three-dimensional data **1134** using sensor information **1132** that has been decoded or decompressed. This enables server **901** to reduce the amount of data to be transmitted.

(1019) For example, server **901** includes a processor and memory. The processor performs the above processes using the memory.

(1020) The following will describe a variation of the present embodiment. FIG. **133** is a diagram illustrating a configuration of a system according to the present embodiment. The system illustrated in FIG. **133** includes server **2001**, client device **2002A**, and client device **2002B**.

(1021) Client device **2002A** and client device **2002B** are each provided in a mobile object such as a vehicle, and transmit sensor information to server **2001**. Server **2001** transmits a three-dimensional map (a point cloud) to client device **2002A** and client device **2002B**.

(1022) Client device **2002A** includes sensor information obtainer **2011**, storage **2012**, and data transmission possibility determiner **2013**. It should be noted that client device **2002B** has the same configuration. Additionally, when client device **2002A** and client device **2002B** are not particularly distinguished below, client device **2002A** and client device **2002B** are also referred to as client device **2002**.

(1023) FIG. **134** is a flowchart illustrating operation of client device **2002** according to the present embodiment.

(1024) Sensor information obtainer **2011** obtains a variety of sensor information using sensors (a group of sensors) provided in a mobile object. In other words, sensor information obtainer **2011** obtains sensor information obtained by the sensors (the group of sensors) provided in the mobile object and indicating a surrounding state of the mobile object. Sensor information obtainer **2011** also stores the obtained sensor information into storage **2012**. This sensor information includes at least one of information obtained by LiDAR, a visible light image, an infrared image, or a depth image. Additionally, the sensor information may include at least one of sensor position information, speed information, obtainment time information, or obtainment location information. Sensor position information indicates a position of a sensor that has obtained sensor information. Speed information indicates a speed of the mobile object when a sensor obtained sensor information. Obtainment time information indicates a time when a sensor obtained sensor information. Obtainment location information indicates a position of the mobile object or a sensor when the sensor obtained sensor information.

(1025) Next, data transmission possibility determiner **2013** determines whether the mobile object (client device **2002**) is in an environment in which the mobile object can transmit sensor information to server **2001** (S2002). For example, data transmission possibility determiner **2013** may specify a location and a time at which client device **2002** is present using GPS information etc., and may determine whether data can be transmitted. Additionally, data transmission possibility determiner **2013** may determine whether data can be transmitted, depending on whether it is possible to connect to a specific access point.

(1026) When client device **2002** determines that the mobile object is in the environment in which

the mobile object can transmit the sensor information to server **2001** (YES in S2002), client device **2002** transmits the sensor information to server **2001** (S2003). In other words, when client device **2002** becomes capable of transmitting sensor information to server **2001**, client device **2002** transmits the sensor information held by client device **2002** to server **2001**. For example, an access point that enables high-speed communication using millimeter waves is provided in an intersection or the like. When client device **2002** enters the intersection, client device **2002** transmits the sensor information held by client device **2002** to server **2001** at high speed using the millimeter-wave communication.

(1027) Next, client device **2002** deletes from storage **2012** the sensor information that has been transmitted to server **2001** (S2004). It should be noted that when sensor information that has not been transmitted to server **2001** meets predetermined conditions, client device **2002** may delete the sensor information. For example, when an obtainment time of sensor information held by client device **2002** precedes a current time by a certain time, client device **2002** may delete the sensor information from storage **2012**. In other words, when a difference between the current time and a time when a sensor obtained sensor information exceeds a predetermined time, client device **2002** may delete the sensor information from storage **2012**. Besides, when an obtainment location of sensor information held by client device **2002** is separated from a current location by a certain distance, client device **2002** may delete the sensor information from storage **2012**. In other words, when a difference between a current position of the mobile object or a sensor and a position of the mobile object or the sensor when the sensor obtained sensor information exceeds a predetermined distance, client device **2002** may delete the sensor information from storage **2012**. Accordingly, it is possible to reduce the capacity of storage **2012** of client device **2002**.

(1028) When client device **2002** does not finish obtaining sensor information (NO in S2005), client device **2002** performs step S2001 and the subsequent steps again. Further, when client device **2002** finishes obtaining sensor information (YES in S2005), client device **2002** completes the process.

(1029) Client device **2002** may select sensor information to be transmitted to server **2001**, in accordance with communication conditions. For example, when high-speed communication is available, client device **2002** preferentially transmits sensor information (e.g., information obtained by LiDAR) of which the data size held in storage **2012** is large. Additionally, when high-speed communication is not readily available, client device **2002** transmits sensor information (e.g., a visible light image) which has high priority and of which the data size held in storage **2012** is small. Accordingly, client device **2002** can efficiently transmit sensor information held in storage **2012**, in accordance with network conditions

(1030) Client device **2002** may obtain, from server **2001**, time information indicating a current time and location information indicating a current location. Moreover, client device **2002** may determine an obtainment time and an obtainment location of sensor information based on the obtained time information and location information. In other words, client device **2002** may obtain time information from server **2001** and generate obtainment time information using the obtained time information. Client device **2002** may also obtain location information from server **2001** and generate obtainment location information using the obtained location information.

(1031) For example, regarding time information, server **2001** and client device **2002** perform clock synchronization using a means such as the Network Time Protocol (NTP) or the Precision Time Protocol (PTP). This enables client device **2002** to obtain accurate time information. What's more, since it is possible to synchronize clocks between server **2001** and client devices **2002**, it is possible to synchronize times included in pieces of sensor information obtained by separate client devices **2002**. As a result, server **2001** can handle sensor information indicating a synchronized time. It should be noted that a means of synchronizing clocks may be any means other than the NTP or PTP. In addition, GPS information may be used as the time information and the location information.

(1032) Server **2001** may specify a time or a location and obtain pieces of sensor information from

client devices **2002**. For example, when an accident occurs, in order to search for a client device in the vicinity of the accident, server **2001** specifies an accident occurrence time and an accident occurrence location and broadcasts sensor information transmission requests to client devices **2002**. Then, client device **2002** having sensor information obtained at the corresponding time and location transmits the sensor information to server **2001**. In other words, client device **2002** receives, from server **2001**, a sensor information transmission request including specification information specifying a location and a time. When sensor information obtained at a location and a time indicated by the specification information is stored in storage **2012**, and client device **2002** determines that the mobile object is present in the environment in which the mobile object can transmit the sensor information to server **2001**, client device **2002** transmits, to server **2001**, the sensor information obtained at the location and the time indicated by the specification information. Consequently, server **2001** can obtain the pieces of sensor information pertaining to the occurrence of the accident from client devices **2002**, and use the pieces of sensor information for accident analysis etc.

(1033) It should be noted that when client device **2002** receives a sensor information transmission request from server **2001**, client device **2002** may refuse to transmit sensor information. Additionally, client device **2002** may set in advance which pieces of sensor information can be transmitted. Alternatively, server **2001** may inquire of client device **2002** each time whether sensor information can be transmitted.

(1034) A point may be given to client device **2002** that has transmitted sensor information to server **2001**. This point can be used in payment for, for example, gasoline expenses, electric vehicle (EV) charging expenses, a highway toll, or rental car expenses. After obtaining sensor information, server **2001** may delete information for specifying client device **2002** that has transmitted the sensor information. For example, this information is a network address of client device **2002**. Since this enables the anonymization of sensor information, a user of client device **2002** can securely transmit sensor information from client device **2002** to server **2001**. Server **2001** may include servers. For example, by servers sharing sensor information, even when one of the servers breaks down, the other servers can communicate with client device **2002**. Accordingly, it is possible to avoid service outage due to a server breakdown.

(1035) A specified location specified by a sensor information transmission request indicates an accident occurrence location etc., and may be different from a position of client device **2002** at a specified time specified by the sensor information transmission request. For this reason, for example, by specifying, as a specified location, a range such as within XX meters of a surrounding area, server **2001** can request information from client device **2002** within the range. Similarly, server **2001** may also specify, as a specified time, a range such as within N seconds before and after a certain time. As a result, server **2001** can obtain sensor information from client device **2002** present for a time from $t-N$ to $t+N$ and in a location within XX meters from absolute position S. When client device **2002** transmits three-dimensional data such as LiDAR, client device **2002** may transmit data created immediately after time t .

(1036) Server **2001** may separately specify information indicating, as a specified location, a location of client device **2002** from which sensor information is to be obtained, and a location at which sensor information is desirably obtained. For example, server **2001** specifies that sensor information including at least a range within YY meters from absolute position S is to be obtained from client device **2002** present within XX meters from absolute position S. When client device **2002** selects three-dimensional data to be transmitted, client device **2002** selects one or more pieces of three-dimensional data so that the one or more pieces of three-dimensional data include at least the sensor information including the specified range. Each of the one or more pieces of three-dimensional data is a random-accessible unit of data. In addition, when client device **2002** transmits a visible light image, client device **2002** may transmit pieces of temporally continuous image data including at least a frame immediately before or immediately after time t .

(1037) When client device **2002** can use physical networks such as 5G, Wi-Fi, or modes in 5G for transmitting sensor information, client device **2002** may select a network to be used according to the order of priority notified by server **2001**. Alternatively, client device **2002** may select a network that enables client device **2002** to ensure an appropriate bandwidth based on the size of transmit data. Alternatively, client device **2002** may select a network to be used, based on data transmission expenses etc. A transmission request from server **2001** may include information indicating a transmission deadline, for example, performing transmission when client device **2002** can start transmission by time t . When server **2001** cannot obtain sufficient sensor information within a time limit, server **2001** may issue a transmission request again.

(1038) Sensor information may include header information indicating characteristics of sensor data along with compressed or uncompressed sensor data. Client device **2002** may transmit header information to server **2001** via a physical network or a communication protocol that is different from a physical network or a communication protocol used for sensor data. For example, client device **2002** transmits header information to server **2001** prior to transmitting sensor data. Server **2001** determines whether to obtain the sensor data of client device **2002**, based on a result of analysis of the header information. For example, header information may include information indicating a point cloud obtainment density, an elevation angle, or a frame rate of LiDAR, or information indicating, for example, a resolution, an SN ratio, or a frame rate of a visible light image. Accordingly, server **2001** can obtain the sensor information from client device **2002** having the sensor data of determined quality.

(1039) As stated above, client device **2002** is provided in the mobile object, obtains sensor information that has been obtained by a sensor provided in the mobile object and indicates a surrounding state of the mobile object, and stores the sensor information into storage **2012**. Client device **2002** determines whether the mobile object is present in an environment in which the mobile object is capable of transmitting the sensor information to server **2001**, and transmits the sensor information to server **2001** when the mobile object is determined to be present in the environment in which the mobile object is capable of transmitting the sensor information to server **2001**.

(1040) Additionally, client device **2002** further creates, from the sensor information, three-dimensional data of a surrounding area of the mobile object, and estimates a self-location of the mobile object using the three-dimensional data created.

(1041) Besides, client device **2002** further transmits a transmission request for a three-dimensional map to server **2001**, and receives the three-dimensional map from server **2001**. In the estimating, client device **2002** estimates the self-location using the three-dimensional data and the three-dimensional map.

(1042) It should be noted that the above process performed by client device **2002** may be realized as an information transmission method for use in client device **2002**.

(1043) In addition, client device **2002** may include a processor and memory. Using the memory, the processor may perform the above process.

(1044) Next, a sensor information collection system according to the present embodiment will be described. FIG. **135** is a diagram illustrating a configuration of the sensor information collection system according to the present embodiment. As illustrated in FIG. **135**, the sensor information collection system according to the present embodiment includes terminal **2021A**, terminal **2021B**, communication device **2022A**, communication device **2022B**, network **2023**, data collection server **2024**, map server **2025**, and client device **2026**. It should be noted that when terminal **2021A** and terminal **2021B** are not particularly distinguished, terminal **2021A** and terminal **2021B** are also referred to as terminal **2021**. Additionally, when communication device **2022A** and communication device **2022B** are not particularly distinguished, communication device **2022A** and communication device **2022B** are also referred to as communication device **2022**.

(1045) Data collection server **2024** collects data such as sensor data obtained by a sensor included

in terminal **2021** as position-related data in which the data is associated with a position in a three-dimensional space.

(1046) Sensor data is data obtained by, for example, detecting a surrounding state of terminal **2021** or an internal state of terminal **2021** using a sensor included in terminal **2021**. Terminal **2021** transmits, to data collection server **2024**, one or more pieces of sensor data collected from one or more sensor devices in locations at which direct communication with terminal **2021** is possible or at which communication with terminal **2021** is possible by the same communication system or via one or more relay devices.

(1047) Data included in position-related data may include, for example, information indicating an operating state, an operating log, a service use state, etc. of a terminal or a device included in the terminal. In addition, the data include in the position-related data may include, for example, information in which an identifier of terminal **2021** is associated with a position or a movement path etc. of terminal **2021**.

(1048) Information indicating a position included in position-related data is associated with, for example, information indicating a position in three-dimensional data such as three-dimensional map data. The details of information indicating a position will be described later.

(1049) Position-related data may include at least one of the above-described time information or information indicating an attribute of data included in the position-related data or a type (e.g., a model number) of a sensor that has created the data, in addition to position information that is information indicating a position. The position information and the time information may be stored in a header area of the position-related data or a header area of a frame that stores the position-related data. Further, the position information and the time information may be transmitted and/or stored as metadata associated with the position-related data, separately from the position-related data.

(1050) Map server **2025** is connected to, for example, network **2023**, and transmits three-dimensional data such as three-dimensional map data in response to a request from another device such as terminal **2021**. Besides, as described in the aforementioned embodiments, map server **2025** may have, for example, a function of updating three-dimensional data using sensor information transmitted from terminal **2021**.

(1051) Data collection server **2024** is connected to, for example, network **2023**, collects position-related data from another device such as terminal **2021**, and stores the collected position-related data into a storage of data collection server **2024** or a storage of another server. In addition, data collection server **2024** transmits, for example, metadata of collected position-related data or three-dimensional data generated based on the position-related data, to terminal **2021** in response to a request from terminal **2021**.

(1052) Network **2023** is, for example, a communication network such as the Internet. Terminal **2021** is connected to network **2023** via communication device **2022**. Communication device **2022** communicates with terminal **2021** using one communication system or switching between communication systems. Communication device **2022** is a communication satellite that performs communication using, for example, (1) a base station compliant with Long-Term Evolution (LTE) etc., (2) an access point (AP) for Wi-Fi or millimeter-wave communication etc., (3) a low-power wide-area (LPWA) network gateway such as SIGFOX, LoRaWAN, or Wi-SUN, or (4) a satellite communication system such as DVB-S2.

(1053) It should be noted that a base station may communicate with terminal **2021** using a system classified as an LPWA network such as Narrowband Internet of Things (NB IoT) or LTE-M, or switching between these systems.

(1054) Here, although, in the example given, terminal **2021** has a function of communicating with communication device **2022** that uses two types of communication systems, and communicates with map server **2025** or data collection server **2024** using one of the communication systems or switching between the communication systems and between communication devices **2022** to be a

direct communication partner; a configuration of the sensor information collection system and terminal **2021** is not limited to this. For example, terminal **2021** need not have a function of performing communication using communication systems, and may have a function of performing communication using one of the communication systems. Terminal **2021** may also support three or more communication systems. Additionally, each terminal **2021** may support a different communication system.

(1055) Terminal **2021** includes, for example, the configuration of client device **902** illustrated in FIG. **125**. Terminal **2021** estimates a self-location etc. using received three-dimensional data. Besides, terminal **2021** associates sensor data obtained from a sensor and position information obtained by self-location estimation to generate position-related data.

(1056) Position information appended to position-related data indicates, for example, a position in a coordinate system used for three-dimensional data. For example, the position information is coordinate values represented using a value of a latitude and a value of a longitude. Here, terminal **2021** may include, in the position information, a coordinate system serving as a reference for the coordinate values and information indicating three-dimensional data used for location estimation, along with the coordinate values. Coordinate values may also include altitude information.

(1057) The position information may be associated with a data unit or a space unit usable for encoding the above three-dimensional data. Such a unit is, for example, WLD, GOS, SPC, VLM, or VXL. Here, the position information is represented by, for example, an identifier for identifying a data unit such as the SPC corresponding to position-related data. It should be noted that the position information may include, for example, information indicating three-dimensional data obtained by encoding a three-dimensional space including a data unit such as the SPC or information indicating a detailed position within the SPC, in addition to the identifier for identifying the data unit such as the SPC. The information indicating the three-dimensional data is, for example, a file name of the three-dimensional data.

(1058) As stated above, by generating position-related data associated with position information based on location estimation using three-dimensional data, the system can give more accurate position information to sensor information than when the system appends position information based on a self-location of a client device (terminal **2021**) obtained using a GPS to sensor information. As a result, even when another device uses the position-related data in another service, there is a possibility of more accurately determining a position corresponding to the position-related data in an actual space, by performing location estimation based on the same three-dimensional data.

(1059) It should be noted that although the data transmitted from terminal **2021** is the position-related data in the example given in the present embodiment, the data transmitted from terminal **2021** may be data unassociated with position information. In other words, the transmission and reception of three-dimensional data or sensor data described in the other embodiments may be performed via network **2023** described in the present embodiment.

(1060) Next, a different example of position information indicating a position in a three-dimensional or two-dimensional actual space or in a map space will be described. The position information appended to position-related data may be information indicating a relative position relative to a keypoint in three-dimensional data. Here, the keypoint serving as a reference for the position information is encoded as, for example, SWLD, and notified to terminal **2021** as three-dimensional data.

(1061) The information indicating the relative position relative to the keypoint may be, for example, information that is represented by a vector from the keypoint to the point indicated by the position information, and indicates a direction and a distance from the keypoint to the point indicated by the position information. Alternatively, the information indicating the relative position relative to the keypoint may be information indicating an amount of displacement from the keypoint to the point indicated by the position information along each of the x axis, the y axis, and

the z axis. Additionally, the information indicating the relative position relative to the keypoint may be information indicating a distance from each of three or more keypoints to the point indicated by the position information. It should be noted that the relative position need not be a relative position of the point indicated by the position information represented using each keypoint as a reference, and may be a relative position of each keypoint represented with respect to the point indicated by the position information. Examples of position information based on a relative position relative to a keypoint include information for identifying a keypoint to be a reference, and information indicating the relative position of the point indicated by the position information and relative to the keypoint. When the information indicating the relative position relative to the keypoint is provided separately from three-dimensional data, the information indicating the relative position relative to the keypoint may include, for example, coordinate axes used in deriving the relative position, information indicating a type of the three-dimensional data, and/or information indicating a magnitude per unit amount (e.g., a scale) of a value of the information indicating the relative position.

(1062) The position information may include, for each keypoint, information indicating a relative position relative to the keypoint. When the position information is represented by relative positions relative to keypoints, terminal **2021** that intends to identify a position in an actual space indicated by the position information may calculate candidate points of the position indicated by the position information from positions of the keypoints each estimated from sensor data, and may determine that a point obtained by averaging the calculated candidate points is the point indicated by the position information. Since this configuration reduces the effects of errors when the positions of the keypoints are estimated from the sensor data, it is possible to improve the estimation accuracy for the point in the actual space indicated by the position information. Besides, when the position information includes information indicating relative positions relative to keypoints, if it is possible to detect any one of the keypoints regardless of the presence of keypoints undetectable due to a limitation such as a type or performance of a sensor included in terminal **2021**, it is possible to estimate a value of the point indicated by the position information.

(1063) A point identifiable from sensor data can be used as a keypoint. Examples of the point identifiable from the sensor data include a point or a point within a region that satisfies a predetermined keypoint detection condition, such as the above-described three-dimensional feature or feature of visible light data is greater than or equal to a threshold value.

(1064) Moreover, a marker etc. placed in an actual space may be used as a keypoint. In this case, the marker may be detected and located from data obtained using a sensor such as LiDAR or a camera. For example, the marker may be represented by a change in color or luminance value (degree of reflection), or a three-dimensional shape (e.g., unevenness). Coordinate values indicating a position of the marker, or a two-dimensional bar code or a bar code etc. generated from an identifier of the marker may be also used.

(1065) Furthermore, a light source that transmits an optical signal may be used as a marker. When a light source of an optical signal is used as a marker, not only information for obtaining a position such as coordinate values or an identifier but also other data may be transmitted using an optical signal. For example, an optical signal may include contents of service corresponding to the position of the marker, an address for obtaining contents such as a URL, or an identifier of a wireless communication device for receiving service, and information indicating a wireless communication system etc. for connecting to the wireless communication device. The use of an optical communication device (a light source) as a marker not only facilitates the transmission of data other than information indicating a position but also makes it possible to dynamically change the data.

(1066) Terminal **2021** finds out a correspondence relationship of keypoints between mutually different data using, for example, a common identifier used for the data, or information or a table indicating the correspondence relationship of the keypoints between the data. When there is no

information indicating a correspondence relationship between keypoints, terminal **2021** may also determine that when coordinates of a keypoint in three-dimensional data are converted into a position in a space of another three-dimensional data, a keypoint closest to the position is a corresponding keypoint.

(1067) When the position information based on the relative position described above is used, terminal **2021** that uses mutually different three-dimensional data or services can identify or estimate a position indicated by the position information with respect to a common keypoint included in or associated with each three-dimensional data. As a result, terminal **2021** that uses the mutually different three-dimensional data or the services can identify or estimate the same position with higher accuracy.

(1068) Even when map data or three-dimensional data represented using mutually different coordinate systems are used, since it is possible to reduce the effects of errors caused by the conversion of a coordinate system, it is possible to coordinate services based on more accurate position information.

(1069) Hereinafter, an example of functions provided by data collection server **2024** will be described. Data collection server **2024** may transfer received position-related data to another data server. When there are data servers, data collection server **2024** determines to which data server received position-related data is to be transferred, and transfers the position-related data to a data server determined as a transfer destination.

(1070) Data collection server **2024** determines a transfer destination based on, for example, transfer destination server determination rules preset to data collection server **2024**. The transfer destination server determination rules are set by, for example, a transfer destination table in which identifiers respectively associated with terminals **2021** are associated with transfer destination data servers.

(1071) Terminal **2021** appends an identifier associated with terminal **2021** to position-related data to be transmitted, and transmits the position-related data to data collection server **2024**. Data collection server **2024** determines a transfer destination data server corresponding to the identifier appended to the position-related data, based on the transfer destination server determination rules set out using the transfer destination table etc.; and transmits the position-related data to the determined data server. The transfer destination server determination rules may be specified based on a determination condition set using a time, a place, etc. at which position-related data is obtained. Here, examples of the identifier associated with transmission source terminal **2021** include an identifier unique to each terminal **2021** or an identifier indicating a group to which terminal **2021** belongs.

(1072) The transfer destination table need not be a table in which identifiers associated with transmission source terminals are directly associated with transfer destination data servers. For example, data collection server **2024** holds a management table that stores tag information assigned to each identifier unique to terminal **2021**, and a transfer destination table in which the pieces of tag information are associated with transfer destination data servers. Data collection server **2024** may determine a transfer destination data server based on tag information, using the management table and the transfer destination table. Here, the tag information is, for example, control information for management or control information for providing service assigned to a type, a model number, an owner of terminal **2021** corresponding to the identifier, a group to which terminal **2021** belongs, or another identifier. Moreover, in the transfer destination table, identifiers unique to respective sensors may be used instead of the identifiers associated with transmission source terminals **2021**.

Furthermore, the transfer destination server determination rules may be set by client device **2026**.

(1073) Data collection server **2024** may determine data servers as transfer destinations, and transfer received position-related data to the data servers. According to this configuration, for example, when position-related data is automatically backed up or when, in order that position-related data is commonly used by different services, there is a need to transmit the position-related data to a data server for providing each service, it is possible to achieve data transfer as intended by changing a

setting of data collection server **2024**. As a result, it is possible to reduce the number of steps necessary for building and changing a system, compared to when a transmission destination of position-related data is set for each terminal **2021**.

(1074) Data collection server **2024** may register, as a new transfer destination, a data server specified by a transfer request signal received from a data server; and transmit position-related data subsequently received to the data server, in response to the transfer request signal.

(1075) Data collection server **2024** may store position-related data received from terminal **2021** into a recording device, and transmit position-related data specified by a transmission request signal received from terminal **2021** or a data server to request source terminal **2021** or the data server in response to the transmission request signal.

(1076) Data collection server **2024** may determine whether position-related data is suppliable to a request source data server or terminal **2021**, and transfer or transmit the position-related data to the request source data server or terminal **2021** when determining that the position-related data is suppliable.

(1077) When data collection server **2024** receives a request for current position-related data from client device **2026**, even if it is not a timing for transmitting position-related data by terminal **2021**, data collection server **2024** may send a transmission request for the current position-related data to terminal **2021**, and terminal **2021** may transmit the current position-related data in response to the transmission request.

(1078) Although terminal **2021** transmits position information data to data collection server **2024** in the above description, data collection server **2024** may have a function of managing terminal **2021** such as a function necessary for collecting position-related data from terminal **2021** or a function used when collecting position-related data from terminal **2021**.

(1079) Data collection server **2024** may have a function of transmitting, to terminal **2021**, a data request signal for requesting transmission of position information data, and collecting position-related data.

(1080) Management information such as an address for communicating with terminal **2021** from which data is to be collected or an identifier unique to terminal **2021** is registered in advance in data collection server **2024**. Data collection server **2024** collects position-related data from terminal **2021** based on the registered management information. Management information may include information such as types of sensors included in terminal **2021**, the number of sensors included in terminal **2021**, and communication systems supported by terminal **2021**.

(1081) Data collection server **2024** may collect information such as an operating state or a current position of terminal **2021** from terminal **2021**.

(1082) Registration of management information may be instructed by client device **2026**, or a process for the registration may be started by terminal **2021** transmitting a registration request to data collection server **2024**. Data collection server **2024** may have a function of controlling communication between data collection server **2024** and terminal **2021**.

(1083) Communication between data collection server **2024** and terminal **2021** may be established using a dedicated line provided by a service provider such as a mobile network operator (MNO) or a mobile virtual network operator (MVNO), or a virtual dedicated line based on a virtual private network (VPN). According to this configuration, it is possible to perform secure communication between terminal **2021** and data collection server **2024**.

(1084) Data collection server **2024** may have a function of authenticating terminal **2021** or a function of encrypting data to be transmitted and received between data collection server **2024** and terminal **2021**. Here, the authentication of terminal **2021** or the encryption of data is performed using, for example, an identifier unique to terminal **2021** or an identifier unique to a terminal group including terminals **2021**, which is shared in advance between data collection server **2024** and terminal **2021**. Examples of the identifier include an international mobile subscriber identity (IMSI) that is a unique number stored in a subscriber identity module (SIM) card. An identifier for use in

authentication and an identifier for use in encryption of data may be identical or different.

(1085) The authentication or the encryption of data between data collection server **2024** and terminal **2021** is feasible when both data collection server **2024** and terminal **2021** have a function of performing the process. The process does not depend on a communication system used by communication device **2022** that performs relay. Accordingly, since it is possible to perform the common authentication or encryption without considering whether terminal **2021** uses a communication system, the user's convenience of system architecture is increased. However, the expression "does not depend on a communication system used by communication device **2022** that performs relay" means a change according to a communication system is not essential. In other words, in order to improve the transfer efficiency or ensure security, the authentication or the encryption of data between data collection server **2024** and terminal **2021** may be changed according to a communication system used by a relay device.

(1086) Data collection server **2024** may provide client device **2026** with a User Interface (UI) that manages data collection rules such as types of position-related data collected from terminal **2021** and data collection schedules. Accordingly, a user can specify, for example, terminal **2021** from which data is to be collected using client device **2026**, a data collection time, and a data collection frequency. Additionally, data collection server **2024** may specify, for example, a region on a map from which data is to be desirably collected, and collect position-related data from terminal **2021** included in the region.

(1087) When the data collection rules are managed on a per terminal **2021** basis, client device **2026** presents, on a screen, a list of terminals **2021** or sensors to be managed. The user sets, for example, a necessity for data collection or a collection schedule for each item in the list.

(1088) When a region on a map from which data is to be desirably collected is specified, client device **2026** presents, on a screen, a two-dimensional or three-dimensional map of a region to be managed. The user selects the region from which data is to be collected on the displayed map. Examples of the region selected on the map include a circular or rectangular region having a point specified on the map as the center, or a circular or rectangular region specifiable by a drag operation. Client device **2026** may also select a region in a preset unit such as a city, an area or a block in a city, or a main road, etc. Instead of specifying a region using a map, a region may be set by inputting values of a latitude and a longitude, or a region may be selected from a list of candidate regions derived based on inputted text information. Text information is, for example, a name of a region, a city, or a landmark.

(1089) Moreover, data may be collected while the user dynamically changes a specified region by specifying one or more terminals **2021** and setting a condition such as within 100 meters of one or more terminals **2021**.

(1090) When client device **2026** includes a sensor such as a camera, a region on a map may be specified based on a position of client device **2026** in an actual space obtained from sensor data. For example, client device **2026** may estimate a self-location using sensor data, and specify, as a region from which data is to be collected, a region within a predetermined distance from a point on a map corresponding to the estimated location or a region within a distance specified by the user. Client device **2026** may also specify, as the region from which the data is to be collected, a sensing region of the sensor, that is, a region corresponding to obtained sensor data. Alternatively, client device **2026** may specify, as the region from which the data is to be collected, a region based on a location corresponding to sensor data specified by the user. Either client device **2026** or data collection server **2024** may estimate a region on a map or a location corresponding to sensor data.

(1091) When a region on a map is specified, data collection server **2024** may specify terminal **2021** within the specified region by collecting current position information of each terminal **2021**, and may send a transmission request for position-related data to specified terminal **2021**. When data collection server **2024** transmits information indicating a specified region to terminal **2021**, determines whether terminal **2021** is present within the specified region, and determines that

terminal **2021** is present within the specified region, rather than specifying terminal **2021** within the region, terminal **2021** may transmit position-related data.

(1092) Data collection server **2024** transmits, to client device **2026**, data such as a list or a map for providing the above-described User Interface (UI) in an application executed by client device **2026**. Data collection server **2024** may transmit, to client device **2026**, not only the data such as the list or the map but also an application program. Additionally, the above UI may be provided as contents created using HTML displayable by a browser. It should be noted that part of data such as map data may be supplied from a server, such as map server **2025**, other than data collection server **2024**.

(1093) When client device **2026** receives an input for notifying the completion of an input such as pressing of a setup key by the user, client device **2026** transmits the inputted information as configuration information to data collection server **2024**. Data collection server **2024** transmits, to each terminal **2021**, a signal for requesting position-related data or notifying position-related data collection rules, based on the configuration information received from client device **2026**, and collects the position-related data.

(1094) Next, an example of controlling operation of terminal **2021** based on additional information added to three-dimensional or two-dimensional map data will be described.

(1095) In the present configuration, object information that indicates a position of a power feeding part such as a feeder antenna or a feeder coil for wireless power feeding buried under a road or a parking lot is included in or associated with three-dimensional data, and such object information is provided to terminal **2021** that is a vehicle or a drone.

(1096) A vehicle or a drone that has obtained the object information to get charged automatically moves so that a position of a charging part such as a charging antenna or a charging coil included in the vehicle or the drone becomes opposite to a region indicated by the object information, and such vehicle or a drone starts to charge itself. It should be noted that when a vehicle or a drone has no automatic driving function, a direction to move in or an operation to perform is presented to a driver or an operator by using an image displayed on a screen, audio, etc. When a position of a charging part calculated based on an estimated self-location is determined to fall within the region indicated by the object information or a predetermined distance from the region, an image or audio to be presented is changed to a content that puts a stop to driving or operating, and the charging is started.

(1097) Object information need not be information indicating a position of a power feeding part, and may be information indicating a region within which placement of a charging part results in a charging efficiency greater than or equal to a predetermined threshold value. A position indicated by object information may be represented by, for example, the central point of a region indicated by the object information, a region or a line within a two-dimensional plane, or a region, a line, or a plane within a three-dimensional space.

(1098) According to this configuration, since it is possible to identify the position of the power feeding antenna unidentifiable by sensing data of LiDAR or an image captured by the camera, it is possible to highly accurately align a wireless charging antenna included in terminal **2021** such as a vehicle with a wireless power feeding antenna buried under a road. As a result, it is possible to increase a charging speed at the time of wireless charging and improve the charging efficiency.

(1099) Object information may be an object other than a power feeding antenna. For example, three-dimensional data includes, for example, a position of an AP for millimeter-wave wireless communication as object information. Accordingly, since terminal **2021** can identify the position of the AP in advance, terminal **2021** can steer a directivity of beam to a direction of the object information and start communication. As a result, it is possible to improve communication quality such as increasing transmission rates, reducing the duration of time before starting communication, and extending a communicable period.

(1100) Object information may include information indicating a type of an object corresponding to the object information. In addition, when terminal **2021** is present within a region in an actual space

corresponding to a position in three-dimensional data of the object information or within a predetermined distance from the region, the object information may include information indicating a process to be performed by terminal **2021**.

(1101) Object information may be provided by a server different from a server that provides three-dimensional data. When object information is provided separately from three-dimensional data, object groups in which object information used by the same service is stored may be each provided as separate data according to a type of a target service or a target device.

(1102) Three-dimensional data used in combination with object information may be point cloud data of WLD or keypoint data of SWLD.

(1103) In the three-dimensional data encoding device, when attribute information of a current three-dimensional point to be encoded is layer-encoded using Levels of Detail (LoDs), the three-dimensional data decoding device may decode the attribute information in layers down to LoD required by the three-dimensional data decoding device and need not decode the attribute information in layers not required. For example, when the total number of LoDs for the attribute information in a bitstream generated by the three-dimensional data encoding device is N , the three-dimensional data decoding device may decode M LoDs ($M < N$), i.e., layers from the uppermost layer LoD0 to LoD($M-1$), and need not decode the remaining LoDs, i.e., layers down to LoD($N-1$). With this, while reducing the processing load, the three-dimensional data decoding device can decode the attribute information in layers from LoD0 to LoD($M-1$) required by the three-dimensional data decoding device.

(1104) FIG. **136** is a diagram illustrating the foregoing use case. In the example shown in FIG. **136**, a server stores a three-dimensional map obtained by encoding three-dimensional geometry information and attribute information. The server (the three-dimensional data encoding device) broadcasts the three-dimensional map to client devices (the three-dimensional data decoding devices: for example, vehicles, drones, etc.) in an area managed by the server, and each client device uses the three-dimensional map received from the server to perform a process for identifying the self-position of the client device or a process for displaying map information to a user or the like who operates the client device.

(1105) The following describes an example of the operation in this case. First, the server encodes the geometry information of the three-dimensional map using an octree structure or the like. Then, the sever layer-encodes the attribute information of the three-dimensional map using N LoDs established based on the geometry information. The server stores a bitstream of the three-dimensional map obtained by the layer-encoding.

(1106) Next, in response to a send request for the map information from the client device in the area managed by the server, the server sends the bitstream of the encoded three-dimensional map to the client device.

(1107) The client device receives the bitstream of the three-dimensional map sent from the server, and decodes the geometry information and the attribute information of the three-dimensional map in accordance with the intended use of the client device. For example, when the client device performs highly accurate estimation of the self-position using the geometry information and the attribute information in N LoDs, the client device determines that a decoding result to the dense three-dimensional points is necessary as the attribute information, and decodes all the information in the bitstream.

(1108) Moreover, when the client device displays the three-dimensional map information to a user or the like, the client device determines that a decoding result to the sparse three-dimensional points is necessary as the attribute information, and decodes the geometry information and the attribute information in M LoDs ($M < N$) starting from an upper layer LoD0.

(1109) In this way, the processing load of the client device can be reduced by changing LoDs for the attribute information to be decoded in accordance with the intended use of the client device.

(1110) In the example shown in FIG. **136**, for example, the three-dimensional map includes

geometry information and attribute information. The geometry information is encoded using the octree. The attribute information is encoded using N LoDs.

(1111) Client device A performs highly accurate estimation of the self-position. In this case, client device A determines that all the geometry information and all the attribute information are necessary, and decodes all the geometry information and all the attribute information constructed from N LoDs in the bitstream.

(1112) Client device B displays the three-dimensional map to a user. In this case, client device B determines that the geometry information and the attribute information in M LoDs ($M < N$) are necessary, and decodes the geometry information and the attribute information constructed from M LoDs in the bitstream.

(1113) It is to be noted that the server may broadcast the three-dimensional map to the client devices, or multicast or unicast the three-dimensional map to the client devices.

(1114) The following describes a variation of the system according to the present embodiment. In the three-dimensional data encoding device, when attribute information of a current three-dimensional point to be encoded is layer-encoded using LoDs, the three-dimensional data encoding device may encode the attribute information in layers down to LoD required by the three-dimensional data decoding device and need not encode the attribute information in layers not required. For example, when the total number of LoDs is N, the three-dimensional data encoding device may generate a bitstream by encoding M LoDs ($M < N$), i.e., layers from the uppermost layer LoD0 to LoD(M-1), and not encoding the remaining LoDs, i.e., layers down to LoD(N-1). With this, in response to a request from the three-dimensional data decoding device, the three-dimensional data encoding device can provide a bitstream in which the attribute information from LoD0 to LoD(M-1) required by the three-dimensional data decoding device is encoded.

(1115) FIG. 137 is a diagram illustrating the foregoing use case. In the example shown in FIG. 137, a server stores a three-dimensional map obtained by encoding three-dimensional geometry information and attribute information. The server (the three-dimensional data encoding device) unicasts, in response to a request from the client device, the three-dimensional map to a client device (the three-dimensional data decoding device: for example, a vehicle, a drone, etc.) in an area managed by the server, and the client device uses the three-dimensional map received from the server to perform a process for identifying the self-position of the client device or a process for displaying map information to a user or the like who operates the client device.

(1116) The following describes an example of the operation in this case. First, the server encodes the geometry information of the three-dimensional map using an octree structure, or the like. Then, the sever generates a bitstream of three-dimensional map A by layer-encoding the attribute information of the three-dimensional map using N LoDs established based on the geometry information, and stores the generated bitstream in the server. The sever also generates a bitstream of three-dimensional map B by layer-encoding the attribute information of the three-dimensional map using M LoDs ($M < N$) established based on the geometry information, and stores the generated bitstream in the server.

(1117) Next, the client device requests the server to send the three-dimensional map in accordance with the intended use of the client device. For example, when the client device performs highly accurate estimation of the self-position using the geometry information and the attribute information in N LoDs, the client device determines that a decoding result to the dense three-dimensional points is necessary as the attribute information, and requests the server to send the bitstream of three-dimensional map A. Moreover, when the client device displays the three-dimensional map information to a user or the like, the client device determines that a decoding result to the sparse three-dimensional points is necessary as the attribute information, and requests the server to send the bitstream of three-dimensional map B including the geometry information and the attribute information in M LoDs ($M < N$) starting from an upper layer LoD0. Then, in response to the send request for the map information from the client device, the server sends the

bitstream of encoded three-dimensional map A or B to the client device.

(1118) The client device receives the bitstream of three-dimensional map A or B sent from the server in accordance with the intended use of the client device, and decodes the received bitstream. In this way, the server changes a bitstream to be sent, in accordance with the intended use of the client device. With this, it is possible to reduce the processing load of the client device.

(1119) In the example shown in FIG. 137, the server stores three-dimensional map A and three-dimensional map B. The server generates three-dimensional map A by encoding the geometry information of the three-dimensional map using, for example, an octree structure, and encoding the attribute information of the three-dimensional map using N LoDs. In other words, NumLoD included in the bitstream of three-dimensional map A indicates N.

(1120) The server also generates three-dimensional map B by encoding the geometry information of the three-dimensional map using, for example, an octree structure, and encoding the attribute information of the three-dimensional map using M LoDs. In other words, NumLoD included in the bitstream of three-dimensional map B indicates M.

(1121) Client device A performs highly accurate estimation of the self-position. In this case, client device A determines that all the geometry information and all the attribute information are necessary, and requests the server to send three-dimensional map A including all the geometry information and the attribute information constructed from N LoDs. Client device A receives three-dimensional map A, and decodes all the geometry information and the attribute information constructed from N LoDs.

(1122) Client device B displays the three-dimensional map to a user. In this case, client device B determines that all the geometry information and the attribute information in M LoDs ($M < N$) are necessary, and requests the server to send three-dimensional map B including all the geometry information and the attribute information constructed from M LoDs. Client device B receives three-dimensional map B, and decodes all the geometry information and the attribute information constructed from M LoDs.

(1123) It is to be noted that in addition to three-dimensional map B, the server (the three-dimensional data encoding device) may generate three-dimensional map C in which attribute information in the remaining $N - M$ LoDs is encoded, and send three-dimensional map C to client device B in response to the request from client device B. Moreover, client device B may obtain the decoding result of N LoDs using the bitstreams of three-dimensional maps B and C.

(1124) Hereinafter, an example of an application process will be described. FIG. 138 is a flowchart illustrating an example of the application process. When an application operation is started, a three-dimensional data demultiplexing device obtains an ISOBMFF file including point cloud data and a plurality of pieces of encoded data (S7301). For example, the three-dimensional data demultiplexing device may obtain the ISOBMFF file through communication, or may read the ISOBMFF file from the accumulated data.

(1125) Next, the three-dimensional data demultiplexing device analyzes the general configuration information in the ISOBMFF file, and specifies the data to be used for the application (S7302). For example, the three-dimensional data demultiplexing device obtains data that is used for processing, and does not obtain data that is not used for processing.

(1126) Next, the three-dimensional data demultiplexing device extracts one or more pieces of data to be used for the application, and analyzes the configuration information on the data (S7303).

(1127) When the type of the data is encoded data (encoded data in S7304), the three-dimensional data demultiplexing device converts the ISOBMFF to an encoded stream, and extracts a timestamp (S7305). Additionally, the three-dimensional data demultiplexing device refers to, for example, the flag indicating whether or not the synchronization between data is aligned to determine whether or not the synchronization between data is aligned, and may perform a synchronization process when not aligned.

(1128) Next, the three-dimensional data demultiplexing device decodes the data with a

predetermined method according to the timestamp and the other instructions, and processes the decoded data (S7306).

(1129) On the other hand, when the type of the data is RAW data (RAW data in S7304), the three-dimensional data demultiplexing device extracts the data and timestamp (S7307). Additionally, the three-dimensional data demultiplexing device may refer to, for example, the flag indicating whether or not the synchronization between data is aligned to determine whether or not the synchronization between data is aligned, and may perform a synchronization process when not aligned. Next, the three-dimensional data demultiplexing device processes the data according to the timestamp and the other instructions (S7308).

(1130) For example, an example will be described in which the sensor signals obtained by a beam LiDAR, a FLASH LiDAR, and a camera are encoded and multiplexed with respective different encoding schemes. FIG. 139 is a diagram illustrating examples of the sensor ranges of a beam LiDAR, a FLASH LiDAR, and a camera. For example, the beam LiDAR detects all directions in the periphery of a vehicle (sensor), and the FLASH LiDAR and the camera detect the range in one direction (for example, the front) of the vehicle.

(1131) In the case of an application that integrally handles a LiDAR point cloud, the three-dimensional data demultiplexing device refers to the general configuration information, and extracts and decodes the encoded data of the beam LiDAR and the FLASH LiDAR. Additionally, the three-dimensional data demultiplexing device does not extract camera images.

(1132) According to the timestamps of the beam LiDAR and the FLASH LiDAR, the three-dimensional data demultiplexing device simultaneously processes the respective encoded data of the time of the same timestamp.

(1133) For example, the three-dimensional data demultiplexing device may present the processed data with a presentation device, may synthesize the point cloud data of the beam LiDAR and the FLASH LiDAR, or may perform a process such as rendering.

(1134) Additionally, in the case of an application that performs calibration between data, the three-dimensional data demultiplexing device may extract sensor geometry information, and use the sensor geometry information in the application.

(1135) For example, the three-dimensional data demultiplexing device may select whether to use beam LiDAR information or FLASH LiDAR information in the application, and may switch the process according to the selection result.

(1136) In this manner, since it is possible to adaptively change the obtaining of data and the encoding process according to the process of the application, the processing amount and the power consumption can be reduced.

(1137) Hereinafter, a use case in automated driving will be described. FIG. 140 is a diagram illustrating a configuration example of an automated driving system. This automated driving system includes cloud server 7350, and edge 7360 such as an in-vehicle device or a mobile device. Cloud server 7350 includes demultiplexer 7351, decoders 7352A, 7352B, and 7355, point cloud data synthesizer 7353, large data accumulator 7354, comparator 7356, and encoder 7357. Edge 7360 includes sensors 7361A and 7361B, point cloud data generators 7362A and 7362B, synchronizer 7363, encoders 7364A and 7364B, multiplexer 7365, update data accumulator 7366, demultiplexer 7367, decoder 7368, filter 7369, self-position estimator 7370, and driving controller 7371.

(1138) In this system, edge 7360 downloads large data, which is large point-cloud map data accumulated in cloud server 7350. Edge 7360 performs a self-position estimation process of edge 7360 (a vehicle or a terminal) by matching the large data with the sensor information obtained by edge 7360. Additionally, edge 7360 uploads the obtained sensor information to cloud server 7350, and updates the large data to the latest map data.

(1139) Additionally, in various applications that handle point cloud data in the system, point cloud data with different encoding methods are handled.

(1140) Cloud server **7350** encodes and multiplexes large data. Specifically, encoder **7357** performs encoding by using a third encoding method suitable for encoding a large point cloud. Additionally, encoder **7357** multiplexes encoded data. Large data accumulator **7354** accumulates the data encoded and multiplexed by encoder **7357**.

(1141) Edge **7360** performs sensing. Specifically, point cloud data generator **7362A** generates first point cloud data (geometry information (geometry) and attribute information) by using the sensing information obtained by sensor **7361A**. Point cloud data generator **7362B** generates second point cloud data (geometry information and attribute information) by using the sensing information obtained by sensor **7361B**. The generated first point cloud data and second point cloud data are used for the self-position estimation or vehicle control of automated driving, or for map updating. In each process, a part of information of the first point cloud data and the second point cloud data may be used.

(1142) Edge **7360** performs the self-position estimation. Specifically, edge **7360** downloads large data from cloud server **7350**. Demultiplexer **7367** obtains encoded data by demultiplexing the large data in a file format. Decoder **7368** obtains large data, which is large point-cloud map data, by decoding the obtained encoded data.

(1143) Self-position estimator **7370** estimates the self-position in the map of a vehicle by matching the obtained large data with the first point cloud data and the second point cloud data generated by point cloud data generators **7362A** and **7362B**. Additionally, driving controller **7371** uses the matching result or the self-position estimation result for driving control.

(1144) Note that self-position estimator **7370** and driving controller **7371** may extract specific information, such as geometry information, of the large data, and may perform processes by using the extracted information. Additionally, filter **7369** performs a process such as correction or decimation on the first point cloud data and the second point cloud data. Self-position estimator **7370** and driving controller **7371** may use the first point cloud data and second point cloud data on which the process has been performed. Additionally, self-position estimator **7370** and driving controller **7371** may use the sensor signals obtained by sensors **7361A** and **7361B**.

(1145) Synchronizer **7363** performs time synchronization and geometry correction between a plurality of sensor signals or the pieces of data of a plurality of pieces of point cloud data. Additionally, synchronizer **7363** may correct the geometry information on the sensor signal or point cloud data to match the large data, based on geometry correction information on the large data and sensor data generated by the self-position estimation process.

(1146) Note that synchronization and geometry correction may be performed not by edge **7360**, but by cloud server **7350**. In this case, edge **7360** may multiplex the synchronization information and the geometry information to transmit the synchronization information and the geometry information to cloud server **7350**.

(1147) Edge **7360** encodes and multiplexes the sensor signal or point cloud data. Specifically, the sensor signal or point cloud data is encoded by using a first encoding method or a second encoding method suitable for encoding each signal. For example, encoder **7364A** generates first encoded data by encoding first point cloud data by using the first encoding method. Encoder **7364B** generates second encoded data by encoding second point cloud data by using the second encoding method.

(1148) Multiplexer **7365** generates a multiplexed signal by multiplexing the first encoded data, the second encoded data, the synchronization information, and the like. Update data accumulator **7366** accumulates the generated multiplexed signal. Additionally, update data accumulator **7366** uploads the multiplexed signal to cloud server **7350**.

(1149) Cloud server **7350** synthesizes the point cloud data. Specifically, demultiplexer **7351** obtains the first encoded data and the second encoded data by demultiplexing the multiplexed signal uploaded to cloud server **7350**. Decoder **7352A** obtains the first point cloud data (or sensor signal) by decoding the first encoded data. Decoder **7352B** obtains the second point cloud data (or sensor signal) by decoding the second encoded data.

(1150) Point cloud data synthesizer **7353** synthesizes the first point cloud data and the second point cloud data with a predetermined method. When the synchronization information and the geometry correction information are multiplexed in the multiplexed signal, point cloud data synthesizer **7353** may perform synthesis by using these pieces of information.

(1151) Decoder **7355** demultiplexes and decodes the large data accumulated in large data accumulator **7354**. Comparator **7356** compares the point cloud data generated based on the sensor signal obtained by edge **7360** with the large data held by cloud server **7350**, and determines the point cloud data that needs to be updated. Comparator **7356** updates the point cloud data that is determined to need to be updated of the large data to the point cloud data obtained from edge **7360**.

(1152) Encoder **7357** encodes and multiplexes the updated large data, and accumulates the obtained data in large data accumulator **7354**.

(1153) As described above, the signals to be handled may be different, and the signals to be multiplexed or encoding methods may be different, according to the usage or applications to be used. Even in such a case, flexible decoding and application processes are enabled by multiplexing data of various encoding schemes by using the present embodiment. Additionally, even in a case where the encoding schemes of signals are different, by conversion to an encoding scheme suitable for demultiplexing, decoding, data conversion, encoding, and multiplexing processing, it becomes possible to build various applications and systems, and to offer of flexible services.

(1154) Hereinafter, an example of decoding and application of divided data will be described. First, the information on divided data will be described. FIG. **141** is a diagram illustrating a configuration example of a bitstream. The general information of divided data indicates, for each divided data, the sensor ID (sensor_id) and data ID (data_id) of the divided data. Note that the data ID is also indicated in the header of each encoded data.

(1155) Note that the general information of divided data illustrated in FIG. **141** includes, in addition to the sensor ID, at least one of the sensor information (Sensor), the version (Version) of the sensor, the maker name (Maker) of the sensor, the mount information (Mount Info.) of the sensor, and the position coordinates of the sensor (World Coordinate). Accordingly, the three-dimensional data decoding device can obtain the information on various sensors from the configuration information.

(1156) The general information of divided data may be stored in SPS, GPS, or APS, which is the metadata, or may be stored in SEI, which is the metadata not required for encoding. Additionally, at the time of multiplexing, the three-dimensional data encoding device stores the SEI in a file of ISO BMFF. The three-dimensional data decoding device can obtain desired divided data based on the metadata.

(1157) In FIG. **141**, SPS is the metadata of the entire encoded data, GPS is the metadata of the geometry information, APS is the metadata for each attribute information, G is encoded data of the geometry information for each divided data, and A1, etc. are encoded data of the attribute information for each divided data.

(1158) Next, an application example of divided data will be described. An example of application will be described in which an arbitrary point cloud is selected, and the selected point cloud is presented. FIG. **142** is a flowchart of a point cloud selection process performed by this application. FIG. **143** to FIG. **145** are diagrams illustrating screen examples of the point cloud selection process.

(1159) As illustrated in FIG. **143**, the three-dimensional data decoding device that performs the application includes, for example, a UI unit that displays an input UI (user interface) **8661** for selecting an arbitrary point cloud. Input UI **8661** includes presenter **8662** that presents the selected point cloud, and an operation unit (buttons **8663** and **8664**) that receives operations by a user. After a point cloud is selected in UI **8661**, the three-dimensional data decoding device obtains desired data from accumulator **8665**.

(1160) First, based on an operation by the user on input UI **8661**, the point cloud information that

the user wants to display is selected (**S8631**). Specifically, by selecting button **8663**, the point cloud based on sensor 1 is selected. By selecting button **8664**, the point cloud based on sensor 2 is selected. Alternatively, by selecting both button **8663** and button **8664**, the point cloud based on sensor 1 and the point cloud based on sensor 2 are selected. Note that it is an example of the selection method of point cloud, and it is not limited to this.

(1161) Next, the three-dimensional data decoding device analyzes the general information of divided data included in the multiplexed signal (bitstream) or encoded data, and specifies the data ID (data_id) of the divided data constituting the selected point cloud from the sensor ID (sensor_id) of the selected sensor (**S8632**). Next, the three-dimensional data decoding device extracts, from the multiplexed signal, the encoded data including the specified and desired data ID, and decodes the extracted encoded data to decode the point cloud based on the selected sensor (**S8633**). Note that the three-dimensional data decoding device does not decode the other encoded data.

(1162) Lastly, the three-dimensional data decoding device presents (for example, displays) the decoded point cloud (**S8634**). FIG. **144** illustrates an example in the case where button **8663** for sensor 1 is pressed, and the point cloud of sensor 1 is presented. FIG. **145** illustrates an example in the case where both button **8663** for sensor 1 and button **8664** for sensor 2 are pressed, and the point clouds of sensor 1 and sensor 2 are presented.

(1163) A three-dimensional data encoding device, a three-dimensional data decoding device, and the like according to the embodiments of the present disclosure have been described above, but the present disclosure is not limited to these embodiments.

(1164) Note that each of the processors included in the three-dimensional data encoding device, the three-dimensional data decoding device, and the like according to the above embodiments is typically implemented as a large-scale integrated (LSI) circuit, which is an integrated circuit (IC). These may take the form of individual chips, or may be partially or entirely packaged into a single chip.

(1165) Such IC is not limited to an LSI, and thus may be implemented as a dedicated circuit or a general-purpose processor. Alternatively, a field programmable gate array (FPGA) that allows for programming after the manufacture of an LSI, or a reconfigurable processor that allows for reconfiguration of the connection and the setting of circuit cells inside an LSI may be employed.

(1166) Moreover, in the above embodiments, the structural components may be implemented as dedicated hardware or may be realized by executing a software program suited to such structural components. Alternatively, the structural components may be implemented by a program executor such as a CPU or a processor reading out and executing the software program recorded in a recording medium such as a hard disk or a semiconductor memory.

(1167) The present disclosure may also be implemented as a three-dimensional data encoding method, a three-dimensional data decoding method, or the like executed by the three-dimensional data encoding device, the three-dimensional data decoding device, and the like.

(1168) Also, the divisions of the functional blocks shown in the block diagrams are mere examples, and thus a plurality of functional blocks may be implemented as a single functional block, or a single functional block may be divided into a plurality of functional blocks, or one or more functions may be moved to another functional block. Also, the functions of a plurality of functional blocks having similar functions may be processed by single hardware or software in a parallelized or time-divided manner.

(1169) Also, the processing order of executing the steps shown in the flowcharts is a mere illustration for specifically describing the present disclosure, and thus may be an order other than the shown order. Also, one or more of the steps may be executed simultaneously (in parallel) with another step.

(1170) A three-dimensional data encoding device, a three-dimensional data decoding device, and the like according to one or more aspects have been described above based on the embodiments, but the present disclosure is not limited to these embodiments. The one or more aspects may thus

include forms achieved by making various modifications to the above embodiments that can be conceived by those skilled in the art, as well forms achieved by combining structural components in different embodiments, without materially departing from the spirit of the present disclosure.

INDUSTRIAL APPLICABILITY

(1171) The present disclosure is applicable to a three-dimensional data encoding device and a three-dimensional data decoding device.

Claims

1. A three-dimensional data encoding method of encoding three-dimensional points, the three-dimensional data encoding method comprising: calculating a predicted value of attribute information of a first three-dimensional point in a prediction mode for calculating the predicted value, using one or more items of attribute information of one or more second three-dimensional points in a vicinity of the first three-dimensional point, the first three-dimensional point and the one or more second three-dimensional points being included in the three-dimensional points; calculating a prediction residual that is a difference between the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point and the predicted value calculated; and generating a bitstream including the prediction residual and prediction mode information indicating the prediction mode, wherein the prediction mode is: one prediction mode among two or more prediction modes when a type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is first attribute information including elements a total number of which is greater than a predetermined threshold value; and one fixed prediction mode when the type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is second attribute information including elements a total number of which is smaller than or equal to the predetermined threshold value.
2. The three-dimensional data encoding method according to claim 1, wherein the bitstream indicates whether or not the prediction mode is the one fixed prediction mode.
3. The three-dimensional data encoding method according to claim 1, wherein the predetermined threshold value is 1.
4. The three-dimensional data encoding method according to claim 1, wherein the bitstream does not include the prediction mode information when the one prediction mode is the one fixed prediction mode.
5. The three-dimensional data encoding method according to claim 1, wherein the predicted value is an average value of the one or more items of attribute information of the one or more second three-dimensional points, when a value indicated by the prediction mode information is 0.
6. The three-dimensional data encoding method according to claim 1, wherein the first attribute information is color information indicating color of a three-dimensional point, and the second attribute information is information indicating a reflectance of a three-dimensional point.
7. A three-dimensional data decoding method of decoding three-dimensional points, the three-dimensional data decoding method comprising: obtaining a prediction residual and prediction mode information indicating a prediction mode for a first three-dimensional point among the three-dimensional points, by obtaining a bitstream; calculating a predicted value in the prediction mode indicated by the prediction mode information; and calculating attribute information of the first three-dimensional point by adding the predicted value to the prediction residual, wherein the prediction mode is: one prediction mode among two or more prediction modes when a type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is first attribute information including elements a total number of which is greater than a predetermined threshold value; and one fixed prediction mode when the type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is second attribute information including elements a total number of which is smaller than or equal to the predetermined threshold value.
8. The three-dimensional data decoding method according to claim 7, wherein the bitstream

- indicates whether or not the one prediction mode is the one fixed prediction mode, and the calculating of the predicted value is performed: in the prediction mode indicated in the prediction mode information when the bitstream indicates that the one prediction mode is different from the one fixed prediction mode; and in the one fixed prediction mode when the bitstream indicates that the one prediction mode is the one fixed prediction mode.
9. The three-dimensional data decoding method according to claim 7, wherein the predetermined threshold value is 1.
10. The three-dimensional data decoding method according to claim 7, wherein the calculating of the predicted value is performed in the one fixed prediction mode when the bitstream does not include the prediction mode information.
11. The three-dimensional data decoding method according to claim 7, wherein the predicted value is an average value of one or more items of attribute information of one or more second three-dimensional points in a vicinity of the first three-dimensional point, when a value indicated by the prediction mode information is 0.
12. The three-dimensional data decoding method according to claim 7, wherein the first attribute information is color information indicating color of a three-dimensional point, and the second attribute information is information indicating a reflectance of a three-dimensional point.
13. A three-dimensional data encoding device that encodes three-dimensional points, the three-dimensional data encoding device comprising: a processor; and memory, wherein using the memory, the processor: calculates a predicted value of attribute information of a first three-dimensional point in a prediction mode for calculating the predicted value, using one or more items of attribute information of one or more second three-dimensional points in a vicinity of the first three-dimensional point, the first three-dimensional point and the one or more second three-dimensional points being included in the three-dimensional points; calculates a prediction residual that is a difference between the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point and the predicted value calculated; and generates a bitstream including the prediction residual and prediction mode information indicating the prediction mode, wherein the prediction mode is: one prediction mode among two or more prediction modes when a type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is first attribute information including elements a total number of which is greater than a predetermined threshold value; and one fixed prediction mode when the type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is second attribute information including elements a total number of which is smaller than or equal to the predetermined threshold value.
14. A three-dimensional data decoding device that decodes three-dimensional points, the three-dimensional data decoding device comprising: a processor; and memory, wherein using the memory, the processor: obtains a prediction residual and prediction mode information indicating a prediction mode for a first three-dimensional point among the three-dimensional points, by obtaining a bitstream; calculates a predicted value in the prediction mode indicated by the prediction mode information; and calculates attribute information of the first three-dimensional point by adding the predicted value to the prediction residual, wherein the prediction mode is: one prediction mode among two or more prediction modes when a type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is first attribute information including elements a total number of which is greater than a predetermined threshold value; and one fixed prediction mode when the type of the attribute information of the first three-dimensional point is second attribute information including elements a total number of which is smaller than or equal to the predetermined threshold value.
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